



## Honouring Nari Shakti



32+ crore Jan Dhan accounts opened for women  
3+ crore women became Lakhpati Didis  
₹16+ lakh crore MUDRA loans to women, strengthening entrepreneurship

12 Saal Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke



CBC 46107/13/0010/2627

## Happening today

● **THE SUPREME** Court is set to hear Congress leader Meenakshi Natarajan's plea against rejection of her nomination papers for Rajya Sabha polls.

● **THE WOMEN'S** T20 World Cup begins with England facing Sri Lanka in Birmingham.

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## Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



## ANNOUNCEMENT ON SOCIAL MEDIA POST HOURS AFTER THREATENING FRESH ATTACKS

# Trump calls off Iran strikes, claims progress in talks towards a deal

Says 'all parties' have approved; no immediate Tehran response



Says discussions were brought to the highest level of Iran's leadership and approved. AP FILE

Parisa Hafezi & Susan Heavey  
Dubai, Washington, June 11

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump called off plans for renewed US military strikes on Iran at the last minute on Thursday, saying negotiations with Tehran had advanced to the highest levels of Iran's leadership and had been approved by a broad coalition of regional powers.

The dramatic reversal came hours before the strikes were expected to be carried out. But details of the diplomatic breakthrough after more than three months of war — including how Iran's leadership had signaled its approval — were not immediately clear in Trump's post on Truth Social.

"Based on the fact that discussions with the Islamic Republic of Iran have been brought to the highest level of Iranian leadership and approved, I have, as President of the United States of America, cancelled the scheduled strikes and bombings

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Tanker MT Jalveer was attacked near the Oman coast, Thursday. ANI

## MODI, TRUMP AT G7 NEXT WEEK

# Third ship hit by US near Oman, all 20 Indians rescued, safe

CENTCOM: Fired Hellfire missiles at its engine room, was trying to ship Iran oil

Shubhajit Roy, Sukalp Sharma & Purnima Sah  
New Delhi, Mumbai, June 11

FEARS FOR the safety of Indian seafarers on board ships trying to transit the Strait of Hormuz heightened Thursday when the US military attacked MT Jalveer, a Guinea-Bissau-flagged tanker, near the Oman coast, the third such incident in the area in four days. All 20 Indian seafarers on board were safely evacuated after the missile strike.

The attack on the tank took place on the day Sarbananda

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## E. EXPLAINED

## Safety concerns mount amid strikes

US enforcement of a naval blockade of Iran has raised fears about safety of seafarers on board ships in the region. Officials say at least 562 Indian seafarers are on ships near the Strait of Hormuz — 329 in the Persian Gulf west of the Strait, and 233 in the Gulf of Oman to the east.

INDIAN NAVY REMOVES UNEXPLODED WARHEAD FROM KOCHI-BOUND SHIP [PAGE 5](#)

# Govt confirms three Indian seafarers killed in US strike, families left with memories of phone calls

Pavneet Singh Chadha, Bhupendra Pandey, Nikhila Henry & Sreenivas Janyala  
Panaji, Lucknow, Hyderabad, June 11

ON THE last phone call with his father on Sunday, Indian seafarer Aditya Sharma confided in him about "warnings" from United States forces and the tense situation aboard his Palau-flagged merchant tanker, MT Settebello, as the ship navi-



(From left) Shivanand Chaurasia, Aditya Sharma and Suresh Pattna died after MT Settebello came under attack.

gated waters off the coast of Oman, amid a naval blockade near the Strait of Hormuz.

"We spoke almost every day. On a WhatsApp call on Sunday, he told me that they received at

least two warnings from the US Navy in the past fortnight, and that the ship was still trying to push towards the Strait of Hormuz. We were worried. Another ship, in their vicinity, was attacked on the same day, but he

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## NITI AAYOG GOVERNING COUNCIL MEETING

# PM calls for district GDP estimates, CMs press for affordable energy

Ravi Dutta Mishra  
New Delhi, June 11

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi Thursday asked states to pursue investments from partner countries by addressing grievances rapidly and to come up with district-level GDP estimates to deal with growth-related challenges at the grassroots level.

He was addressing the 11th Governing Council meeting of Niti Aayog which was attended

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(From right) Chief Ministers DK Shivakumar, Hemant Soren, Nayab Singh Saini, and Rekha Gupta at NITI Aayog meeting, Thursday. ANI

## NATION PAGES 4,8



## TWO KILLED IN FRESH VIOLENCE AS TENSIONS BOIL OVER IN MANIPUR

## MOTOR ACCIDENT CLAIMS: CONSIDER RS 30,000/MONTH AS HOMEMAKERS' INCOME, SAY SSC

## GANGSTER EXTRADITED FROM GEORGIA

# Choose between Abhishek and us: Loyalists' ultimatum to Mamata

Kalyan Banerjee targets Abhishek, Sougata Roy says Mamata must tackle charge of nephew's 'high-handedness'

Tanusree Bose & Manoj C G  
Kolkata, New Delhi, June 11

AS ONE more Rajya Sabha MP of the Trinamool Congress (TMC) resigned Thursday, troubles mounted for party chairperson Mamata Banerjee as two of her colleagues still considered part of her faction gave her an ultimatum, saying she must choose between her nephew



Trinamool MPs Kalyan Banerjee (left) and Sougata Roy.

and TMC's Lok Sabha MP Abhishek Banerjee and those who were standing by her. Banerjee, one of the MPs said, must take note of the "grievances" against Abhishek and that he was with her "as of now".

This came on a day a single-judge Bench of the Calcutta

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RELATED REPORTS, [P 6](#)

# Mexico's 'cathedral of football', the stadium Maradona never really left



Sandip G  
Mexico City, June 11

THE SECURITY officer near tunnel eight of Azteca Stadium is tired. A small crowd has gathered at the alley leading to the dressing room and he is holding them back. On the wall

nearby hangs a photograph: Diego Maradona on the shoulders of his teammates after the 1986 quarter-final at this very stadium, hair fanned out like a halo. Some try to bribe their way past, but the security officer doesn't move.

Near the stadium café, there used to be a small bronze statue of Maradona's 'Hand of God' goal. It was removed during renovation before this World Cup. "We had to make some space, but it will be restored soon," says Juventino

Gonzales, who runs the stadium tours.

The goal that made him and unmade England, boxed up in storage beneath the stadium where it happened. Azteca and Maradona have given each other footballing immortality.

"Almost every visitor comes in search of Maradona memorabilia. Some get so emotional that they even cry," says Gonzales. When Maradona died over five years ago, thousands turned up at the Azteca. "He is not Mexican, but he



Diego Maradona's statue and a mural inside the Azteca Stadium where he scored the Hand of God goal in 1986 World Cup. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



is kind of a hero here. Every year on his death anniversary, people come and place bouquets. Last time, we kept a mural of him in a churro hat," he says.

Outside, the rumbling streets around the Azteca are stacked with taco and torta stalls. Martina's has a torta named after every legendary footballer. The Maradona torta is hot on one side and sweet on the other. "Poco diablo," says Martina, the cafe owner. A little devil. Her husband watched that 1986 game live, she says. "The World Cup brought us

happiness," Martina says, "and Maradona was a big reason."

The earthquake had come the year before the 1986 World Cup and took everything from the country. Nine months later, Maradona arrived.

Inside the press pack that day was Luis Caledron, then at *Excelsior*, now long retired. He remembers the press conferences. Journalists from Argentina and England would press Maradona on his personal life, trying to unsettle him. "He rattled them more than they did him. He liked the reporters who

asked good questions, and gave them long answers," he recalls.

He also remembers a story about the famous 1986 Argentina jersey. Since the original match jerseys were too heavy, coach Carlos Bilardo needed something lighter, with two days to go for their opening game. The manufacturers said it was too late.

So Bilardo sent second-choice goalkeeper Héctor Miguel Zelada into the city. Zelada had played in the local league for years and knew where to go

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

The B J Medical College hostel buildings, a year after they were damaged in the Air India plane crash. BHUPENDRA RANA

# A-I: Victims' belongings returned, 15 families didn't take back anything

Ritu Sharma  
Ahmedabad, June 11

OF THE families of 241 passengers and crew on board the Ahmedabad-Gatwick AI 171 flight, which crashed minutes after taking off on June 12, 2025, as many as 15 declined to take back the personal belongings of their deceased kin, including clothes, passports, wallets and photographs, an Air India spokesperson told *The Indian Express*.

The spokesperson also said that the airline has so far paid

an interim compensation of Rs 25 lakh each to 96 per cent of the families of victims.

The crash killed 241 of the 242 people on board, leaving Vishwas Kumar Ramesh (39) as the sole survivor, and also killed 19 individuals on the ground. There were 169 Indian nationals, 53 British nationals, seven Portuguese and one Canadian among those on board.

Following the crash, Air India set up a 'Family Returns Centre' (FRC) in Ahmedabad

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Vishwas Kumar Ramesh (right), and his advisor Sanjiv Patel. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

## EXPLAINED PAGE 16 AMID UNCERTAINTY OVER AI 171 REPORT, A LOOK AT THE KEY THEORIES BEHIND THE CRASH

at peace. I will have to live with what I have gone through and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2





# Kerala’s 1st Nipah case this yr: Trader whose godown had fruit bats hospitalised

**Shaju Philip**  
*Thiruvananthapuram, June 11*

A 43-YEAR-OLD man in Kozhikode on Thursday tested positive for Nipah virus, making the first such case in Kerala in 2026.

After National Institute of Virology-Pune confirmed the infection, the health department sounded an alert in Kozhikode, which had a recurring history of Nipah cases including the deadly outbreak of 2018.

Official sources said the confirmed case is admitted to the ICU of the government medical college hospital in Kozhikode, while 77 persons in his contact list have been identified. As many as 13 of them in the high risk category have been quarantined.

Kozhikode district collector MS Madhavikutty said a control room has been opened and a route map of the infected person has been prepared for initiating field-level preventive steps. Of the 77 persons in the contact list, 58 are health workers, 14 are his relatives/family members and five are his friends. A rapid response team has been activated in Ramanattukara municipality, where the infected person resided.

The patient is a trader whose godown is situated close to thick vegetation. According to Health officials, when the trader opened the godown after a long time, he saw a large number of fruit bats, which are considered the reservoir of the virus.

Before being admitted to the

medical college hospital on Tuesday, the patient had sought treatment at another hospital in his locality.

The severe zoonotic disease was first detected in Kerala in 2018, in Kozhikode district. Out of 18 cases that year, 17 died. In 2021, the state saw another outbreak, killing one person. In 2023, two Nipah deaths were reported in Kerala, and in 2024, there were two deaths. Last year, Kerala reported four cases of Nipah, out of which two patients died. The total death toll from the Nipah virus in Kerala since 2018 is 24.

All the outbreaks in Kerala were reported in the May to September period, which encompasses the main rainy season in the state. With other viral fevers and the flu also a common occurrence in this season, the early diagnosis of Nipah, which has similar initial symptoms, has been a challenge.

A study on the 2018 outbreak found that the index case was infected from bats, and the others from the hospital where the patient was admitted. The virus reported in Kerala belonged to a Bangladeshi strain, which is known for a mortality rate of up to 90%.

A field survey conducted by NIV and National Institute of High Security Animal Diseases after the Nipah death in July 2024 indicated fruit bats as the source of infection. The presence of antibodies to the virus was detected in fruit bats' samples collected from the village where the July victim lived.

# Puducherry fake medicine racket case: CBI summons Haryana-cadre IPS officer

**Mahender Singh Manral**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

DAYS AFTER arresting two men, including a Delhi Police inspector for allegedly accepting a bribe of Rs 1 crore, the CBI has summoned a 2012-batch IPS officer of Haryana cadre in connection with the Puducherry counterfeit medicine racket case.

The officer, who has been asked to appear on Friday, allegedly told the prime accused in the case that he could “arrange” relief in the CBI cases through his “connections” within the agency. For the purpose, he demanded Rs 3 crore from N Raja alias Valliappan alias Rajasekhara – the prime accused in the Rs 5,000-crore counterfeit medicine racket in Puducherry.

A source said the IPS officer in question is currently serving in a post of Regional DGCA. He had already taken Rs 1 crore from Raja on the promise of securing him relief, the source added. “We have identified him and, after informing his department, we have summoned him to find out more details,” a source said.

On June 8, the CBI had reg-

istered an FIR against Raja; Pradeep Kumar Singh, an inspector with the Delhi Police Crime Branch's Southern Range; and Rajkumar alias Madhanraj, who is alleged to have acted as an intermediary.

The FIR also names unknown public servants and private individuals. “Raja had arranged a payment of Rs 1 crore through hawala transaction. The arrested inspector received the payment through a hawala operator and gave it to one Prabhat, who was an acquaintance of an IPS officer. Singh kept the remaining Rs 25 lakh in his house and the CBI had arrested Singh and Rajkumar with the balance amount of Rs 24.70 lakh,” the CBI said.

The amount was the first instalment of a larger payoff, according to CBI. A source said that according to the FIR, Singh had been facilitating the payment of illegal gratification by the accused who was attempting to secure undue relief in the CBI cases. “After the fresh FIR, Raja started looking for a source in the CBI and met Inspector Singh. He was told that his senior officer would help him and would charge a fee for doings so,” an official said.

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## Trump

against Iran this evening,” Trump wrote. “Discussions and final points have been, in both concept and great detail, approved by all parties involved, including the United States, Israel, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Turkey, Pakistan, Bahrain, Kuwait, Jordan, Egypt, and others. The naval blockade will remain in full force and effect until this transaction is finalized — Time and place of the signing to be announced shortly,” he added.

There was no immediate official comment from Iran. But Iran semi-official Pars news agency cited an informed source close to Iran's negotiating team as saying that Tehran has not approved any text for an initial memorandum of understanding with the US. Trump has repeatedly claimed that a deal with Tehran was imminent, only to have its government deny the suggestions.

Earlier in the day, Trump had said the US would hit Iran “very hard tonight” and even added that he wanted at some point to take Iran's oil infrastructure hub Kharg Island, after a second day of strikes by both sides in the Gulf appeared to threaten a return to all-out war.

A fragile ceasefire has been in place since early April. Iranian sources and Western officials

earlier said indirect US-Iranian talks on a preliminary peace deal had intensified, while the renewed hostilities this week undermined prospects for a swift end to the conflict. Oil prices fell sharply after Trump said he had cancelled the US plans to strike Iran, while stocks extended their gains.

Iran's top negotiator Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf had warned against any rash moves following Trump's initial threats.

“Wrong strategies and impulsive decisions will reset the entire board for the worse, explode energy infrastructure and markets and create an endless quagmire that you will be stuck in for years. You will see a different Iran,” he wrote on X.

UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres called on both sides to redouble their efforts “towards a peaceful, comprehensive, and durable agreement that advances regional and international peace and security,” UN spokesperson Stephane Dujarric said. Despite the latest hostilities, three Iranian sources and Western officials said the talks had not yet discussed in detail issues including a mechanism for the release of billions of dollars in frozen Iranian funds. “This war, from a military standpoint, is a dead end. Americans could not achieve their goals by attacking Iran. There has been progress in negotiations,” said one of the Iranian sources. **REUTERS**

## Man in 11A

what I have lost, each day of my life,” says Vishwas.

A British citizen with roots in Diu, Vishwas spoke exclusively to *The Indian Express* in an interaction over phone facilitated by his personal representative and advisor Sanjiv Patel, a motivational speaker based in Leicester.

Having lost his 35-year-old brother Ajay in the crash, Vishwas says he is hoping for some relief from the “final investigation report”, which he insists “is necessary”. “It will help us know what happened, and ensure this does not happen again,” he says.

A month after the crash, the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) released a preliminary report stating that the aircraft's engine fuel control switches transitioned from the “Run” to “Cutoff” position almost immediately after liftoff from Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport. These switches control the flow of jet fuel to the engines.

Last month, Union Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said the final investigation report was in its “final stages” and could be completed within a month, possibly by Friday's one-year mark.

Vishwas credits his family and Patel for keeping him going through the healing process. “I get the strength to deal with the sorrow and shock because of my family and cooperation from Sanjivbhai,” he says.

Vishwas's family ran a fishing business in Diu before most of them moved to the UK. The eldest of four brothers, he lives in Leicester with his wife Hiral, their five-year-old son Divang, his parents Rameshbhai and Jayaben, and youngest brother Nayan.

Vishwas was seated near the emergency exit when the aircraft slammed into the hostel buildings of B.J Medical College. Thrown clear of the wreckage, he was found walking by emergency services personnel, who took him to Ahmedabad Civil Hospital.

However, traumatised by the loss of Ajay, who was a few seats away from Vishwas on that flight, the family reached out to Patel for support. Patel, who is associated with the Bochasanwasi Akshar Purushottam Swaminarayan (BAPS) Sanstha, helped organise a prayer meeting for victims' families on June 15 last year – the Sunday after the crash. The meet was also attended by the representative of King Charles and Lord Lieutenant of Leicestershire Michael Kapur.

“The shraddhanjali was done in a very dignified way. Vishwas's uncle Maheshbhai is a senior figure in the community and they reached out to me,” Patel says, adding that he is also helping at least a dozen British families who lost loved ones in the crash, including with “paperwork”. In all 260 people, including 52 British citizens, were killed – 19 of them on the hostel premises.

“It can't be explained in words... you can't shake this off because of the experience they have been through, including dealing with the anxiety. Trauma is a day-to-day thing for him (Vishwas),” says Patel, who is helping the family pro bono.

The family received an interim compensation of Rs 25 lakh from Air India -- as did other victims' families -- and Air India is also paying for Vishwas's treatment. “So many families are just living with the consequences. It is not just the physical impact or the trauma, but the impact on the whole family,” says Patel.

## Belongings

return the 8,000 identified personal effects, where the next of kin visited by appointment and were given the belongings with “due dignity”, airline officials said.

At the centre, which was active till February, the families were given a 45-day window to browse a related portal, click on images they found familiar, place the items in a “cart” and reconnect with the airline for processing the claim, officials said.

Of the 22,000 personal belongings recovered, around 8,000, including passports and other documents, could be identified. The remaining 14,000 items could not be directly linked to any individual and went to the “unassociated personal belongings” portal.

“Families of 15 of the deceased declined to take the personal belongings. Also, 25 digital devices were recovered, of which 16 have been returned to the families, with remaining cases primarily constituting situations in which documentation is incomplete, or where families have declined to accept personal belongings,” the Air India spokesperson said, adding that the devices are

mostly phones, laptops and tablets.

Among those who did not claim any of the personal belongings was the family of 24-year-old Dirth Patel, a “budding cricketer”. Speaking to this newspaper earlier, Dirth's brother Krutik had said they did not want his mother “to go through the trauma all over again”. In another case, Ahmedabad-based entrepreneur Trupti Soni, who lost her brother and two sisters-in-law in the crash, had described the recovery process as “fatiguing and painful”.

The dead included former Gujarat chief minister Vijay Rupani, who was travelling to join his wife at his daughter home in London; a young father returning to his children after his wife's last rites; a son who had come to surprise his father on Eid; and, a Canadian gay couple in India to celebrate their wedding anniversary.

“Of the associated personal belongings pertaining to 187 deceased, personal belongings have been returned for 139 deceased in India and in the UK, with remaining cases primarily constituting situations in which documentation is incomplete, or where families have declined to accept personal belongings. Associated personal belongings are items

## Third ship

Sonowal, Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways, confirmed the death of three Indian seafarers, reported missing a day earlier from MT Settebello after it was attacked — of the 24 Indians on board, 21 had been rescued.

The Indian Embassy in Muscat said the evacuation of the MT Jalveer crew to Shinas port was coordinated with assistance from the Royal Navy of Oman and all 20 Indians on board had been safely brought to shore.

Claiming that MT Jalveer “attempted to transport oil from Iran through the Gulf of Oman”, the US Central Command said, “A US aircraft fired two Hellfire missiles into the ship's engine room after the crew repeatedly failed to comply with directions from US forces.”

It said the tanker was “disabled” in the Gulf of Oman “after the vessel violated the blockade against Iran by attempting to

transport Iranian oil, marking the third commercial ship disabled by American forces this week”. “Earlier this week, US aircraft disabled Palau-flagged vessels MT Marivex and MT Settebello on Monday and Tuesday, respectively. Marivex violated the blockade by attempting to sail to an Iranian port and Settebello attempted to transport Iranian oil,” the CENTCOM said.

It is learnt that *MT Jalveer* had already been fired at by an American aircraft last month. On May 15, it received warning shots approximately 30 nautical miles off the Oman coast and was directed to turn back toward the Gulf of Oman.

The attacks on commercial vessels, the resumption of military strikes by US and Iran and the issue of maritime security frame both diplomatic and economic challenges for G7 leaders meeting next week at Evian-les-Bains in eastern France — PM Narendra Modi and President Donald Trump will be among world leaders at the meeting.

## Memories

assured us that all the crew

aboard that ship were safely rescued.” Rajesh Sharma, Aditya's father, told *The Indian Express*.

Aditya, 23, was among the three Indian seafarers who were killed after an attack by American forces on MT Settebello off the coast of Oman on June 9 amid the ongoing stand-off over the Strait of Hormuz. Of the 24 Indian seafarers aboard the vessel, 21 were rescued, while three, previously unaccounted for, were eventually declared dead.

“It is deeply unfortunate to learn of the tragic incident aboard the Palau-flagged MT Settebello. Sadly, three Indian seafarers initially reported missing are now confirmed dead after bodies have been located and identified,” Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal said on X. “This is a profound loss to our maritime family. The Modi government stands firmly with the bereaved during this difficult hour and is fully committed to supporting the next of kin. I have

directed officials to ensure immediate repatriation of the rescued crew members and swift return of the mortal remains of the deceased for their final rites.”

Apart from Aditya, the two others who died in the attack are Suresh Patnala, chief engineer, and Shivanand Chaurasiya, Fitter. The US military has said it attacked the tanker after it attempted to “violate” a blockade imposed by US forces outside Hormuz, off the Oman coast.

Aditya's family hails from Hamirpur in Himachal Pradesh, and he had been working on the commercial ship as a deck cadet since November last year. His father said the family had been frantically watching the news after it was reported that their son had gone missing.

“When he joined in November (2025), there was no war. He told us the ship had earlier done the China-Singapore route and was now headed to Oman. He was planning to sign off from Oman in May, but later decided to stay on for another two months,” his father said.

The family learnt of his death after the company operating the Palau-flagged vessel informed them Thursday morning. “We

Modi is undertaking an official visit to France — June 13-14 (Nice), June 16-18 (Evian and Paris) — and Slovakia from June 14-16.

Late Wednesday night, the Ministry of External Affairs had summoned the US charge d'affaires in New Delhi and lodged a protest after the attack on MT Settebello. “We had summoned the US CDA (Jason Meeks) to register a protest on the attack that happened on this commercial vessel off the coast of Oman. Three Indian nationals have died in that incident,” MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

“We have conveyed our deepest concerns on these incidents and the string of attacks happening. And we hope and expect that these would end, these would come to an immediate halt,” he said, underlining “our deep concerns regarding targeting of commercial ships, of marine personnel, as also civilian infrastructure”.

Officials indicated that the issue of maritime security and safety of seafarers will be part of

the conversation at the G7 meeting.

Sibi George, Secretary (West) in the MEA, said, “We have stated our position on the Strait of Hormuz. We would like, we want, and we have urged that there be unimpeded and safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, in keeping with international law. So that is our position. This is a topic which will come up for discussion, and we will put our points across. Also the concerns that we have, arising out of the West Asia situation and developments there.” Officials said that about 3.2 lakh Indian seafarers form the second-largest cohort of seafarers across the world, as part of the shipping industry.

Shipping Ministry's Additional Secretary Mukesh Mangal said sanctions-related guidelines issued for Indian seafarers are only with respect to vessels under United Nations sanctions, and not based on unilateral sanctions by any country.

are told that the concerned embassy has informed the (Indian) government. We do not know if his body has been found. We are waiting for more information,” Rajesh said.

The family now wants the government to intervene and help bring back the body. “I want to know what happened in his last moments. What were the circumstances, what efforts were made to rescue him... whether he got any help? *Usne kitna fight kiya hoga survival ke liye* (He must have fought to survive). People on board were among the first to be rescued,” Sharma said. “Two more sailors who died were also like my children. I just cannot understand why so many lives were put in danger... when there were repeated warnings,” he asked.

In her last conversation with her husband, Suresh Patnala, Bhargavi Suresh told him, “Please be careful.” He replied, “I am careful.” This was on June 9. Two days later, Bhargavi woke up to the news Patnala had gone missing off the coast of Oman.

Bhargavi, 39, said, “I have two young children who are 10 and 13. Who will now look after them? I am a homemaker. How

will I bring them up?” In their last conversation, Patnala had spoken about the “growing tension” in the region. “He was aware there had been other attacks which had killed people around him.”

Ramji Chaurasia (70) and his family were overjoyed when his elder son, 37-year-old Shivanand Chaurasiya, called them up in November last year saying he had secured a welding job aboard an oil tanker.

Shivanand had been working at a welding shop in Pune at the time. Before leaving for Mumbai to join the vessel as Engine Petty Officer (Fitter), he visited his village, Sirauli in UP. On December 5, he left for Singapore on the MT Settebello. Over the past month, however, the family had been worried due to the Iran-US-Israel war.

Ramji said, “It had been over six months since we last saw our son. He had called his wife, Shushila, two days ago and spoke to her and the children — six-year-old son Samar and two-year-old daughter Vamika. He told he would return soon. We were worried as people were talking about the war and how many ships were stranded there.”

## Mamata

High Court granted Abhishek interim protection from any coercive action by the CID for three weeks in a case of alleged signature forgery, while RS MP Prakash Chik Baraik resigned from RS. He is the third TMC Rajya Sabha MP to resign this week.

Sreerampur MP Kalyan Banerjee — whom Mamata reinstated as the party's Lok Sabha chief whip last month — targeted Abhishek after he and his son were replaced as the TMC number two's advocates in the CID case. Mamata, he said, “has to decide whether she will stay with Abhishek or us who are unhappy with him”. Dum Dum MP Sougata Roy, meanwhile, told *The Indian Express* in an interview that one of the grievances against the TMC “relates to the high-handedness of Abhishek Banerjee” and the party chief must tackle that.

“I had said, ‘Do not treat me like a dustbin’; inform me whether I will appear in the case or not. Later, they informed me that Ayan Bhattacharya will fight the case. So, I left. I have 45 years of practice,” Kalyan told reporters.

Continuing his criticism of Abhishek, the veteran leader said, “It is because of him that we have to hear *chor chor* (‘thief thief’) and our life is under threat. Even today, in the party's bad days, I am beside Didi... Mamata Banerjee has to decide whether she will stay with Abhishek or us who are unhappy with him.”

Kalyan Banerjee's son Sirsanya Bandyopadhyay, also an advocate, said they had decided to withdraw their names from the petition by Abhishek. “From May 5, we have been appearing in court in party matters. Around 1 am (on Thursday), we were informed that someone else will appear. So we made a conscious decision to avoid humiliation,” Sirsanya said.

Roy told *Express* that Mamata must listen to the “grievances of people who are still with the party” and heed to the complaints against her nephew. “She must talk to people. If there are grievances against Abhishek Banerjee, she must tackle those also.” Asked what these grievances were, he said, “One grievance relates to the high-handedness of Abhishek Banerjee.”

## ‘Cathedral of football’

when official channels were closed. He went to Tepito — a barrio so notorious that even the police tread carefully. Counterfeit Rolex, fake Gucci, gang shootouts: Tepito has its own rules.

Zelada found twenty blue jerseys, the away kit. They came without the crest. He knew some tailors near the club stadiums. The jerseys were ready in time. “That jersey wouldn't have been more than fifty pesos,” Caledron says. It sold at an auction for \$9.28 million.

Two years before his death, Maradona returned to Mexico. Not to the capital that had made him immortal but to Culiacán — its blood-lit alleys the headquarters of the Sinaloa cartel, El Chapo's city. The jokes wrote themselves.

At his first press conference as the coach of the Mexican second-division football club Dorados de Sinaloa, he didn't deflect. “I had a lot of missteps in my life. I assume this responsibility like someone who holds a child in their arms,” he said.

During a training session, Rubio Rubin — an American forward on the squad — missed his final shot in a finishing drill and began walking off. Mara-

dona called after him. Rubin said he was done. “You don't tend on a miss,” Maradona said, “Always on a goal.” Rubin went back, scored, and was told he could leave. He later recalled the moment to FIFA. Maradona's line stayed with him: you don't end on a miss.

Maradona called the club the family. A staff member said: “He's identified with a city that people thought would be the death of him. Culiacán is rescuing Maradona in an unimaginable way.” When his contract ended and a renewal couldn't be agreed on, there was no bitterness. “I'll leave Culiacán with the best memory in the world,” he said.

Caledron saw him occasionally during those years. “He was the same man, all energy and joy. But the bigger fun was when he visited for Showball — a type of indoor football — in the mid-2000s. The touch never left him.” Outside tunnel eight, the security officer is still at his post. The next group of tourists has found the passage. They are already slowing down, looking in, calculating their chances. Somewhere below them, in a storage room, the Hand of God waits to be restored.

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90% BUILDINGS IN DELHI DO NOT HAVE FIRE NOC, SAYS MINISTER

# Smoke detectors, fire extinguishers could soon be mandatory at homes

**Gayathri Mani**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

CITING THAT 90% of the buildings in the national capital neither have fire NOC nor have safety compliance in place, the Delhi government is planning to tighten enforcement of building by-laws and strengthen fire safety norms by making smoke detectors and extinguishers mandatory across residential areas, including gated societies, individual houses and residential colonies, said Home Minister Ashish Sood.

“It has also come forward that storage of inflammable materials, electric overloading and violations of rules are the leading causes of fire. Beside actions, it is also time we make people aware about the dos and don’ts to prevent fire in houses especially those located in densely populated areas with narrow lanes,” said the minister.

In Delhi, currently fire hydrants and smoke detectors are only mandatory for commercial buildings and those with a

## ● HOW TO MAKE HOMES SAFER

● Look for signs of faulty wiring like frequent circuit trips, dimming or flickering lights. Get systems inspected.

● Install safety devices like circuit breakers.

● Ensure wiring joints are secure; avoid temporary insulation tape, keep electrical installations away from water.



● RWAs should inform nearest fire station about gates that are open at night for quicker access for fire tenders

● Charge lithium batteries only in open, well-ventilated spaces.

● Avoid lifts during a fire.

● Inspect, upgrade wiring “ and electricity meters in older buildings.

● Keep staircases, exits and evacuation routes obstructions-free.

height of 15 metres or above. However, NOCs and other equipment are not mandatory for independent, low-rise buildings and residential properties, said officials.

“This is not about reacting in haste. But when a fire breaks out, basic safety measures such as fire hydrants, smoke detectors and emergency escape ladders can make the difference... Even as we work to strengthen the

city’s fire safety infrastructure, those inside a building are invariably the first to respond. Ensuring that these systems are in place is therefore in everyone’s interest,” Sood also said.

Officials said that following the Vivek Vihar fire tragedy which claimed nine lives last month, the Fire department was asked to submit a proposal to include fire prevention systems, like smoke detectors,

in houses. “The department has submitted its proposal and it is being examined. Under the proposal, the government is mulling to make smoke detectors mandatory in houses. These don’t cost much and run on battery and whenever there is smoke, an alarm will buzz and alert people so they can escape the premises before the fire spreads,” said a senior official, adding that it can also prevent mishaps.

Officials said Sood has directed the Fire department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi to examine building by-laws. They said that the government is also examining the possibility of advising people on less use of inflammable construction materials, asking them not to store those inside the house.

At the four-storey building in Palam where a fire broke out in March killing nine of a family, inflammable materials like thinners, chemicals and paints were stored in the basement.

Another hurdle is said to be crowded, narrow lanes which

makes it difficult for fire tenders to reach the site of a fire. “Thus, the four-minute response window for addressing such situations is crossed... we are making several changes and upgrading our fire infrastructure and planning to increase the number of stations and procurement of small-sized fire tenders that can reach such areas,” said the minister.

Home department officials confirmed that they have received a proposal from the Delhi Fire Services (DFS) for making smoke detectors mandatory in houses.

“We are reviewing the proposal. We believe that this will reduce fire incidents and casualties drastically. It will soon be sent to the Cabinet for further approval,” said the minister.

Sood is also going to write a letter to the residents of Delhi highlighting the importance of fire safety norms and compliance.

As per data, DFS handles over 20,000 fire calls and the city sees 250-300 deaths due to fire every year.

## Lawrence gang fires at Guru Randhawa’s gym

**Pragnesh**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

MULTIPLE BULLETS were fired outside a franchise of singer Guru Randhawa-owned 24 HS gym in Delhi’s Paschim Vihar area on Thursday morning, with the Lawrence Bishnoi gang allegedly claiming responsibility.

Sources said according to a purported post on Facebook, from an alleged account of US-based Lawrence group gangster Anil Pandit, the gang targeted the gym as Randhawa continued to be cordial with Salman Khan despite multiple ‘warnings’.

“All the anti-nationals who are hiding in any part of the world and planning against the country can hide anywhere. They will be killed there,” the purported post said.

Police said they are verifying the post. Officers said two men on a bike fired seven rounds, which shattered the window panes of the gym. The gym is located on the fourth floor of a commercial building. The other floors house popular fast-food chains, which see heavy footfall during most of the day.

In an audio recording, a man, purportedly Pandit, could be heard saying that the firing outside the gym was done on his and Harman Sandhu’s



Guru Randhawa

orders. “Our brother Harry Boxer had called him [the singer] and warned him, but he didn’t understand. This is just the trailer, we will kill him soon,” the man claimed.

A police officer said the bike used by the assailants is being tracked and CCTV footage is being analysed.

This is the second such incident since March, where alleged members of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang have fired near a commercial gym.

In March, unidentified assailants allegedly opened fire at a gym in Southwest Delhi’s Chhawla, days after Rs 2 crore was allegedly demanded from the gym owner in the name of the gang.

The incident happened outside Urban Gym, located on Kanganheri Road, the police had said.

The Paschim Vihar shooting was also the seventh gang-related shooting in the Capital since February.

Armed men rob real estate firm employees of Rs 1.5 crore

**Express News Service**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

TWO MEN allegedly robbed Rs 1.5 crore in cash after intercepting two employees of a Paschim Vihar-based real estate firm near Zakhira flyover in North Delhi on Wednesday, police said. The accused, who were riding a red Pulsar motorcycle, allegedly threatened the victims with a pistol before fleeing with two bags containing the cash, police said. No arrest has been made so far, they said.

Investigators recovered the magazine of the gun from the spot. They said the incident occurred around 2.10 pm when Nitin and Karan, the employees of the firm, were transporting the money to a cash-in-transit service, identified as RK, at Kucha Ghazi Ram in Chandni Chowk. Police said the employees were travelling on a scooter. The accused fled the scene without retrieving the magazine of the pistol that fell on the road.

The employees alerted the police and their employer immediately after the incident.

Police are trying to find out if there was a leak in the information regarding the transfer of the money. An FIR has been filed and further probe in on.

## Nights turn hotter in Capital; IMD says fresh squalls, hail likely today

**Express News Service**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

TWO DAYS after Palam in Delhi recorded a peak wind gust of 120 kmph during a severe thunderstorm, Delhi woke up to another weather extreme on Thursday as the Safdarjung station reported a 7.1 degrees Celsius rise in minimum temperature within 24 hours.

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), the city’s base weather station, Safdarjung, recorded a minimum temperature of 30 degrees Celsius while the maximum settled at 38.7 degrees Celsius. Through the day, thunderstorm alerts were issued which was upgraded to a red alert late night for upto 90 kmph gusty winds. IMD officials noted that light rain and strong winds were reported over Gurgaon and Northwest Delhi late night. Humidity at Safdarjung ranged between 29% and 59% over the past 24 hours. Across Delhi-NCR, minimum temperatures were mostly in the 28 to 31 degrees Celsius range, with Najafgarh at 31.5 degrees Celsius, Ayanagar at 30.6 degrees Celsius and Pusa at 30.2 degrees.

On June 9, Palam recorded peak winds of 120 kmph, a record-equaling gust for the station, while Pusa logged 80 kmph and Safdarjung 64



According to IMD, Delhi recorded a minimum temperature of 30 degrees Celsius while the maximum settled at 38.7 degrees Celsius. AMIT MEHRA

kmph during the same storm episode.

Intense daytime heating, warm night conditions, and volatile storms, however, are common during the pre-monsoon period.

Thursday’s warm night comes during a month that has historically delivered some of Delhi’s most extreme weather. IMD records since 2011 show June has regularly reported temperatures above 44 degrees, while rainfall totals can vary from barely 10 mm in dry years to more than 240 mm in wet years. The month marks the transition between peak summer heat and the onset of monsoon-

driven thunderstorms, resulting in rapid shifts in temperature, humidity and wind conditions.

### The week ahead

At the national scale, the southwest monsoon advanced further on June 11 into more parts of Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, remaining parts of Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, more parts of West Bengal and some parts of Bihar. This is forecast to advance to Delhi by June 30.

As a result of the storm’s activity, temperatures are likely to fall to 34-36 degrees Celsius by Friday. Minimum temperatures are forecast to drop to 23-25 degrees Celsius on June 12 and 13.

IMD has forecast thunder squalls over Haryana-Chandigarh-Delhi, Punjab and Rajasthan during June 11-12, with wind speeds of 60-70 kmph gusting to 80 kmph. Isolated hailstorm activity is also likely over Haryana-Chandigarh-Delhi and parts of north-west India during the same period.

By June 13, Delhi is expected to remain partly cloudy with another spell of very light to light rain, thunderstorm and winds gusting up to 60 kmph. On June 14, the city is likely to see partly cloudy skies with the possibility of thundery development towards afternoon or evening, the IMD also said.

### ● Skywatch



**Forecast: June 12, 2026**  
Cloudy sky. Light rain, thunderstorm, lightning

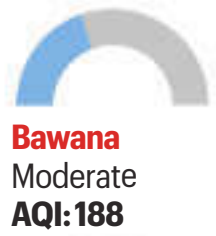
**MAX: 34-36**  
3.9°C below normal

**MIN: 23-25**  
3°C below normal

•Sunrise: 5:23 AM (June 13)  
•Sunset: 7:20 PM (June 12)

•Moonrise: 3:11AM (June 13)  
•Moonset: 4:23 PM (June 12)

### ● AQI Tracker



● Good (0-50)  
● Satisfactory (51-100)  
● Moderate (101-200)  
● Poor (201-300)  
● Very Poor (301-400)  
● Severe (401-500)

## Cool roofs, weather alerts system: Gurgaon’s Rs 5-crore plan to tackle urban warming

**Abhimanyu Hazarika**  
*Gurgaon, June 11*

INSTALLATION OF cool and green roofs in residential and public buildings; setting up more hydration points and public toilets; exploring revival of traditional water bodies and upgradation of weather monitoring systems — these are among the highlights of the Municipal Corporation of Gurugram’s (MCG) Rs 5-crore plan that aims to tackle urban heat in Gurgaon, said officials.

The civic body on Thursday signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA) to mitigate the growing impact of extreme heat and the Urban Heat Island (UHI) effect, which refers to significantly higher temperatures in cities as compared to nearby rural areas.

Gurgaon is among 12 cities selected for a pilot project — ‘Heat Resilient Cities’ — under the Centre’s AMRUT 2.0 reforms, with each of them backed by a Rs 5 crore grant from the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA). To be implemented over a 15-month period, the primary objective of the project is to enable cities to become heat-resilient, climate-responsive, and inclusive through

evidence-based planning and direct, on-ground interventions, officials said.

The memorandum outlines specific “Climate Adaptation Measures” that the MCG must undertake.

MCG Commissioner Pradeep Dahiya said the initiative will play an important role in making the city more capable of dealing with the effects of climate change, as well as improving the standard of living for citizens. “Through scientific data, modern technology, innovation, and public participation, the path to reducing the impact of heat in the city and promoting sustainable development will be paved. This project is an important initiative towards preparing Gurgaon for future climate challenges,” he said.

Under the prescribed framework, the Rs 5-crore grant will fund installation of cool roofs, green roofs, hydration points, public toilets, and shaded public areas. The civic body is also expected to implement “Nature-based Solutions,” which include reviving traditional waterbody systems and heritage campuses to naturally cool neighbourhoods. “Climate Mitigation Measures” like mapping and reducing energy demand, reducing pollution hotspots, and optimising mobility density at heat hotspots will be explored too.

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**Director (Technical)**  
**UP Renewable and EV Infrastructure Limited (UPREV)**



## DELHI GOVT PREPARES REHABILITATION PLAN FOR PEOPLE LIVING ON YAMUNA FLOODPLAINS

## 1 lakh flats needed for 5L living in O-Zone, 18,000 identified so far

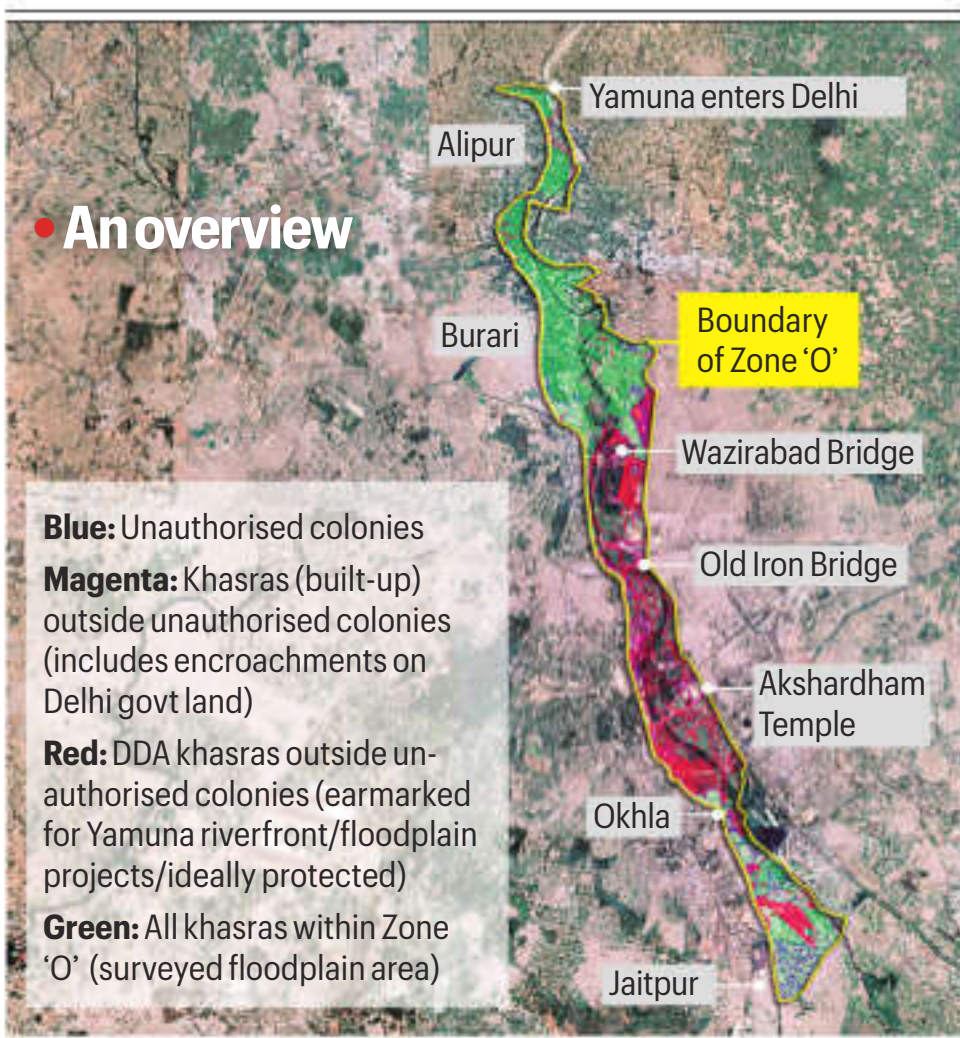
Sophiya Mathew  
New Delhi, June 11

WITH MORE than five lakh people living in the unauthorised colonies in the Yamuna floodplain's O-Zone, eco-sensitive areas along the river where construction is prohibited, the Delhi government has started work on a possible rehabilitation plan and has identified 18,084 flats meant for the economically weaker sections (EWS) across six locations in the Capital even as at least 1 lakh units are needed, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Last month, the Delhi High Court on May 23 had observed that residential colonies in the O-Zone are “completely impermissible”, while noting that 91 unauthorised colonies in the area continue to enjoy temporary protection from punitive action until December 31 under the National Capital Territory of Delhi Laws (Special Provisions) Second Act, 2011. This was after the Centre submitted that occupants of the 91 unauthorised colonies are protected from demolition until December 31.

Sources have now told *The Indian Express* that the Delhi government is coordinating with the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) for the rehabilitation efforts, which involve housing under the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB). The existing units are spread across six locations — Sultanpuri, Savda Ghewra, Bhalswa, and three sites in Dwarka.

A total of 108.61 acres of land is available with DUSIB for rehabilitation, with the largest in Bhalswa having 7,400 EWS



units. Savda Ghewra is another major rehabilitation site where 37.81 acres of land is available with 7620 units. Dwarka's three sites — spanning around 12 acres in total — have more than 2,000 dwelling units whereas Sultanpuri has 6.85 acres land with 1,060 dwelling units.

A senior government official told *The Indian Express*, “The Delhi government is upgrading and repairing the current EWS flats using funds under the Pradhan Mantri-Unauthorised Colonies in Delhi Awas Yojana. The relocation will likely take place in Burari, Sultanpuri, and Savda Ghewra. The work is going on and we are expediting it so that the flats are ready.”

These units were built earlier under EWS housing and slum rehabilitation schemes, including the Jawaharlal

Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission, but many remained vacant or unoccupied for years, according to officials. Government records show that low occupancy was linked to restrictive eligibility norms, lack of peripheral infrastructure and residents' apprehension over losing livelihoods after relocation.

On Tuesday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced that no demolition would be carried out on existing constructions in the colonies and maintained that the High Court's concerns were related to only fresh or ongoing construction activity.

As per the May 23 order, D Thara, Additional Secretary MoHUA, told the court as cited in the 23 May order, “...There is discussion in respect of rehabilitation of these villages and residents as well. Since there

are approximately 5 to 6 lakh people living in these 91 colonies, which would translate into at least 1 lakh houses, a detailed strategy would have to be worked out.”

The MoHUA had also clarified to the court that under the National Capital Territory of Delhi Laws (Special Provisions) Act, the unauthorised colonies within the O-Zone are temporarily protected from punitive action until December 31. No ownership is granted in such land, as per existing regulations.

Recent court submissions have also shown that fresh unauthorised construction in JagatPur Village, Wazirabad Village, Ram Ghat in Wazirabad and New Aruna Nagar near Majnu Ka Tilla have been recorded, alongside enforcement activity in recent months including demolition drives by the DDA in Madanpur Khadar, Jhangola and Revenue Estate-Indraprastha, reclaiming around seven acres.

Bhim Singh Rawat, an environment activist and a member of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People, a nonprofit, said the “status of O-Zone must be kept intact”. He added that the floodplain has “many layers”, including old villages. Farmers and nursery workers who have lived with periodic floods were made more vulnerable after embankments came up, he claimed. He said the embankments and subsequent infrastructure such as bridges, roads, flyovers and barrages have already narrowed the river and its floodplain, while also enabling large-scale encroachment by unauthorised

colonies and government-backed constructions, including areas such as Sonia Vihar, Batla House, Jaitpur, Akshardham and the CWG Village. “Permanent construction must be removed considering overall structural safety of buildings, flood impact on people and safeguarding the hydrological as well as ecological functions of Yamuna floodplain,” Rawat said, adding that any removal of encroachment requires “a holistic and humane approach” with detailed relocation planning, beginning with “government-created and sponsored encroachments”.

The O-Zone has remained in headlines since the National Green Tribunal's (NGT) landmark judgement on January 13, 2015, in the Manoj Misra v. Union of India case.

In a submission to the tribunal, the DDA on February 26 this year said it mapped out that the total delineated O-Zone spanned 9,700 hectares of land. Within this sensitive ecological boundary, there are 90 officially mapped unauthorised colonies occupying approximately 807 hectares, it said. Of this, 3,969.54 hectares is directly owned by the DDA in this zone, and roughly 184.2 hectares are actively encroached upon by these unauthorised settlements. To finalise the eviction boundaries and prevent any new illegal constructions, the DDA also told the NGT in April this year that it is conducting a comprehensive drone survey to map 165 square kilometre area, covering the entire 22-km stretch of the Yamuna floodplain and its buffer zones within the city.

## Nigerian woman jumps to death during raid to bust drug manufacturing unit

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

The raid was carried out on Thursday afternoon.

AN NIGERIAN woman died after allegedly jumping from the fourth floor of a residential building in Outer Delhi's Swarop Nagar during a search operation to bust a drug manufacturing unit on Thursday afternoon, said police. The alleged synthetic drug manufacturing unit was unearthed during a raid by the Anti-Narcotics Squad of the Outer North district, officers added.

During the operation, officers said, a man identified as Romeo alias Sky was also arrested from the third floor of the residential building. Approximately 30 grams of banned methamphetamine and 1.5 grams of heroin were allegedly recovered from his possession.

Investigators then moved to the fourth floor, where two African nationals were residing in separate flats. One of the flats was occupied by a woman identified as Stella Pius. An officer said, “When the police team entered the flat, Stella allegedly jumped from the balcony. She was immediately shifted to the government hospital in Burari, where she was declared brought dead,” the officer said.

From the possession of another African national, identified as Martin Aarón, who was her neighbour, police recovered the key to unlock the alleged drug unit at Stella's flat. According to police, the room contained a large quantity of chemicals, laboratory equipment and other material allegedly used in the manufacture of synthetic drugs. “The premises appeared to be functioning as a metham-

phetamine manufacturing and raw material storage facility,” the officer said.

Madhur Verma, Joint Commissioner of Police, said, “In accordance with the Centre's Nasha Mukti Bharat campaign, the Delhi Police is committed to carrying out comprehensive investigations to ensure that every source, supplier, and network involved in the trafficking of illicit substances, narcotics, and contraband is exposed and brought to justice. This operation represents a major breakthrough, and further investigation is being conducted to uncover the entire supply chain and identify all those involved.”

Among other items recovered during the raid were approximately 100 litres of unidentified chemical substances, 10 litres of hydrochloric acid, 31 bottles containing around 15.5 litres of hypophosphorous acid, six empty bottles of the same chemical, 35.5 kg of a white powder, 21 kilograms of black granules, 4.1 kilograms of black liquid and 192 grams of MDMA, said officers.

Police also seized two heating mantles, two 2,000-ml flasks, two distillation units, two weighing machines, several drums, steel tubs, plastic pipes,

a large stove and a gas cylinder.

Samples of the seized substances have been sent for forensic examination. Police are investigating the source of the chemicals, the scale of the alleged operation and the role of those involved.

Police said the raid was conducted as part of the investigation into an Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) case registered at Burari police station earlier this week. On June 9, acting on a tip-off, the Anti-Narcotics Cell had arrested a Nigerian national, Frank Dashmond, from the Chandan Vihar area of Burari and recovered 67.9 grams of MDMA from his possession, according to officers. A case under the NDPS Act was registered and Dashmond was subsequently arrested.

According to investigators, leads developed during the questioning of Dashmond led police to Swarop Nagar, resulting in the latest arrests and the discovery of the suspected drug manufacturing facility on Thursday. Further investigation is ongoing. “The proceedings into Stella Pius's death are being conducted by Swarop Nagar police station in Outer North district,” said the officer.

## Signature Bridge audit: PWD gives nod for a consultant

Gayathri Mani  
New Delhi, June 11

TO ENSURE the structural stability of the Signature Bridge, the Public Works Department (PWD) has approved a proposal to engage a consultant to conduct a comprehensive structural audit and preparation of maintenance methodology of the city's first asymmetrical bridge, inaugurated in 2018.

PWD minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said, “Public safety is our highest priority. It is surprising that no structural audit of the Signature Bridge was conducted in the last seven years. This landmark structure suffered from years of neglect under the previous government. To ensure its long-term safety and stability, we have decided to appoint an expert consultant for a comprehensive structural assessment.” The consultant will also examine the slanting lifts and assess the feasibility of making them operational for public use. Based on the report, necessary steps will be taken for repairs, rehabilitation and maintenance, Singh told *The Indian Express*.

The Signature Bridge project was executed by the Delhi Tourism and Transport Development Corporation (DTTDC).

The DTTDC, however, did not have the budget for its maintenance, and after several request made by it, the bridge was finally handed over to the PWD earlier this year.

According to an official document, the cost of engaging a consultant is Rs 17.5 lakh. The consultancy will include a detailed structural safety and stability assessment of the bridge. A comprehensive maintenance methodology, including recommendations for preventive, periodic and long-term measures, will also be part of it.

The PWD also directed the engineer in charge to ensure that the consultancy services are completed on time. “No cost escalation will be entertained without prior approval of the competent authority,” read the document. A senior PWD official said that after taking over the bridge from DTTDC, PWD carried out an internal audit and found that the surface and grills and side railings of the bridge were damaged and the street lights were not functional.

Following that, the department took immediate measures like eradicating dark spots by fixing streetlights. Besides, patch works were carried out on the road surface and potholes were repaired, said officials.

## NewsClick cases quashed: Why Delhi HC rejected 5 key allegations

Sohini Ghosh  
New Delhi, June 11

THE TWO cases against digital news portal NewsClick and its founder Prabir Purkayastha quashed by the Delhi High Court dealt with allegations of money laundering. The cases from 2020 were filed by the Delhi Police's Economic Offences Wing (EOW) and the Enforcement Directorate.

The EOW FIR had alleged foreign direct investment (FDI) was received by PPK NewsClick Studio Private Limited, which owns NewsClick, from Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, US, (WWMH) during 2018-19, in violation of FDI norms and other laws. Through the FDI, WWMH -- a Delaware-incorporated for-profit company -- came to hold 76.9% shares of PPK NewsClick Studio.

The EOW FIR was lodged on August 26, 2020. The ED's ECIR (equivalent to FIR) was lodged on September 2, 2020. Here are the five key allegations and what the HC said:

**FDI violations**

According to the probe agencies, NewsClick allegedly overvalued its shares to avoid the 26% cap on FDI for digital media platforms. Notably, this cap was only introduced in September 2019 after the invest-

ment was made.

FDI violations were alleged under the Foreign Exchange Management (Transfer or Issue of Security by a Person Resident Outside India) Regulations, 2017 (FEMA), although the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had given its clearance that the FDI was in compliance with regulations. While the EOW mentioned the RBI's stance in a status report, it subsequently withdrew it.

On this, the court of Justice Neena Bansal Krishna observed, “This (RBI) correspondence, though mentioned in the unserved Status Report, was subsequently withdrawn, but is sufficient to explain that there were no violations by petitioner...”

**FDI 'siphoned'**

The news portal was accused of “siphoning” of “more than 45%” of the FDI and citing that it had incurred “huge losses” due to “excessive payment of consultancy, salary and rent”, and other expenses of promoters, journalists, and employees associated with the company.

The court threw out this allegation. Justice Krishna recorded, “When a company is functioning, especially in the business of digital print media, such expenses are bound to

occur...”

**Company voided**

Another allegation was that WWMH was voided in June 2017 and the transaction received fraudulent.

NewsClick had pointed out that as per Delaware incorporation laws, once a company is voided, a new company can seek incorporation under the same name, which is the case here. It was pointed out that WWMH was incorporated in November 2017, making the transaction legal and valid.

Justice Krishna observed, “There is nothing which has come out in the investigation of the State that M/s Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, with which the petitioner had dealings, was a non-existing company. In fact, the status report is completely silent on this aspect.”

**Cheating, criminal breach of trust claims**

Justice Krishna observed that the key ingredients which make up the offences of cheating and criminal breach of trust are not made out. “For offence of cheating, it is necessary that there must be an aggrieved person who has been cheated out of his valuable property. In this case, M/s Worldwide Media Holdings LLC is the entity

which had forwarded 1.5 million USD to the petitioner. However, there is no complaint whatsoever by the company about having been cheated by the petitioner...”

Similarly, the court also dismissed the criminal breach of trust charge.

**'Criminal conspiracy' charge**

The ED alleged money laundering relying on criminal conspiracy, one of the scheduled offences, which was alleged in the predicate offence -- the EOW FIR. The central probe agency alleged criminal conspiracy is clearly made out as the amount of Rs 9.59 crore (USD 1.5 million) was brought into India “in the garb of investment in digital media”, carried out by Purkayastha in connivance with Jason Pfletcher (manager of WWMH) and Neville Roy Singham (American businessman and investor). The court dismissed this argument. Justice Krishna noted, “From the ED's response, it is evident they are trying to claim that the offence under Section 120B IPC is still made out.

However, on what basis the criminal conspiracy is being alleged is not explained, except that Purkayastha and Pfletcher had entered into an agreement.”

## Rs 5K-crore fake medicine racket case: IPS officer summoned for questioning

Mahender Singh Manral  
New Delhi, June 11

DAYS AFTER arresting two men, including a Delhi Police inspector, in an alleged Rs 5,000-crore counterfeit medicine racket, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Thursday summoned a 2012-batch IPS officer of the Haryana cadre for questioning.

The IPS officer, who has not been named, is currently serving as a regional director with the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), said a source. He had allegedly demanded a bribe of Rs 3 crore from N Raja alias Valliappan alias Rajasekar, the main accused in the alleged racket running out of Pucherry, as he assured him that he had connections in the CBI and could arrange relief for him in some cases.

“We have identified him... and we have summoned him, after informing his department, to find out more details about the case,” a source said.

On June 8, the CBI had registered an FIR against Raja, Pradeep Kumar Singh, an inspector with the Delhi Police Crime Branch's Southern Range, and Rajkumar alias Madhanraj, who allegedly acted as an intermediary.

Among others, the FIR also mentions an unidentified public servant. “Raja had allegedly arranged a bribe of Rs 1 crore through hawala transaction. Pradeep Kumar Singh received the payment through a hawala operator and gave it to one Prabhath, who knew an IPS officer. Singh kept Rs 25 lakh in his house... CBI had arrested Singh and Rajkumar with Rs 24.70 lakh,” the central agency said.

The amount was the first instalment of a larger payoff, according to CBI. A source said that according to the FIR, Singh allegedly conspired with other accused, and indulged in corrupt activities by facilitating the payment of illegal gratification to secure undue relief in the CBI cases. He also claimed he had influence over investigating officers and other public servants connected with the probe.

## Delhi cop booked for assaulting woman and trespassing into Gurgaon society

Express News Service  
Gurgaon, June 11

A DELHI Police constable has been booked for allegedly trespassing into a residential society, issuing death threats to a family, and physically assaulting a 21-year-old woman in Gurgaon, officers said on Thursday.

According to the FIR registered in the case, the accused allegedly entered an apartment complex in a highly intoxicated state between 5 am and 6:30 am on May 31.

The woman, also the complainant in the case, alleged that the accused repeatedly rang the doorbell of her apartment. When her mother opened the door, he allegedly attempted to force his way inside, hurling abuses and issuing death threats. The situation escalated when the accused, according to the complainant, verbally abused her younger sister and threatened her with “rape and murder”.

The woman said that she was returning from a function when her mother informed her about the incident. She alleged that the accused subsequently intercepted her within the society premises.

The FIR states that the accused allegedly abused her, issued death threats, and even physically assaulted her before her friends intervened. The complainant underwent a medical examination after alerting the police.

In her complaint, the woman claimed that a similar incident happened in September last year, leading to the registration of another FIR against the accused.

The FIR in the case was registered under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for voluntarily causing hurt, wrongful restraint, house-trespass after preparation for hurt, assault or wrongful restraint, criminal intimidation and word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman. The complainant's counsel said that the accused's bail plea was dismissed on Wednesday and he is currently in judicial custody.

## ● YEAR AFTER BSP LEADER WAS SHOT DEAD IN HIS CAR

## Gangster accused of killing BSP leader extradited from Georgia

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

LAST YEAR, in January, Haryana Police arrested five alleged shooters within three days — Sagar, Rajan, Mangru, Gagan and Shivam. All five men were wanted for allegedly shooting dead Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) leader Harbilash Hajjumaajra inside his car in Ambala on January 24, 2025.

Even as the police had zeroed on the suspected gangster behind the killing due to purported social media posts, the statements of the five shooters confirmed the name — Vainkat Garg (29), an ally of Kapil

Sangwan Aka Nandu, the notorious gangster based out of the United Kingdom.

However, about a month before he allegedly executed his most infamous murder, Garg had allegedly fled India. The gangster, following his arrest after registration of 23 cases against him in Chandigarh and Haryana, had got out on bail in October 2024 and escaped. The first case filed against him dated back to 2016, said officers.

“Investigation conducted by STF Haryana revealed that Vainkat Garg fled India on December 10, 2024, from the Indira Gandhi International Air-



The accused in custody.

port, New Delhi, to the United Arab Emirates and subsequently travelled to Georgia on January 26, 2025,” read a statement by Haryana Police.

To stay in Georgia, officers

said, he only needed proof of residence in UAE, as per the East European country's laws. “From Georgia, he established contact with Kapil Sangwan. Most gangs in Delhi were consolidating and forming alliances back then. Garg did the same,” a police officer said.

Year-long efforts by the Indian authorities have finally led to his extradition. The CBI, in coordination with the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), and the Haryana Police.

A team from Haryana Police reached Tbilisi five days back and he was brought back to

Delhi on Thursday.

At present, he is allegedly involved in at least 34 cases. Of these, 11 are linked to crimes perpetrated from foreign soil. Police say his involvement is suspected in many more.

Born in Chandana Colony of Narayangarh area of Ambala in Haryana, Garg initially got involved with local gangs. He managed to scale his network to a 53-member network based in the NCR, with cases of Arms Act, extortion and murder filed against the members.

Haryana Police wasn't the only one who tried to bring Garg back.

“About six months back, the

Delhi Police had found him involved in the murder of a businessman in Paschim Vihar area of Delhi. The businessman was suspected of being close to Kapil Sangwan's rival, Manjeet Mahal, and was looking after some of his properties. The Delhi Police had requested the MEA to revoke Garg's passports along with those of nine other criminals,” said a police officer.

Apart from the above case, Garg was allegedly involved in recruiting and directing shooters around the Delhi-NCR area. After the killing of the BSP leader, sources said that his gang had become more active in the Capital.



# Indian Navy removes unexploded missile warhead from Kochi-bound oil tanker

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

THE INDIAN Navy has successfully completed a complex operation which involved the recovery and safe disposal of an unexploded missile warhead from the crude oil tanker when it was on way to Kochi after suffering damage off the coast of Oman.

The Marshall Islands-flagged tanker MT Olympic Life, did not have any Indian national onboard, the Navy said in a statement on Thursday, adding that it was on passage from Fujairah, UAE, to Kochi when it reported an explosion in its hull, while off the coast of Oman on May 26, 2026.

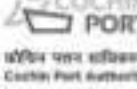
The vessel reported the presence of an unexploded ordnance as it continued its transit towards Kochi, the Navy statement noted.

“On receipt of information through the Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR), the Indian Navy initiated a coordinated response,” it said.

It added that Kochi-based Southern Naval Command deployed a specialist Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD)



Indian Navy team extracted an unexploded missile warhead lodged inside crude oil tanker MT Olympic Life, while off the coast of Oman on May 26. PTI

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team for a detailed assessment. The team confirmed that a projectile had penetrated the vessel's hull, traversed multiple structural compartments and was lodged inside a fuel tank.

“In view of the risks associated with the presence of an unexploded missile warhead inside a fuel storage compartment, the EOD team adopted a deliberate and phased approach to ensure the safety of the ship, its crew and surrounding port infrastructure,” it said.

According to the Navy, after completion of prescribed safety procedures, the EOD team employed advanced diagnostic methods to identify and isolate the detonation mechanism before carrying out the safe extraction of the

warhead along with the associated debris.

“The recovered ordnance has been transported to a secure facility for safe storage and detailed examination,” said an officer.

The Navy said that this highly risky operation, highlights the Indian Navy's proficiency in explosive ordnance disposal, technical expertise and effective inter-agency co-ordination in addressing complex maritime contingencies.

“The Indian Navy's prompt response to an emergency at sea, irrespective of the nationality of the crew or the ownership of the vessel, reaffirms its role as a responsible maritime force dedicated to global maritime safety and a trusted and preferred security partner in the region,” it noted.

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| 2      | Thermogravimetric Analysis (1 No.)                        | GEM/2026/B/7558263 & 20-05-2026 | 30-06-2026 & 14:30:00   |
| 3      | Three Target DC & RF Magnetron Sputtering Machine (1 No.) | GEM/2026/B/7618887 & 08-06-2026 | 30-06-2026 & 14:30:00   |

The details are available on the GeM Portal. Firms must submit their offer only through the GeM Portal in two bid system. The bid document is also available for viewing on the website of DTU, [www.dtu.ac.in](http://www.dtu.ac.in). For any query, please contact us at the telephone no. 011-27871018.

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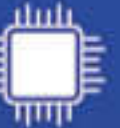
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## Taking the LEAD

BJP's RAJYA Sabha member Dr Ajeet Madhavrao Gopchade has started a fellowship — MP LEAD (Legislative Exposure & Administrative Development) — to provide young students with first-hand exposure to governance and public administration. Under this initiative, 40 undergraduate and PG students, including girls and tribal youth, have been selected through a competitive process. Beginning June 17, the participants will spend one month in New Delhi, where they will be attached to MPs, MLAs, and Councilors to gain practical insights into legislative functioning. Gopchade started the initiative following PM Narendra Modi's call for bringing one lakh youth from non-political families into politics.

## Nothing Personal

INSIDE THE TMC fort, which is falling like a house of cards, not all love is lost among the party MPs who find themselves on opposite sides. A senior TMC MP from team Mamata Banerjee has been telling journalists in the Capital not to use personal details of some of the rebel MPs. A "request" for this has been made to journalists of Bengali as well as national media organisations by the TMC leader, who insists personal lives of people should not be dragged into any professional discord.

## Special Greetings

KICKING OFF the two-day BRICS Urbanisation Forum 2026 in the Capital, Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal made it a point to greet all the visiting dignitaries in their language. Welcoming the ministers and officials from BRICS nations, Lal read out the greetings in 10 languages, including Russian, Chinese and Persian, besides the regular "good morning, suprabhat" in English and Hindi.

## Change of Plan

THE CONGRESS high command on Thursday called two of its senior leaders — UP Congress general secretary Avinash Pande and state chief Ajay Rai — who were in the Capital to attend a party event at Indira Bhawan, for a separate meeting on the upcoming UP Assembly polls. Sources said the meeting was scheduled for 5 pm, but Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge had to suddenly leave for Karnataka and the programme was postponed indefinitely. Rai leaves for Mathura on Friday for a payatra to the Vrindavan Temple. He is ready to return to Delhi whenever the high command calls him for a discussion, said the sources.

## Won't leave Mamata in her tough times: Shatrughan

ENS & PTI  
Kolkata, June 11

SHATRUGHAN SINHA said Thursday he would remain with the Trinamool Congress and continue to support party chief Mamata Banerjee despite recent turbulence from the party. Sinha's assertion came after his name featured in a purported list of rebel TMC MPs circulating online. The former Union minister, who has been with the BJP in past, also posted on X on congratulating PM Modi on completing 12 years in office.

Responding to the buzz, Sinha, in an interview to *PTI* said he would not leave Banerjee at a time when the party faces challenges. "I will not leave Mamata Banerjee in her difficult time. She stood by me when I was facing a tough time after losing the election in Patna," Sinha told *PTI*. "I am issuing a three-line whip to myself — I was with the TMC and Mamata ji, I am with the TMC and Mamata ji, and I will stay with the TMC and Mamata ji. I have no intention of going anywhere," he said.

Sinha said some leaders may have left the party due to "compulsions, fears or allurement" but added that he would remain with the TMC. "I am grateful to those who invited me to join the TMC rebel group, but my principled stand is I should stand by Mamata Banerjee..."

## HC GRANTS HIM INTERIM PROTECTION FROM ARREST FOR THREE WEEKS

# Abhishek questioned for over 5 hours in signature forgery case

Tanusree Bose  
& Sweety Kumari  
Kolkata, June 11

TMC NATIONAL general secretary Abhishek Banerjee was questioned for over five hours by the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) of West Bengal Police on Thursday evening in connection with the MLAs' signature forgery case.

The Diamond Harbour MP, who had skipped the CID summons thrice earlier, citing illness and his petition in the High Court against the probe, appeared before the probe agency hours after the Calcutta High Court granted him interim protection from arrest in connection with the ongoing police probe into the signature forgery case.

He reached the CID headquarters, Bhabani Bhawan, around 5.50 pm, soon after he landed in Kolkata on his return from New Delhi, where he had gone to attend the INDIA bloc meeting along with his aunt and party chief Mamata Banerjee.

He left the CID headquarters around 11.30 pm and did not speaking to the waiting media persons.

The CID is probing the allegations of forged signatures of TMC MLAs in a party letter to the Assembly Speaker, recommend-



TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee arrives at the CID headquarters in Kolkata for questioning on Thursday. EXPRESS

ing the appointment of Sovandeb Chatterjee as the Leader of Opposition. TMC rebels Ritabrata Banerjee and Sandipan Saha had allegedly told Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari that signatures of some of the MLAs in the letter to the Speaker were forged, triggering a probe by the CID. On Tuesday, the CID team had carried out searches at the TMC office and former chief minister Mamata Banerjee's Kalighat residence.

Earlier in the day, the single bench of Justice Kaushik Chandra granted Abhishek interim relief for three weeks while asking him to cooperate with the investigating agency.

The High Court asked Abhishek

to appear before the CID by 6 pm on Thursday.

"This Court is further of the view that, for the purpose of securing or recovering any document relevant to the investigation, the Investigating Agency remains at liberty to resort to search and seizure or to adopt any other measure permissible in law. The petitioner (Abhishek), however, cannot be compelled to be a witness against himself," Justice Chandra stated in the order.

In the interim order, the High Court asked Abhishek to fully cooperate with the investigation, adding, "The Investigating Agency shall be at liberty to interrogate the petitioner (Ab-

hishek) in accordance with law... In the event the petitioner's further presence is required, the Investigating Agency shall issue at least 48 hours' prior notice to the petitioner. The petitioner shall thereafter appear before the Investigating Agency as and when required."

"The Investigating Agency shall not take any coercive steps against the petitioner for a period of three weeks from the date," the High Court ordered, listing the matter after two weeks.

Meanwhile, the West Bengal CID has taken over the investigation into alleged inflammatory statements by TMC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee during the Assembly election campaign, a senior police officer said on Thursday. "A formal order has been issued transferring the investigation to the CID. The case diary, documents and digital evidence collected so far have been handed over to the agency for further investigation," a senior police officer told *PTI*.

The FIR was lodged based on a complaint filed by one Rajib Sarkar in North 24 Parganas district. Sarkar had alleged that the MP made provocative comments on post-poll violence and the vote counting process.

(WITH PTI INPUTS)

## TMC Lok Sabha rebels waiting for a senior MP to join ranks

Liz Mathew  
New Delhi, June 11

THE REBEL faction of the Trinamool Congress (TMC) in Lok Sabha, led by veteran party leader Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, is expecting a big name to join the camp before it writes to Speaker Om Birla, seeking recognition for the bloc, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

While the rebel camp has been "in touch" with one such senior MP, "the signature is yet to be added", a source said.

It has been three days since the TMC implosion in the Lok Sabha began, prompting claims and counterclaims on who is on the list of rebels. One of the reasons why the rebels have not written to Birla yet is the wait for a "political heavyweight", sources said, adding that this would boost the "credibility" of the rebel camp and add heft to its challenge against Mamata Banerjee.

Senior TMC MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who is leading the mutiny, has claimed that 20 out of 28 Trinamool MLAs in Lok Sabha want to be recognised as a separate bloc and align with the NDA. Asked what pushed the Trinamool MPs into rebellion, she told *The Indian Express*, "There was rampant corruption, misgovernance and there was no democracy. We have left the party because we want to survive in public life and continue in public service."

Asked what the plan ahead for the rebels is, she replied, "As of now we have decided to be with the NDA, giving it full support. Later, we (rebel MPs) will sit together and decide what kind of support it should be."

## NITI AAYOG MEET

# Base MBBS admissions on Class 12 marks: Vijay



CM C Joseph Vijay leaves Tamil Nadu House in New Delhi to attend the NITI Aayog Governing Council Meeting on Thursday. ANI

Harikishan Sharma  
New Delhi, June 11

AMID CONTROVERSY over the NEET-UG paper leak, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday demanded that his state be permitted to fill all seats under the state quota in MBBS, BDS, and AYUSH courses based "solely" on Class 12 marks.

Vijay raised the demand during the 11th meeting of the Governing Council of NITI Aayog, which was chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Opposing the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET), Vijay said that the government of Tamil Nadu is committed to protecting the rights of students. "The State is opposed to the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET) for admission to undergraduate medical and dental courses, as its introduction has affected the students from rural and socio-economically disadvantaged families. In view of the above, the Government of Tamil Nadu may be permitted to fill all seats under the State quota in MBBS, BDS, and AYUSH courses based solely on Class XII marks," he said.

Vijay's demand for allowing admission based on Class 12 marks comes at a time when the government has been facing

criticism following the NEET-UT paper leak. The National Testing Agency (NTA) will conduct the Re-NEET UG 2026 on June 21 (Sunday). On NEET, Vijay's stand is in line with his predecessor MK Stalin's.

Vijay also sought the Centre's support in "creating world-class start-up incubators, a venture capital ecosystem for deep-tech enterprises, and enhanced funding for applied research", and demanded release of the Central assistance to the state.

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy is learnt to have demanded to set up "M-6 Task Force" under the leadership of the Prime Minister for the development of six major economic growth engines of the country — Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru. He is learnt to have suggested creation of a special fund of Rs 6 lakh crore, with an allocation of Rs 1 lakh crore each to strengthen urban infrastructure in these cities.

Reddy also met the PM and submitted a memorandum seeking the Government of India's support for a range of strategic infrastructure, education, industrial and connectivity projects critical to Telangana's growth and India's journey towards Viksit Bharat 2047, said a source.

## AGAINST PRICE RISE, PAPER LEAK

# Soon, Congress to launch a nationwide campaign

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

THE CONGRESS on Thursday said the BJP government at the Centre has moved from "vote chori" (vote theft) to "seat chori" (seat theft) and announced a nationwide agitation against issues such as price rise, unemployment, paper leaks and electoral malpractices.

The decision was taken after a meeting of party general secretaries, state in-charges and Pradesh congress presidents held at the party headquarters in the Capital.

The meeting was chaired by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and attended by Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, Congress general secretaries

Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, KC Venugopal, Jairam Ramesh among others.

During the meeting, Gandhi told the party leaders that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has led the country to "ruins", said sources.

At a press conference, Congress general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal and general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh said the campaign against the failures of the Modi government will begin soon and continue for next two-three months on the national, state and district level.

On the rejection of Meenakshi Natarajan's Rajya Sabha nomination, Venugopal said, "We condemn the BJP's latest 'seat chori' attempt in MP..."

# How a TMC split may alter Parliament arithmetic, strengthen NDA's hand

Deeptiman Tiwary  
New Delhi, June 11

THE POLITICAL crisis engulfing the Trinamool Congress (TMC) has the potential to alter the Parliament arithmetic in ways that could have significant implications for the Narendra Modi government's legislative agenda, including its plans to revive the contentious delimitation legislation during the forthcoming Monsoon Session.

With rebel leaders claiming the support of 20 of the TMC's 28 Lok Sabha MPs, seven AAP Rajya Sabha MPs having already merged with the BJP earlier this year, and three more TMC members resigning from the Upper House amid the current turmoil, the Opposition's parliamentary strength is undergoing its biggest realignment since the splits in the Shiv Sena in 2022 and the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) in 2023.

The developments come at a time when the Opposition has already been weakened by the breakdown of the Congress-DMK alliance after the Congress aligned itself with Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) following the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections.

The NDA currently commands the support of about 293 MPs in the 543-member Lok Sabha. Rebel TMC leaders claim the support of 20 of the party's 28 Lok Sabha MPs and have indicated their willingness to back the government. If those numbers hold, the government's effective support base rises from 293 to 313 MPs.

The significance of the shift becomes apparent when viewed against the April vote on the delimitation-linked constitutional



TMC chief Mamata Banerjee in New Delhi earlier this week. ANI FILE

amendment. Despite retaining the support of all NDA constituents and receiving backing from several non-aligned parties, the government was able to secure only 298 votes and failed to pass the legislation.

The addition of 20 TMC MPs would theoretically raise the government's demonstrated support base from 298 to 318 votes, substantially improving its position compared to the earlier attempt.

What could add to this is the timing of the TMC crisis. It comes at a time when the Opposition's parliamentary architecture is already under strain. The Congress-DMK alliance has collapsed following Congress's decision to align with the TVK in Tamil Nadu.

The split weakens one of the strongest pillars of the INDIA bloc and opens the possibility of issue-based cooperation between the DMK and the government on specific legislative matters. The DMK has 22 Lok Sabha MPs.

If the party were to support a

delimitation-linked constitutional amendment, the government's potential support base would rise from 313 to 335 MPs. That would be just 25 short of the two-third majority in the current Lok Sabha.

The two-thirds mark in the full 543-member Lok Sabha is 362. However, three Lok Sabha seats are currently vacant — Basirhat in West Bengal, Shillong in Meghalaya and Nowgong in Assam — reducing the effective strength of the House to 540. That brings the effective two-thirds threshold down to 360.

While 335 would still not guarantee the passage of a constitutional amendment, it would place the government within striking distance of the required numbers and provide the BJP leadership with a considerably stronger platform for floor management on the day of voting.

In practical terms, the government would no longer need to build an entirely new coalition around a constitutional amendment. Instead, it would need to secure a much smaller number

of additional votes through support, abstentions or absences in the Opposition ranks.

## Immediate impact in Rajya Sabha

The Upper House numbers are evolving in stages. The BJP's strength had already risen to 113 after the merger of seven former AAP Rajya Sabha MPs. The NDA's tally consequently climbed to around 148 members.

The TMC crisis has now created a second opening. Three TMC Rajya Sabha MPs have resigned, reducing the party's strength from 13 to 10 and creating three vacancies.

If NDA-backed candidates secure all three seats in ensuing by-elections, the NDA's tally would rise from approximately 148 to 151. The two-third majority mark in the Rajya Sabha is 163 members.

The more consequential development lies in the West Bengal Assembly. Rebel leaders claim the support of 58 of the TMC's 80 MLAs, leaving Mamata Banerjee with only 22 legislators.

Those numbers have direct implications for future Rajya Sabha elections. Under the Rajya Sabha electoral formula, a party's ability to elect MPs depends on the number of MLAs it has in the state Assembly. With only 22 MLAs, the Mamata Banerjee faction would struggle to elect a Rajya Sabha member independently in future election cycles.

The TMC's current Rajya Sabha contingent may not disappear immediately, but it could steadily shrink as existing members complete their terms.

## RAJYA SABHA ELECTIONS

# Natarajan out, 3 BJP leaders from MP enter Upper House

Anand Mohan J  
Bhopal, June 11

BJP CANDIDATES Tarun Chugh, Rajneesh Agrawal and Mahesh Kewat were on Wednesday declared elected unopposed to the Rajya Sabha from Madhya Pradesh, formally ending a bitter contest in which Congress candidate Meenakshi Natarajan's nomination was rejected.

Natarajan's nomination was rejected by the Returning Officer for allegedly not disclosing a pending court case. "We all have been elected unopposed. All three candidates have collected their certificates," Agrawal told *The Indian Express*.

The BJP had sprung a surprise when it fielded Kewat to take on Natarajan, hoping to split Congress votes. The Congress subsequently decided to fly its 66 MLAs to Karnataka in an attempt to resist any efforts by the BJP to reach out to the legislators for support. However, this was eventually in vain as the Congress candidate's nomination was rejected.

Kewat's elevation to the Rajya Sabha marks the culmination of a four-decade journey through the Sangh Parivar and BJP organisational structure. A native of Orchha in Niwari district, Kewat first became associated with the RSS in 1984 and



Rajneesh Agrawal, Tarun Chugh and Mahesh Kewat display their certificates in Bhopal on Thursday. PTI

later worked with the ABVP as a student activist. He was also associated with the VHP before formally entering BJP politics in the mid-1990s.

Unlike many nominees who

emerge from electoral politics or government, Kewat built his career through local organisation work. BJP leaders have framed his nomination as both a social justice and an ideological state-

ment. His roots in Orchha also carry symbolic value.

Of the three new RS MPs, Tarun Chugh is the highest-profile entrant. A national general secretary of the BJP and one of the party's most trusted organisational strategists, Chugh has spent nearly four decades in the Sangh Parivar and BJP ecosystem.

If Chugh represents the BJP's national face, Agrawal embodies its organisational spine in Madhya Pradesh. The Sagar-based leader is widely regarded within BJP circles as one of the party's most effective backroom managers. **FULL REPORT ON** [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM)

## SC to hear Cong leader plea today

THE SUPREME COURT will hear Congress leader Meenakshi Natarajan's plea challenging the rejection of her Rajya Sabha nomination from MP on Friday.

Senior Advocate Abhishek Singhvi mentioned the plea before a bench of Justices P K Mishra and A S Chandurkar, which said it will be listed on Friday, subject to curing of defects, if any. Natarajan's candidature was rejected on June 9. ENS





# Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan

## Madhya Pradesh Prepares to Save Every Drop



NARENDRA MODI  
Prime Minister

### A Participatory Model of Water Governance



CM Dr.Mohan Yadav addressing Ganga Dussehra Celebration at Ujjain as a part of Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan.

Madhya Pradesh has successfully taken up revival of water bodies seeking larger public participation under Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan.

#### Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav's Water Conservation Vision

Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav has been consistently urging citizens to act in unison for conservation of water. He emphasizes that every member of society must develop a sense of responsibility towards water conservation. In his numerous public speeches, the philosophy of water has been spelled out meticulously. The key messages include -

- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi is the driving force behind the national people's movement for water conservation.
- Water is a key parameter of development. If there is water, there is a prosperous future.
- Under the Prime Minister's leadership, historic initiatives such as the Ministry of Jal Shakti, Jal Jeevan Mission, Namami Gange, Amrit Sarovar Mission, and Jal Shakti Ab-

hiyan have been launched.

- Rivers are revered and worshipped as goddesses in Indian culture.
- Efforts have been made in every district for the construction or restoration of 75 water bodies. More than 70,000 Amrit Sarovars have been developed so far, enhancing rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, and irrigation facilities. This mission is part of the Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav celebrations. Work is also underway under the Namami Gange project, including sewage treatment plants, riverfront development, and biodiversity conservation.
- The Prime Minister Krishi Sinchayee Yojana promotes the principle of "More Crop per Drop."
- The Catch the Rain campaign has transformed rainwater harvesting into a mass movement. Under the Prime Minister's guidance, lakhs of water conservation structures have been created, including check dams, rainwater harvesting systems, and the restoration of traditional water sources.
- As a result, groundwater recharge has

increased, the number of over-exploited groundwater units has declined, and water scarcity has reduced in several districts.

- Madhya Pradesh is also undertaking exemplary initiatives in the field of water conservation.
- The Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan is a statewide public movement. In 2025, the campaign was conducted from March 19 to June 30. In 2026 as well, it has been implemented with full vigor across the state. Maintenance work has been carried out on more than 10,000 check dams and stop dams.
- Thousands of ponds have been deepened, and new water conservation structures have been constructed.
- Water conservation works worth approximately Rs. 2,500 crore have been undertaken.
- Ancient step wells, ponds, and water structures are valuable cultural heritage assets. Their restoration enhances cultural pride and promotes tourism.
- Madhya Pradesh is emerging as a leading state in water conservation in India.

#### Urban MP engaged in Water Conservation

Extensive work has been undertaken for water conservation in urban areas. The Urban Development and Housing Department has carried out large-scale initiatives such as restoration and rejuvenation of ponds, wells, and ancient stepwells, cleaning and beautification of drains, and the installation of rainwater harvesting systems. Urban local bodies set up drinking water kiosks at various locations for convenience of local citizens.

#### CM calls for Shramdan

##### PUBLIC AWARENESS BUILDING

On the call of Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav, extensive public awareness programs on water conservation across the state have been taken up. More than 5.25 lakh people actively participated in these initiatives. In addition, 2,682 Water Temples have been set up in various development blocks.



Chief Minister Dr. Yadav Performs Shramdan at Devi Sagar Talab on Ganga Dussehra.

#### Shipra Tirth Parikrama



Under the leadership of Chief Minister Dr. Mohan Yadav, the State Government has been continuously working towards achieving self-reliance in water. The Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan, launched to conserve and rejuvenate rivers, ponds, and traditional water structures, has now evolved into a mass movement with widespread public participation.

As part of the campaign, the "Shipra Tirth Parikrama" in Ujjain was organized. During the event, Chief Minister Dr. Yadav offered a 351-foot-long chunari to the sacred Maa Shipra River. The campaign is also accelerating conservation efforts through the cleaning and restoration of Futera Talab and ancient stepwells across the state. The campaign is spreading the message: "Conservation of Every Drop, Save Life."

#### Revival of Holy Ghats of Shipra

Celebrating Ganga Dussehra with huge mass gathering in Ujjain underlined that people have willingly contributing to saving water. Addressing the valedictory ceremony of the Shipra Tirth Parikrama, CM Dr. Yadav stated that during Simhastha-2028, the ghats of Maa Shipra, developed over a stretch of more than 30 kilometres, will enable devotees to take the holy dip and earn spiritual merit. The ghats of Maa-Shipra, stretching from Triveni to Siddhnath, are considered sacred. Availability of clean and continuously flowing waters of Maa Shipra will enhance the sanctity of the event. After nearly six decades, devotees attending Simhastha will once again be able to bathe in the naturally flowing waters of Maa Shipra. The government is ensuring excellent arrangements to make Simhastha-2028 memorable and set new benchmarks.

#### Cleaning of Water Sources Becomes A Mass Movement

Madhya Pradesh has successfully taken up water conservation initiatives under the Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan. This has now become a mass movement and has achieved historic milestones in water conservation. The campaign is being conducted across the state from 19 March to 30 June 2026.

Various activities are being organized across the districts under the Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan for the conservation and enhancement of water resources. The campaign aims to promote rainwater harvesting, preserve traditional water sources, and raise community awareness about water conservation.

As part of the campaign, the cleaning of wells, stepwells, ponds, reservoirs, and drains is being carried out on a war footing in villages and urban areas across the districts. Efforts are being made to revive these water sources through the active participation of Gram Panchayats, schools, Anganwadi centers, voluntary organizations, and local citizens.

Residents were also educated about household water conservation measures, including rainwater harvesting and ways to prevent water wastage. The campaign has witnessed active involvement from the District Administration, Janpad Panchayats, Urban Local Bodies, the



Water Resources Department, and other related departments. Local public representatives, social workers, and youth have also enthusiastically participated in these activities.

All citizens were counselled to protect water sources, use water judiciously, and adopt rainwater harvesting practices to help prevent future water crises. The campaign is emerging as a strong initiative towards achieving water self-reliance in the districts through active public participation.

#### Madhya Pradesh Earns National Recognition in Water Conservation

Over 2.17 Lacs Works Completed



Madhya Pradesh has made a significant progress in water conservation across the country. Many districts have achieved top rankings. Khandwa got first position.

##### PERFORMANCE RANKING 2026

| Ranking | District | Score |
|---------|----------|-------|
| 1       | Khandwa  | 7.75  |
| 2       | Ujjain   | 7.49  |
| 3       | Khargone | 7.10  |
| 4       | Balaghat | 7.04  |
| 5       | Neemuch  | 7.00  |

##### Integrated Dashboard

To ensure regular monitoring of the campaign on a single platform, an Integrated Dashboard has been developed. Through this system, all departments are recording and tracking their respective activities. The dashboard also facilitates district-wise rankings, promoting administrative and departmental transparency as well as healthy competition among districts.

##### PROGRESS CHART From 2024 to 2026

| Year | Activities Done                               |
|------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | 62,000 Work Done                              |
|      | 40,108 New Ventures                           |
|      | 21,536 Water Bodies Revived                   |
| 2025 | 86,360 Water Bodies Recovered                 |
|      | 553 Amrit Sarovar Works completed             |
| 2026 | 2,17,843 Work Completed                       |
|      | 61,030 Farm Pond                              |
|      | 157 Amrit Sarovar                             |
|      | 94,073 Dug Well Recharge                      |
|      | 1206 Irrigation Infrastructure                |
|      | 31,656 Water Conservation & Recharge          |
|      | 5,116 Watershed Related Works                 |
|      | 2,883 Repair & Maintenance (Water Structure)  |
|      | 12.76 Cr.Gap Filling in Plantation            |
|      | 11,550 Work Not Permissible in VB-GRAM-G      |
|      | 169.47 PMKSY Watershed                        |
|      | 2,288,403 JSJB 2.0                            |
|      | 6,887 Water Tank Cleaning in Schools(WoW app) |

#### MP's Victory of Participatory Approach

Positive outcome reported from across districts

Water management has brought significant improvements in agriculture, the environment, and livelihoods. The Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan has emerged as an effective medium for water conservation, environmental protection, and rural development across Madhya Pradesh. The campaign has accelerated the restoration of water sources and the construction of new water conservation structures. Public participation has strengthened water management efforts.

As a result, water availability has increased in various districts of the state, agricultural productivity has improved, biodiversity has been conserved, rural economies have become stronger, and people's livelihoods have witnessed positive changes.

##### Chhindwara: Pond Construction in Palachaurai Boosts Agricultural Productivity

Palachaurai village in Junnardeo block of Chhindwara district has emerged as a model of greenery and prosperity. Under the campaign, priority was given to the construction of water structures and the revival of old water sources.

Through coordinated efforts of the Fisheries Department and the Panchayat & Rural Development Department, ponds ranging from half an acre to two-and-a-half acres were constructed, ensuring year-round water availability.

The rise in groundwater levels has directly benefited agriculture. Farmers who were previously dependent on rainfall are now practicing irrigated farming. Currently, they are harvesting up to three crops annually, leading to increased production and income.

Production of wheat, gram, lentils, mustard, and peas during the Rabi season has increased significantly. Farmers are also able to cultivate green gram (moong) and black gram (urad) during the summer season. In addition, they have developed alternative sources of income through fish farming,



pearl cultivation, and water chestnut production.

As a result, the village's economic condition has improved, migration has declined, and young people are becoming self-reliant by engaging in agriculture.

##### Gwalior: Revival of Prithvi Tal

In Gwalior district, the historic Prithvi Tal has been rejuvenated under the Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan. It has been transformed into a modern, functional, and attractive water reservoir.

Spread across approximately 7.27 hectares, the pond had previously been severely affected by siltation, water hyacinth growth, and encroachments, making it nearly unusable. It has been revived as an effective center for water conservation.

Extensive desilting, deepening, and cleaning activities were carried out under the campaign, increasing the pond's



water storage capacity. The fertile soil removed from the pond was used in nearby agricultural fields, providing additional benefits to farmers.

Following beautification efforts, the site has become a popular picnic destination and a center for recreational and health-related activities. One of the most significant achievements has been the restoration of biodiversity.

Currently, more than 120 species of native and migratory birds inhabit the area. Turtles and other aquatic creatures have also returned, transforming the site into a vibrant ecosystem.

##### Mandsaur: Restoration of Thadod's Historic Stepwell Provides a Sustainable Water Source

In Thadod village of Mandsaur district, the revival of the historic Hazrat Ghalib Baori (stepwell) has emerged as an inspiring achievement.

For years, the stepwell had remained neglected and unusable due to accumulated debris, dirt, and poor maintenance. Under the campaign, the administration and local villagers actively participated in its restoration.

Through voluntary labor, debris was removed, the water source was cleaned, and the surrounding area was developed and organized. As a result, the stepwell has once again become a clean, safe, and functional water source.

The campaign has not only preserved an important historical heritage site but has also provided villagers with a sustainable source of water. It is expected to contribute to groundwater recharge and has become a source of inspiration for other villages.

##### Towards Sustainable Development

The efforts being undertaken under the Jal Ganga Samvardhan Abhiyan are bringing meaningful changes in the conservation and utilization of water resources across Madhya Pradesh.

The examples of Chhindwara, Gwalior, and Mandsaur demonstrate that well-planned implementation combined with active community participation can deliver sustainable results at the local level.

This initiative is not only addressing current water needs but is also laying a strong foundation for future water security, thereby promoting balanced and long-term development throughout the state.



## MOTOR ACCIDENT CLAIMS

## ‘Homemakers nation builders’: SC puts ‘loss of domestic care’ at Rs 30K monthly

Ananthakrishnan G  
New Delhi, June 11

DEFINING HOMEMAKERS as “nation builders”, the Supreme Court on Thursday fixed Rs 30,000 as their notional monthly income for the purpose of motor accident claims in the event of their death.

In a judgment which is likely to have wide implications on cases related to the Motor Vehicles Act, the bench of Justices Sanjoy Karol and N Kotiswar Singh held that “a composite sum of Rs 30,000 shall be added under the head of loss of domestic care” in motor accident claims linked to the death of a homemaker. The bench passed the order while granting additional compensation in a road accident dating back to November 25, 2001, when a woman died while she was on her way from Sirsa to Fatehabad (Haryana).

Her husband and three children approached the Motor Accident Claims Tribunal, which granted compensation of Rs 2.42 lakh in December 2023. They then went to the Punjab and Haryana High Court, which, in December 2024, enhanced the compensation to Rs 8.43 lakh along with 7.5% interest from the date of filing the claim petition. The family then approached the Supreme Court. The top court Thursday increased the compensation to Rs 62.78 lakh, noting the contribution of a homemaker to the “growth of the human being and the nation”, and quantifying the “loss of domestic care monthly income” at Rs 30,000.

“When a Motor Accidents Claim Tribunal or the High Court or this Court is concerned with a case involving the death of a homemaker, in order to overcome the inherent disadvantage accrued against the homemaker on a calculation of compensation on the basis of conservatively computed notional income... a composite sum of Rs 30,000 shall be added under the head of ‘loss of domestic care’,” the bench said. “This amount of Rs 30,000, i.e., loss of domestic care, is to be taken as a ‘stand-in’ (basic mini-

mum monthly income) for monthly income in those cases where the homemaker does not have an input into the house, in strictly conventional, monetary terms. In those cases where the homemaker is part of the workforce, the component of loss of domestic care shall be in addition to the monthly income as may be proved before the tribunal/ courts... It is our hope that the word housewife/ homemaker, is in future, in recognition of the contributions of the lady of the house... is now used as ‘nation builder.’”

Writing for the bench, Justice Karol said: “The loss of a homemaker, however, is not limited to the husband and children. It also directly impacts the women’s parents who have been deprived of the love and company of their child... Still further, the loss is acutely felt by her in-laws, who are more often than not members of the same household and are therefore dependent on the love, labour and dedication of this person... Strict arithmetic calculation does not lend its service to any of these scenarios.”

The court said that in its view, “it is ironic to describe a homemaker as dependant on earning members, when, in reality the household’s functioning depends substantially on the homemaker. The earning members are, in fact, solely dependent on the homemaker but alas, this reality does not receive the acknowledgment it deserves. Efforts have been made across fields to some success, but yet, undeniably, the road is long.”

The bench also expressed concern over the delay in deciding motor accident claims, and issued a series of directions in this regard. It said that an analysis of the 100 appeals decided by the SC “reveals that the average pendency in the High Courts is approximately eight years and before the (Motor Accident Claims) Tribunals... is approximately six years”. The SC asked Chief Justices of High Courts to take steps to decide pending cases without further delay.

FULL REPORT ON  
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

## UP man arrested for sacrilege bid at Golden Temple compound

Kamaldeep Singh Brar  
Amritsar, June 11

A MAN from Uttar Pradesh was on Thursday nabbed by guards for an alleged sacrilege bid at Gurdwara Shaheed Baba Gurbaksh Singh Ji, situated inside the Golden Temple complex.

Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargai said that one Abhijit from Saharanpur in Uttar Pradesh entered the sanctum during a Akhand Path around 2 am on Thursday. “After completing parkarma (circumambulation) of Guru Granth Sahib, he reportedly picked up the Sri Sahib (sword). Sewadars immediately apprehended him and handed him over to the police,” he said.

The Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC) has filed an official complaint regarding the incident, however, police said that an FIR is yet to be registered. Gargai said the incident was similar to a December 2021 sacrilege bid, when an individual crossed a safety grill inside Golden Temple and picked up the Sri Sahib.

He also called Thursday’s incident a major failure of the Punjab government and criticised authorities for not yet identifying the person involved in the 2021 case. The Jathedar added that the current case could be part of a larger conspiracy or a deliberate effort to hurt Sikh sentiments.

Patel to vice-chancellors and directors of state universities and institutions, universities have been asked to immediately implement preventive measures aimed at curbing such cases. The letter, issued by Dr Sudhir M Bobde, Special Executive Officer to the Chancellor, states that reports of attempts to convert students through inducements or psychological pressure are being received frequently. It said educational institutions must remain vigilant to ensure a “safe, religion-neutral and academic environment” and adopt strategies to eliminate such attempts. The letter also states, “At the university and institutional level, ‘Anti-Radicalisation’ units or Student Welfare Cells should

## Two killed in fresh violence as tensions boil over in Manipur

Comes day after  
6 abducted men’s  
bodies are foundSukrita Baruah  
Guwahati, June 11

Two persons were killed in a Kuki-Zo village near the Indo-Myanmar border in Manipur on Thursday amid heightened tensions following the recovery of the bodies of six Naga men nearly a month after they had been abducted.

Tensions started rising in Manipur soon after police announced Wednesday evening that joint security forces had recovered six bodies of those “believed to be among” the men abducted on May 13. Search operations for the six men had been underway for the past



Bodies, suspected to be of the six missing persons of the Naga community, being brought to a mortuary in Imphal on Thursday. PTI

four weeks. Their bodies were recovered a day after Naga groups released 14 Kuki men they had been holding hostage in Senapati district, demanding that the six men be located and handed over.

Once news spread that the bodies had been recovered and were being taken to the capital, Imphal, for post-mortem examination, large numbers of people began gathering at the Jawaharlal Nehru Institute of

Medical Sciences (JNIMS) in Imphal East, where the bodies were brought at around 2 am on Thursday. As emotions and tempers rose among those gathered at the institute, which included family members and Naga civil society groups, security forces deployed there used teargas at around midnight.

Later, in the early hours of Thursday, an attack on Kultuh, a small Kuki-Zo village located in Kanjong district, was reported. According to officials, the attack on the village, which is located close to the Indo-Myanmar border, started at around 4 am, and two people were killed, and at least six houses were burned.

Kuki-Zo organisations identified the two deceased as Letminlun Haokip, the head deacon of Kultuh Church, and Lunminthang Haokip, a youth chairman of the church.

## Free bus travel for women to roll out in Kerala from June 15

Shaju Philip  
Thiruvananthapuram, June 11

THE CONGRESS government’s free bus travel scheme for women in the Kerala State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) is set to roll out from Monday, with the benefit restricted to ordinary services — as opposed to faster and more premium services — operated by the financially struggling state-run transport corporation.

Free bus travel for women was among the five “Indira Guarantees” promised by the Congress-led UDF during the Assembly election campaign. The scheme, named Priyadarshini, will be available to all women and transgender persons without any age restriction.

Announcing the decision on Wednesday, Chief Minister V D Sathesaran said the scheme would be implemented in phases. “This is the first time such a scheme is being introduced in Kerala. It is expected to result in a revenue loss of Rs 65-70 crore a month, or Rs 750-800 crore annually, for KSRTC. The government will compensate the corporation for the loss,” he said.

Sathesaran said the second phase of the scheme would be considered after assessing KSRTC’s financial position. “The scheme will be reviewed every month. There is a shortage of ordinary KSRTC buses in north Kerala, and steps will be taken to address it. District-wise data on women passengers using ordinary services will also be reviewed and factored into future decisions,” he said.

The scheme comes at a time when KSRTC continues to depend heavily on government support. According to official figures, the state spends around Rs 1,500 crore annually towards the salaries of about 22,000 employees and pensions of nearly 40,000 retirees. Government assistance remains crucial as the corporation is unable to meet its operational expenses through service revenue alone.

## In Kashmir village once known for its springs, mining leaves river scarred, fields barren

Bashaarat Masood  
Sail (Budgam), June 11

IT LOOKS nothing like a riverbed. Deep cuts and ridges mark the rocky terrain, framed against distant willow trees and the Pir Panjal mountains. Nearby stands a mound of soil and loose gravel — debris from excavation. A few metres away flows the Sukhnag river, once abundant but now a shadow of its former self.

This is Sail, a village of 2,500 in Kashmir’s Budgam. Located on the banks of Sukhnag, the village was once blessed by nature, with gushing river water branching into tiny streams around it and feeding its thriving trout farms and paddy fields. Then, villagers allege, a riverbed mining project changed it beyond recognition.

Last month, a joint panel of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC), the National Institute of Himalayan Environment (NIHE) and the J&K Pollution Control Committee (JKPCC) flagged “indiscriminate and unscientific” extraction of minerals from the Sukhnag — a river central to Budgam district. The extraction was undertaken through a series of permits issued by the district administration, which activists allege circumvented environmental clearance requirements.

The report, submitted to the NGT on May 6, highlighted the extent of the damage, saying there were indications of excavation “below the active river bed and into the alluvial aquifer zones” to depths of 4.42 metres — nearly 15 feet. “When we tried to raise our voice and blocked the road, officials threatened to lodge an FIR against us,” a village resident says.

Although short-term mining projects in Sukhnag were undertaken by companies, NKC Projects Pvt Ltd, a prominent infrastructure and civil construction company based in Gurugram, undertook a majority of the extraction. Calls and emails to NKC Projects seeking a response



In its report before NGT, joint panel in the Sukhnag case estimated that 10.6 lakh to 15.3 lakh tonnes of riverbed material may have been extracted, causing ‘irreversible hydrogeological damage’. EXPRESS

went unanswered. Attempts to police drew no response, while officials from the district administration declined to comment.

The mining has stopped for over a year, but locals cite irreversible damage to the area’s ecosystem: A lowered riverbed, dried-up springs and irrigation channels, and loss of aquatic life.

With no water, Imtiyaz Ali’s 1.25-acre paddy field has also turned barren. “I stopped growing paddy and planted acacia trees,” he says. “Before, the 10 kanals of land would fetch me at least 50 quintals of paddy at the rate of Rs 3,000 per quintal. But now, with acacia, I will have to wait 15 years for the trees to grow, and even then, it will fetch only peanuts.” A 54-km-long tributary of Jhelum, Sukhnag is a glacial river that originates near the Tosamaidan meadow in the Pir Panjal and passes through central Budgam and is considered a critical source of water for drinking, irrigation and trout fishing.

In Kashmir, designated trout streams such as Sukhnag, Doodhganga and Shaliganga are subject to stricter regulation. But the last few years have seen rampant mining in these fragile river systems, prompting petitions before the NGT for these rivers.

In its report before the NGT, the joint panel in the Sukhnag case estimated that 10.6 lakh to 15.3 lakh tonnes of riverbed material may have been extracted from the surveyed stretch of the river, and said it had caused “ir-

reversible hydrogeological damage”. It recommended a “moratorium on all mining activities” until the system is “adequately restored”. “Even when a conservative depth of 3.86 metres is considered, estimated extraction remains high at nearly 10.62 lakh tonnes (as measured by G B Pant National Institute of Himalayan Environment),” it said.

Environmental activist Raja Muzaffar Bhat, who filed the petition before the NGT, says the actual figures could be much higher. “The report only talks about a small area,” he says. “If you look at the figures for two years, they have extracted around 200 dumpers of material from the river.” Bhat alleges that in contravention of Supreme Court guidelines, the local administration had issued short-term permits for mining.

For the area, the consequences of these alleged infractions appeared overnight. Peerzada Rayees Ahmad had a trout farm fed by a small stream from Sukhnag, which was lost. “One night, the river suddenly dried up. We went to see what had happened and saw giant excavators had dug deep into the river and the water level had fallen below the riverbed. When we questioned them, they humiliated us and asked us to complain to whomever we wanted,” says Ahmad. He’s still seeking an FIR against the mining company.

FULL REPORT ON  
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

## Stand-up comedian, others face FIR over ‘obscene’ remarks during show

Express News Service  
Mumbai, June 11

MAHARASHTRA CYBER police on Thursday registered an FIR against stand-up comedian Pranit More, web developer Himanshu Jangra, Dr Sejal Pawar and others for allegedly making obscene comments during a show in Gurugram recently.

Summons have been issued to the three, directing them to appear before Maharashtra Cyber for inquiry. An official said that Maharashtra Cyber is monitoring online media ecosystems to identify and take appropriate action against content that violates laws and adversely affects public order or dignity. The case was registered at the Nodal

Cyber Police Station after a preliminary probe into viral video clips from the show hosted by More. The case was registered against More, Jangra, Pawar and other unidentified individuals under relevant sections of the BNS along with the IT Act.

The case arises from videos circulated through YouTube, Instagram and social media platforms during More’s show. The content being widely circulated allegedly contains offensive, obscene and objectionable remarks concerning women, consent and deceased persons, which are against accepted societal norms and attract provisions of criminal law.

The probe conducted by Maharashtra Cyber revealed

that one of the clips allegedly contained remarks made by Himanshu Jangra suggesting entitlement to sexual favours in return for an amount of Rs 370 spent on chicken biryani during a date, thereby portraying women in a derogatory manner and trivialising issues relating to consent and dignity, the official said. More was seen laughing at Jangra’s comment.

Another clip allegedly featured Dr Sejal Pawar making obscene and derogatory comments concerning cadavers of males used for educational purposes. Both More and Jangra apologised after facing backlash on social media, and the latter also deactivated his Instagram account. WITH PTI INPUTS

## • BRIEFLY



Protestors at Savitribai Phule Pune University. EXPRESS

## MAHARASHTRA

## CJP releases ‘exam manifesto’, seeks education minister’s resignation

IN COCKROACH Janta Party’s second protest held at Savitribai Phule Pune University on Thursday, protestors demanded resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Founder Abhijeet Dipke released five demand points of CJP, calling it the party’s exam manifesto. “I want to ask Vishwaguru, are crores of students important to you or one incompetent minister?... Sonam Wangchuk was put in jail instead of being made the education minister. In the past 10-12 years, there is only talk of Hindu-Muslim in the country... They want to divide us. Because then you will only think of religious issues. You will not think of employment, education, jobs, inflation,” Dipke said. ENS

Punjab: 30 kg  
heroin seized;  
six arrested

A CROSS-BORDER drug smuggling cartel has been dismantled with the arrest of six persons and recovery of over 30 kg of heroin, a top Punjab Police officer said on Thursday. Preliminary probe revealed that the accused were linked to a Dubai-based smuggler, who was facilitating the supply of heroin consignments from across the border, Director General of Police Gaurav Yadav wrote on X. An FIR has been registered under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act at Chheharta police station, Amritsar. Further probe is underway, police said. PTI

3 arrested for  
teen’s murder in  
Jharkhand

JHARKHAND POLICE on Thursday claimed to have solved the murder case of 18-year-old Pramod Yadav, who had been missing since June 7 from Gadiya village in Chatra district. Chatra SDPO Sunny Vardhan said that two accused — Sunil Kumar (19) and Sunil Kumar (21), both residents of Tola-Baghmani in Pathel — and a minor have been arrested. Yadav’s body was found buried under sand on June 7 itself. “It was revealed during the probe that the accused had murdered Yadav over a dispute related to the buying and selling of illegal weapons,” SDPO Vardhan said. PTI

## ‘Patriarchal preference for male child’: SC says strict enforcement of PCPNDT Act needed

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

THE SUPREME Court on Friday said “deep-seated patriarchal preferences towards a male child and the behind the curtains prevalence of sex-selection practices” continue to exist in the country despite improvement in the national child sex ratio.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and P K Mishra made the observation as it dismissed a Maharashtra doctor’s appeal challenging criminal proceedings against him under the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (Prohibition of Sex Selection) Act, 1994 (PCPNDT Act).

Citing various schemes started by state governments to curb female foeticide and improve the condition of women, the SC said they “are indicative of continued efforts to eradicate the systemic bias suffered by the girl child in an inherently patriarchal system. Much progress has been made, and yet, much is left to be desired. In sum, while the situation is markedly better than it was in the mid-1990s, the data does not support complacency. The statistics... show that the progress made is incomplete and uneven”.

“Consequently, the integrity and strict enforcement of welfare-oriented legislation such as the PCPNDT Act remain essential along with efforts continued and earnest, till the time there is a widespread change in mentality and what till now is perceived as the ‘inherent weakness’ of the woman is replaced by true equality, when there will dawn a realisation that efforts such as these are no longer required. This is not to say that the laws protecting women within legislation such as IPC/BNS will no longer be required but at least, there will no longer be a question on whether a girl child deserves to

be born,” the court said.

Justice Karol, writing for the bench, referred to noted poet Subhadra Kumari Chauhan’s poem ‘Balika ka Parichay’, which he said “powerfully describes the beautiful joy of a mother upon the birth of her daughter”. The bench added that “to our mind the objective of the...Act...is to enable a woman to feel the same ‘joy’”.

The judgment also quoted the famous shloka “Yatra naryastu puiyante ramante tatra devata”, from Manusmriti, saying “from our own scriptures, the once much cherished but now largely forgotten value is also worth reminding ourselves of”.

The court noted that “according to official Government of India data, the country’s sex ratio has shown clear signs of improvement in recent years, though the story is not entirely straightforward”.

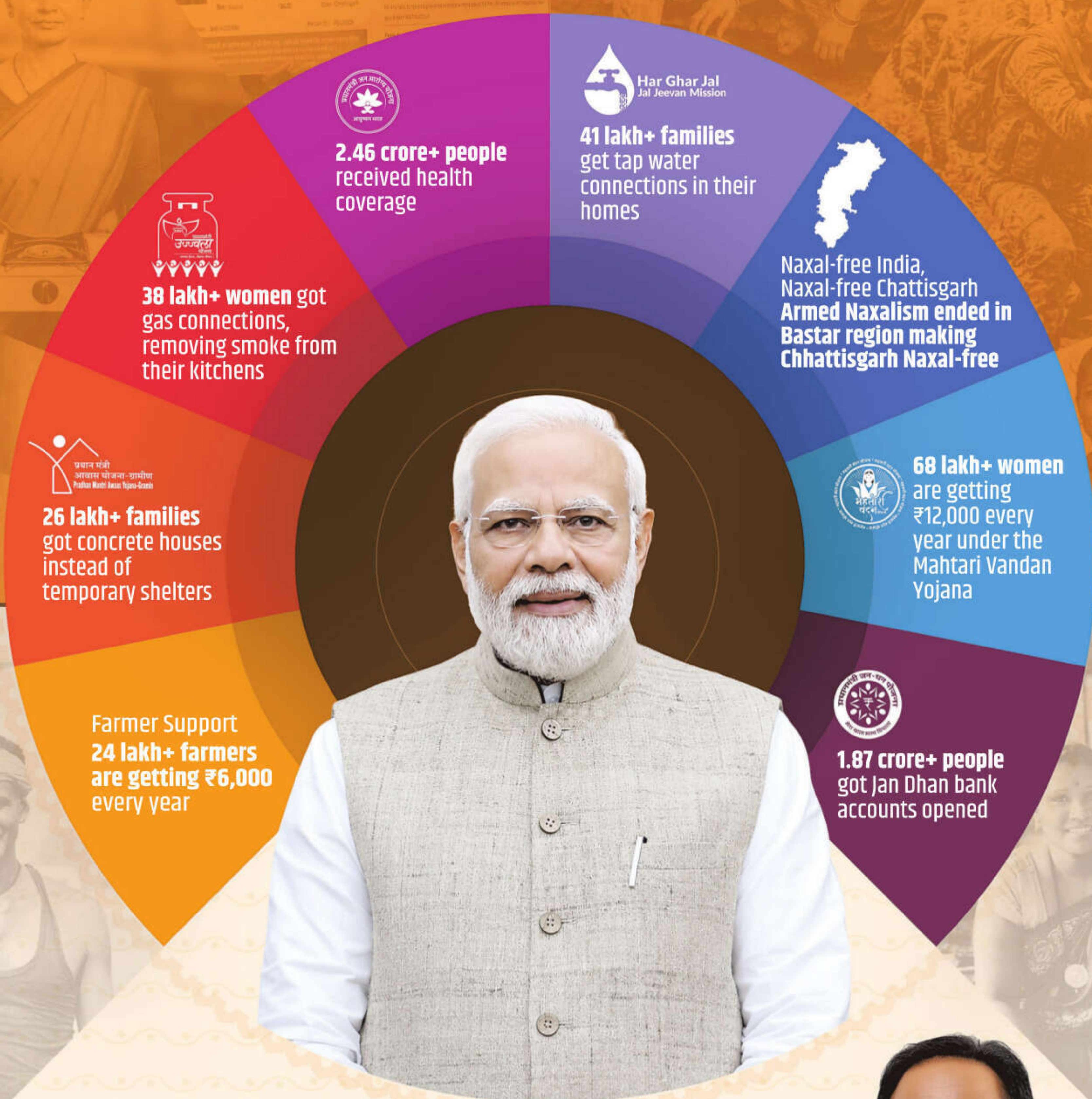
It said, “Census data shows that the national child sex ratio declined from 945 in 1991 to 927 in 2001 and further to 919 in 2011, reflecting the severity of the imbalance that prompted stringent implementation of the PCPNDT Act. The recovery to 929 at birth signals a partial course correction, but yet, not a path of true equality and acceptability. Differences across states drive home this point. For example, Haryana and Punjab, which recorded child sex ratios below 900 in the years immediately after the turn of the century have demonstrated improvement in subsequent surveys showing the success of the regulations as enforced and the awareness measures being implemented. Nonetheless, several states still do report sex ratios at birth below the national average. This shows the continuing presence of deep-seated patriarchal preferences towards a male child and the ‘behind the curtains’ prevalence of sex selection practices”.







# 12 Saal *Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke*



**Chhattisgarh moves forward  
with Modi's guarantee**

Shri Vishnu Deo Sai - Hon. CM of Chhattisgarh  
epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi





**Subhadra Yojana**  
**1 crore+**  
women financially empowered

**Lakshpati Didi**  
**23.46 lakh**  
A new identity for women

**Mukhyamantri Sampurna  
Pushti Yojana**

Strengthening the nutrition of  
adolescent girls, mothers & children

**Mukhyamantri Kanya Vivaha Yojana**

Boon for Economically Weaker Families  
above 1,300 couples married



**Ayushman Bharat-  
Gopabandhu Jana Arogya Yojana**  
Benefiting **3.46 crore** people



**Social Security Pension Scheme**  
**57 lakh+** benefitted



**2,52,000** employment opportunities  
generated with an investment of  
**₹3.6 lakh crore** across 34 projects



## Vikash ki Lahar, Gaon se Sahar

Reservation in  
Professional Education

**22.5%** for STs

**16.25%** for SCs

**11.25%** for SEBCs

**44,875** Shishu Vatikas  
benefiting **3.2 lakh** children

Godabarish Mishra Adarsha  
Prathamik Vidyalaya

**2,200** schools will be  
strengthened with an  
investment of **₹12,000 crore**

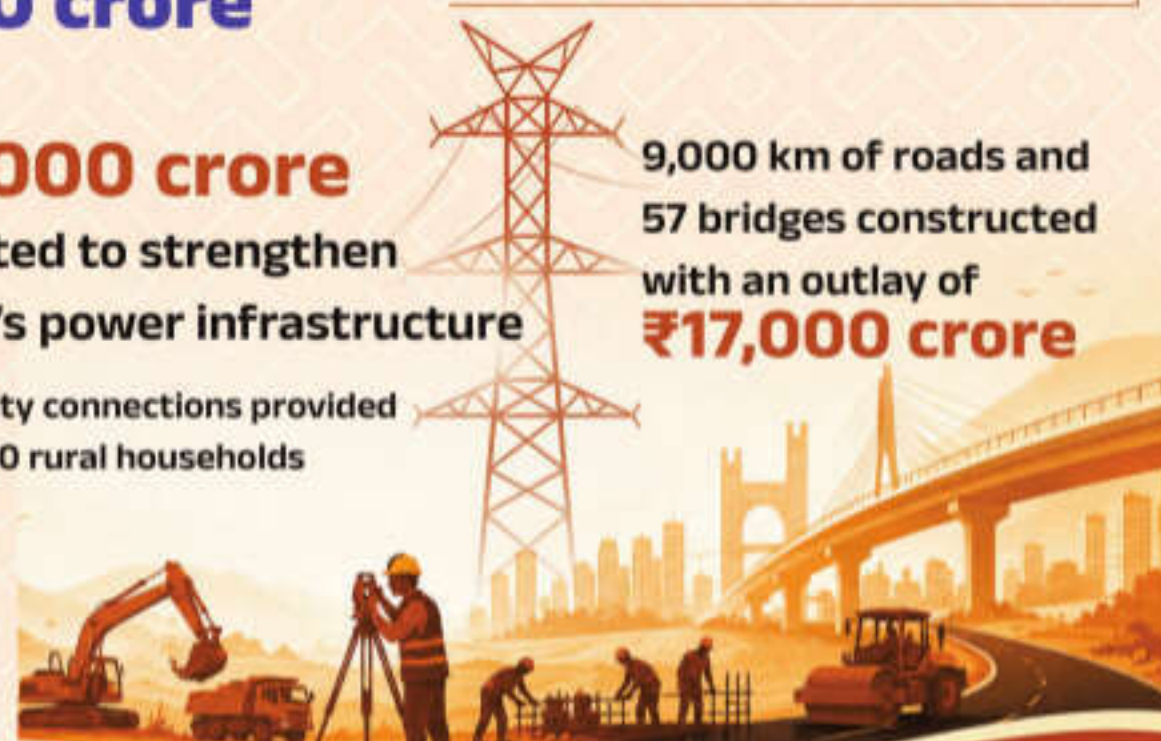


**Shaheed Madho Singh  
Haath Kharcha Yojana**  
**3.22 lakh** tribal students  
benefitted over the last 2 years

**₹6,000 crore**  
invested to strengthen  
State's power infrastructure

Electricity connections provided  
to 39,760 rural households

9,000 km of roads and  
57 bridges constructed  
with an outlay of  
**₹17,000 crore**



**MMSY**  
**11,596** km of all-weather rural roads and  
**566** bridges Constructed under SBY

PMAY and MMAY  
Nearly **5 lakh** families have  
received pucca houses.

Food Security Scheme  
**3+ crore**  
benefitted



**Samruddha Sahara Yojana**  
**₹4,870 crore** for urban  
development



**Mukhyamantri Kamadhenu Yojana**  
**326 Crore** FA to more than  
**4 lakh** dairy farmers

**Samruddha Krushak Yojana**  
Input assistance of  
**₹13,000 crore**  
provided to  
**19 lakh** farmers

CM-KISAN Scheme  
**51 Lakh** farmers benefitted  
with 3,000 Crore



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Annapurna Yojana**  
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Assured irrigation facilities extended to  
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## ED in dock again, needs to be held to account

THE DELHI High Court’s order, released Wednesday, on the Delhi Police Economic Offences Wing (EOW) and Enforcement Directorate’s (ED’s) cases against online portal NewsClick and its founder editor Prabir Purkayastha is an indictment, but not of the accused. Calling the continuation of the Delhi Police’s FIR “a gross abuse of the process of law”, the court has quashed the proceedings by the two agencies. “Aside from bald assertions of there being a criminal conspiracy, there is not a whisper of any incriminating allegation,” the HC said in a verdict that raises serious questions about the motives and competence of the investigating bodies and the prosecution. Purkayastha, who spent seven months in jail, still faces cases under UAPA, FCRA and income tax laws. That’s why the broader question now is about accountability for what appears to be an attempt to weaponise legal proceedings against a media outlet.

From Purkayastha’s arrest under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), voided by the Supreme Court in 2024, to the lack of legal grounds for the charges under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) and Indian Penal Code against NewsClick, it is clear that scant regard was paid to the letter and spirit of the law. This cavalier attitude is even more disturbing given the frequency with which the ED and other agencies invoke “special” laws like the UAPA and PMLA, all but shifting the burden of proof onto the accused and significantly increasing the threshold for the grant of bail. The HC also underlined the holowness of the ED’s demand for more time to investigate over a year and a half after it began its inquiries. As the SC observed last year in *Robert Lalchungnunga Chongthuv v. State of Bihar*, investigations cannot continue endlessly. Earlier in *Vakil Prasad Singh v. State of Bihar* (2009), the Court had said the right to a speedy trial falls under the purview of Article 21, and this includes a speedy investigation. The SC has also repeatedly asserted, including in the Purkayastha case, that bail should be the rule and jail the exception, even when charges are brought under special laws.

For some time now, legal scholars have argued that the process of establishing guilt or innocence often becomes the punishment. There are no disincentives or consequences, particularly in cases that have a certain political hue, for lapses in investigation and prosecution. Earlier this week, the Allahabad HC held magistrates and police officers liable for illegal preventive detentions. It is time to take this conversation forward and evolve a framework to ensure accountability without hampering investigations.

## Green energy can’t yet bend climate curve

LAST YEAR, renewable energy installations scaled a landmark, globally. Solar, wind and hydro edged out fossil fuels as the predominant source of power. The world’s two most populous countries, India and China, led the charge in adding clean energy installations. Yet, human activities pushed global warming to 1.37 degrees Celsius in 2025, according to the latest Indicators of Global Climate Change (IGCC) report, published on Wednesday in the journal *Earth System Science Data*. That the increase in warming comes at a time when the appetite for clean energy is at record levels frames the scale of the challenge for policymakers the world over. The expansion in renewables, though significant, is still not enough to check the rise in GHG emissions.

Unlike the power sector and, to an extent, the transport sector, large sections of the industry continue to be driven by fossil fuels. Transitioning to cleaner alternatives — green hydrogen, for instance — takes time and requires investments. In the short run, national policies can help by nudging manufacturers towards adopting energy-efficient machines, using recyclable materials, and minimising waste. Recycled aluminium, for instance, requires much less energy than new aluminium. However, sustainable equipment often has high upfront costs. Integrating green technologies with traditional systems requires research and development. All this can be contingent on cooperation between academia and governments, and among governments. Unfortunately, know-how transfer has been the Achilles Heel of global warming mitigation.

At the current emission rate, the carbon budget — the GHG that can still be emitted if global warming can be kept below the Paris Climate Pact’s threshold of 1.5°C — could be completely depleted in about three years, according to the IGCC report. The report comes at a time when national representatives have assembled at Bonn for mid-year climate talks. With the heatwave sweeping Europe and several other parts of the world, the report’s warnings should resonate among the participants.

## He took red soil to silver screen

EVERYWHERE BHARATHIRAJA looked, he seemed to see potential. He looked around rural Tamil Nadu — the red soil of its fields, dried river beds and waving palm trees — and saw its cinematic beauty. Until he trained the lens on village life in his directorial debut *16 Vayathinile*, Tamil cinema’s aesthetics were bound by the limits of the studio and the sensibilities of its largely city-based storytellers. They determined what could be shot and whose stories could be told. By bringing in the sights and textures of rural Tamil life on the screen — gently exploring how caste, inequality and deprivation shaped relationships — Bharathiraja, who died this week at the age of 84, changed its grammar forever.

The filmmaker, who made such classics as *Kizhakke Pogum Rail*, *Sigappu Rojakkal*, *Vedam Puthithu* and *Mudhal Mariyadhai*, was also a master at spotting the potential in people. Partly out of instinct and partly as a gesture of defiance against an industry that had stymied his own ambitions of becoming a star, he launched the careers of actors like Revathi, Radhikaa and Karthik. His journey, from a village in Theni district to the ‘Iyakkunar Imayam’ (pinnacle among directors), inspired filmmakers such as writer-director K Bhagyaraj, Parthiban and Pandiarajan, whose work embodied the same granular approach to storytelling.

Music was key to the appeal of Bharathiraja’s films, owing largely to his long partnership with Ilaiyaraaja. A relationship that dated back to when the duo, along with the composer’s brothers, performed at communist meetings, it was instrumental in establishing the soundtrack of rural Tamil Nadu. Even today, songs like ‘Sendhoora poove’ (*16 Vayathinile*) and ‘Kodiyile malligai poo’ (*Kadalora Kavithaigal*), rooted in folk traditions and evoking a certain romance with the rural, continue to stir the imagination of moviegoers.

# R&D underspending in India has no one cause. It’s systemic as well as cultural

WHEN ANALYSTS encounter the observation that Indian businesses chronically underinvest in research and development, the instinct is to reach for systemic explanations and to resist cultural ones. The resistance is not unreasonable. Cultural explanations, carelessly deployed, slide into stereotypes, and stereotypes foreclose rather than illuminate. Yet the categorical rejection of culture as an explanatory variable creates its own blind spot, because some of the most persuasive systemic explanations turn out, on inspection, to incorporate cultural elements — not as fixed ethnic traits but as historically conditioned orientations that may change as the circumstances that produced them change.

The truth, as usual, lies in the interaction between multiple causes, none of which is individually sufficient.

### The captive market and its seductions

Begin with the most structurally respectable explanation: India’s domestic market is vast, and vastness, paradoxically, can be an impediment. A large captive market insulates producers from the bracing pressure of export competition, which has historically been the driving force behind quality improvement and technological upgrading. This is the R&D equivalent of Dutch disease — the same abundance that appears to be an asset quietly erodes the competitive muscle that exposure to harder markets would build. Companies that can grow for decades by serving a billion-plus consumers without venturing beyond the Subcontinent have little incentive to invest in the costly, uncertain process of frontier innovation. Why develop a better product when the existing one sells readily?

### The long shadow of colonial deindustrialisation

A second explanation reaches further back. Indian commercial communities have historically been trading rather than manufacturing communities, and while this characterisation admits exceptions, it reflects a genuine historical reality. Whatever manufacturing instincts and capabilities existed before colonial rule were, in many cases, systematically suppressed. The de-industrialisation documented by economic historians — the destruction of India’s textile industry, among others — was not merely an economic event; it reshaped the orientation of Indian enterprise toward commerce, intermediation, and arbitrage rather than production and innovation. The few families that retained or rebuilt manufacturing identity stand as evidence of what might have been more widespread had history taken a different course.

### Financialisation before its time

The third explanation may be the most consequential, and is the one with the richest empirical corroboration from other markets. India’s corporate sector underwent a degree of financialisation — a shift in priorities from productive investment to financial return — somewhat earlier than its level of industrial development warranted. This sequencing mattered enormously.

The empirical record from developed markets is sobering. William Lazonick’s research, published in the *Harvard Business Review* in 2014, documented how the shareholder-value doctrine drove American corporations toward stock buybacks and dividends at the expense of investment in capabilities. Between 2003 and 2012, the 449 com-



V ANANTHA NAGESWARAN

India’s corporate sector underwent a degree of financialisation — a shift in priorities from productive investment to financial return — somewhat earlier than its level of industrial development warranted

# From Qatar to US: Changing standards of sports justice



MIHIR VASAVDA

Los Angeles will host the 2028 Olympics, likely during the final months of Trump’s presidency. The IOC’s charter promises universality. Ensuring that promise may be one of the Games’ biggest administrative challenges

FOUR YEARS ago, much of the Western football world discovered its conscience. Ahead of the 2022 World Cup in Qatar, federations from Norway, Denmark and Germany — and many more — questioned the host’s human rights record. The tournament became a referendum on Qatar itself. Fast forward to 2026, and the contrast is hard to ignore. Days before the kick-off, Somali referee Omar Artan — selected by FIFA and due to become the first from his country to officiate at a men’s World Cup — was denied entry into the US despite holding a valid visa.

FIFA confirmed that he would miss the tournament because all referees are required to operate from the World Cup’s central training base in the US. Artan is one of Africa’s most respected referees and was named the continent’s best male referee last year. Yet, his World Cup dream ended at an immigration desk.

Former tennis great Martina Navratilova was among the few prominent sporting voices to question the episode. But compared to the moral outrage directed at Qatar before 2022, the silence has been deafening.

The Artan affair is not an isolated incident. Iran, one of the qualified teams, has spent the build-up navigating a maze of restrictions. FIFA regulations guarantee each federation a share of tickets for distribution among supporters, yet Iran says that allocation has effectively been withdrawn.

Journalists, officials and ticket-holding fans from other countries, too, have complained about visa troubles. Last weekend, Iraq striker Ayman Hussein was questioned for nearly seven hours, and his phone was checked when the team arrived in Chicago. The team’s photographer was held for more than 10 hours and was denied entry.

This comes against the backdrop of broader American travel restrictions that affect citizens from several nations. Security concerns and the Ebola

outbreak are cited as other reasons for the strictness.

In 2019, when India denied visas to Pakistani shooters ahead of the shooting World Cup in New Delhi following the Pulwama terror attack, the reaction from the Olympic body was swift and severe. It suspended discussions on future events in India and advised international federations against awarding Olympic qualification competitions to the country until guarantees were provided.

The message was clear: Host nations cannot selectively exclude eligible participants.

That principle appears considerably harder to enforce when the host is the world’s most powerful country. FIFA’s commercial future is tied to the North American market. Broadcasters, sponsors and governing bodies understand where influence resides.

Much of the criticism of Qatar was justified. The US, too, should be held to a difficult standard. Every host nation faces legitimate security concerns and immigration challenges. But consistency matters.

In two years, Los Angeles will host the 2028 Olympics, likely during the final months of Donald Trump’s presidency. The International Olympic Committee’s charter promises universality. Ensuring that promise may become one of the biggest administrative challenges of the Games.

Earlier World Cups have shown that great goals, underdog stories and unforgettable matches have a way of pushing politics into the background. That may happen again.

But long after the final is played, the memory of this World Cup may not simply be about football. It may also be remembered for exposing a truth about global sport: That principles are often applied unevenly, outrage is frequently selective, and morality sometimes depends on who holds the power.

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mihir.vasavda@expressindia.com

panies that had been continuously listed in the S&P 500 spent 54 per cent of their earnings on buybacks and another 37 per cent on dividends, leaving precious little for R&D. The central argument was that “maximise shareholder value” had been operationalised as “maximise short-term stock price”, with predictable consequences for long-run competitiveness. The distortions introduced by executive stock option schemes compound this problem. Research by John Core, Wayne Guay, and David Larcker on equity-based compensation has shown that options tied to short-term stock performance create incentives to manage earnings rather than invest in projects with distant payoffs. R&D expenditure, by its nature, suppresses near-term profits while creating competitive advantage over a horizon of five to 10 years — a horizon that typically outlasts both the executive’s tenure and the vesting period of their compensation package. The gains accrue to the executive’s successors; the costs fall on the executive’s own balance sheet. John Asker, Joan Farre-Mensa, and Alexander Ljungqvist, in a widely cited 2015 study comparing investment behaviour between publicly listed and privately held firms in the US, found that public companies invest substantially less — and are significantly more sensitive to short-

term stock price movements — than comparable private firms facing no such scrutiny. The mechanism was precisely the quarterly reporting cycle.

India’s corporate sector absorbed the structural features of financialised capitalism before it had fully developed the manufacturing depth and technological capabilities that American and European corporations pos-

● WORDLY WISE  
Football is the ballet of the masses.  
—Dmitri Shostakovich

# The trees that escaped Berger’s Ways of Seeing



SUMANA ROY

IT HAS been half a century since an English writer made a series of four films, and then made a book from them. We know that it revolutionised ways of looking at art, and also at humans. *Ways of Seeing* was published two years before I was born — I would first read it only 25 years later. It did not seem to matter to anyone, in those remaining years of the last millennium, that this was a book by a European man, using examples only from European art, focussed only on humans. It didn’t occur to anyone to ask: How many trees are there in *Ways of Seeing*? The answer is none, of course — what does that say about our ways of seeing? John Berger would have been 100 years old this year; his ways of seeing — that Matthew Hall has, in a different context, diagnosed as “plant blindness”, the socio-optical conditioning of the human species to not notice plant life around them — are not his alone; most of us suffer from this condition.

As someone who suffers from an obverse condition — of noticing plants, in a way that others have called obsessive — what does it mean to find oneself on the other side of the Berger world? I mean, of course, the obvious opposites — a woman, a non-European, from the Indian Subcontinent, raised by a different light, climate, art — but also the less obvious things. Berger was raised by a world where words like “climate” and “ecology” belonged to government brochures. He uses “ecology” in his book once: “Prior to the recent interest in ecology, nature was not thought of as the object of the activities of capitalism.... Aspects of nature were objects of scientific study, but nature as a whole defied possession”.

“All images are man-made,” Berger asserts. He never uses the word “tree” — his quotes include “apple”, “garden”, “wheat”, “cornstalk”; in two images we see trees in the background, providing shade to the women on whom he — and the artist — focusses his attention. I have no intention of being a correctionist, of playing a game where we scold Aristotle for not being a feminist or Hegel for not thinking of non-European societies. Yet, I feel an unease with the lack of attention to plant life and how it is evidence of the unequal distribution of attention to all living forms, as a result of which we find ourselves here today. Our ways of being have been compelled to accommodate other ways of seeing because of the world we find ourselves in — sweaty, unpredictable, one we can no longer trust as host, slightly hostile, unresponsive to our telepathy, biologically atavistic, with the chance of the return of organisms from an unrecognisable and unknown time.

Why must Berger’s ways of seeing give way to what I have, in my head, been calling ways of *treeing*? If *Ways of Seeing* was revolutionary in the way it saw humans in art, what could it imply for us to reverse our focus — where we notice moss and mycelium, fir and fern, not as compass needle but as the mercury in a thermometer?

Tell me then — is there a tree in the *Mona Lisa*? Roy, a poet and writer, is associate professor, Ashoka University. Views are personal

## 40 YEARS AGO

June 12, 1986



### 100cr duty relief for industry

THE GOVERNMENT announced concessions in customs and excise duty totalling about Rs 100 crore to help industry. Of this, the electronic industry will account for relief, mostly in customs duty, to the extent of Rs 60 crore. The decisions have been taken by the Finance Ministry in response to representations made by trade and industry during “open house” discussions held by the Finance Minister, V P Singh.

### Terrorists killed in Punjab

SIX PEOPLE, including three terrorists, were

killed and as many injured while the police nabbed 15 extremists besides four members of the dreaded Dashmesh Regiment during the past 24 hours in Punjab. The BSF, meanwhile, started taking charge of the terrorist-infested border district of Gurdaspur from the Central Reserve Police Force.

### Hegde, Chavan set up panel

THE CHIEF Ministers of Karnataka and Maharashtra met for two hours, virtually took the edge off the Karnataka-Maharashtra controversy on naming Kannada as the first language from the pre-school stage in Belgaum and other places across the boundary, as-

sured renewed warmth in ties, and vowed greater cooperation. The joint statement by Ramakrishna Hegde and S B Chavan said that a joint panel would look into the grievances of the linguistic minorities on either side.

### Sri Lanka bus bombing

TWENTY-TWO PEOPLE were killed and over 40 injured when bombs exploded in two Sri Lanka Transport Board buses in Trincomalee in the Eastern Province around 10.30 am. The bombs exploded near the inner harbour road, 200 yards away from the bus stand. Following the explosion, a curfew was imposed on the administrative district of Trincomalee.





DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate



ILLUSTRATION: C.R. SASIKUMAR

Implosion of Trinamool Congress raises a question: How relevant are regional parties today?

## Regional parties deepen democracy



MANOJ JHA

**I**N THE Nehruvian phase of Indian democracy, the country had just emerged from colonial rule and was grappling with challenges of an unprecedented scale. Alongside the joy of Independence came Partition and the assassination of Mahatma Gandhi. Millions were displaced, communities were torn apart, and the very idea of a united India appeared fragile.

Despite these immense challenges, India did not descend into chaos. Instead, there emerged a remarkable collective resolve to build a democratic nation-state. This does not mean that the Nehru years were free from tensions. Political churnings were already visible in different parts of the country. The demand for linguistic states, for instance, reflected a powerful assertion of cultural identities. Yet Nehru's political stature and his emphasis on federalism, democratic institutions and national integration created a sense that all regions had a stake in the Indian project. While India's democratic institutions survived and matured, the broad national consensus that had characterised the early years gradually weakened.

The Congress system began to lose its capacity to represent the full spectrum of regional aspirations. It was in this changing political landscape that regional parties emerged as major actors. It was a sign of democratic deepening. These parties gave political expression to voices and concerns that often remained underrepresented in national politics. They emerged from specific historical, linguistic, cultural and economic contexts and sought to articulate aspirations that were rooted in local realities.

In Tamil Nadu, the Dravidian movement challenged the perceived cultural and political dominance of the Hindi-speaking North. What began as a social and cultural movement eventually transformed into a powerful political force. In Punjab, regional politics reflected concerns relating to language, religion and federal autonomy. In Assam and other northeastern states, regional parties emerged from movements seeking recognition of local identities and greater control over resources. In Jammu and Kashmir, regional political formations sought to navigate the complex relationship between local aspirations and national integration. In Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and West Bengal, regional parties became vehicles for expressing distinctive political and developmental concerns. Perhaps the most important contribution of re-

gional parties has been their role in strengthening Indian federalism. They demonstrated that unity could be built through accommodation and negotiation.

The coalition era that emerged in the late 1980s and continued for much of the next three decades marked the high point of regional political influence. Governments at the Centre depended on the support of regional parties. States acquired greater bargaining power, regional concerns gained national visibility and the federal principle became more meaningful. This compulsion eased once the BJP secured single-party majorities in 2014 and 2019, even as governance continued to run through alliances.

The growing centralisation of political authority, the increasing dominance of national narratives and the expansion of national parties into traditional regional strongholds have raised questions about the future of regional formations. The clearest expressions of this centralisation are fiscal: The GST regime folding much of state taxation into a shared council, and the rising use of cesses and surcharges that sit outside the pool shared with states.

Some observers predict gradual decline of regional formations. Such predictions may be premature. India's linguistic, cultural, historical and economic differences cannot be wished away. As long as these diversities exist, political formations that articulate regional aspirations will continue to find relevance. It's true that in places, regionalism has hardened into parochial or nativist politics; yet the broader historical record suggests that regional parties have broadened representation, challenged entrenched elites and brought historically marginalised communities into the political mainstream.

The contemporary political landscape presents new challenges. The sharpest current test is the delimitation exercise. With Lok Sabha seats long frozen on 1971 figures, regional states fear that reapportionment by population would shift weight to the north and erode their influence.

India is not a nation-state in the conventional European sense. It is also a civilisational compact among multiple identities, languages, cultures and histories. Regional parties remind us of this reality. They ensure that the conversation between the Centre and the states remains alive. The challenge today is not to choose between national and regional parties, nor to view them through an adversarial binary. In a country as vast and diverse as India, the vitality of democracy will always depend on the capacity of the national imagination to accommodate regional aspirations. In that sense, the future of regional parties is inseparable from the future of the Idea of India itself.

The writer is a *Rajya Sabha* MP from *Rashtriya Janata Dal*

## New generation isn't bound by regionalism



ABHINAV PRAKASH

**T**HE IMPLSION of the Trinamool Congress is the terminal crisis of a syndicate that never functioned like a true political party. The TMC is not collapsing because the BJP outmanoeuvred it. It is collapsing because patronage machines, when stripped of patronage, have nothing left to hold them together. It is imploding because it was always structurally incapable of surviving the loss of power.

There is no incentive for the BJP to engineer the collapse of a party facing the wrath of the people and already in free fall.

The locus of the crisis is entirely internal. Dozens of MPs and MLAs are boycotting their own leader's meeting. Senior functionaries are accusing Mamata Banerjee of nepotism. They blame Abhishek Banerjee for having destroyed the TMC. None of this requires any outside force. It requires only the removal of the one thing that held them together, power.

This is the structural weakness of a particular kind of political formation that India has produced in abundance since the 1960s. Such parties lack intra-party democracy and internal accountability. Their origin lies in regional feudalism, often relying on one or two social groups rather than a cadre mobilised around an ideology or vision. They are what can be called "the party of leaders" as opposed to "the party of cadre", with local strongmen coming together as an interest group, depending on the personal relationship with the leader. When the founding leader weakens, the party does not survive as an institution.

Regional parties of the TMC variety did not emerge from ideological ferment. They emerged from anti-incumbency, a leader who broke with the ruling establishment or national party, mobilised a coalition of resentment, and rode it to power. When in power, the TMC built syndicates, cut-money networks, and an apparatus of violence. The TMC never had any party organisation but a system of coercive patronage. The TMC is, and always was, a franchise arrangement organised around a single leader and the access to state resources that leader could guarantee.

The TMC made an additional, fatal miscalculation, the attempt to hand the succession to a nephew lacking popular

legitimacy. Nepotism was compounded by a non-political professional class of consultants, data managers, and campaign designers inserted between the party's founding leader and its grassroots workers.

The workers in the towns and village booths found themselves lectured on strategy by executives who had never fought a single booth-level battle. It hollowed out whatever remained of organic loyalty to the TMC, replacing it with material expectations. Withdraw the material expectation, and you are left with nothing.

The TMC's crisis also raises a deeper question about the purpose and lifespan of India's regional parties. These formations arose at a specific historical moment, following the fracturing of Congress hegemony after 1967, the assertion of caste identities seeking political expression, and the primacy of hyper-local issues that national parties were then structurally ill-equipped to articulate. The TMC itself emerged from a specific anti-incumbency against the Left.

But India's new generation is not bound by regionalism in its imagination, aspirations, and scale. The politics of regional exceptionalism, the idea that states' interests are somewhat incompatible with the national interest, resonates less with a generation that consumes social media, competes in national examinations, aspires to national opportunities, and identifies with a rising India far more than with any subnational pride. The TMC's brand of sub-nationalism was always thin, borrowed from the Left's exhausted language, never rooted in civilisational depth. A party without ideology, without cadre, without a second tier of leadership, and without a coherent answer to why it should exist as a distinct political formation when faced with a nationally rooted, locally anchored party like the BJP was always one electoral defeat away from implosion.

The TMC was a holding company for individual ambitions. And when the holding company goes bankrupt, individual ambitions find other vehicles. The leaders leaving the TMC today are not traitors. They are merely doing what the TMC always trained them to do. The party built them that way. It has no right to be surprised. What is collapsing is not merely a party but a model of politics that was transactional, violent, nepotistic, and ideologically hollow. And now it has been decisively rejected by the people of Bengal. The obituary of the TMC is being written not in the strategy rooms of the BJP, but in the internal logic of what the TMC always was.

The writer is national vice-president, *BJP Youth Wing*

## Dowry deaths are about patriarchy and much more



DIPANKAR GUPTA

**I**HAVE just read the interesting article, "Patriarchy and the mother-in-law trope in India" by Audrey Dmello (*IE*, June 7). She is right on most counts but elides over a crucial detail. I don't mean to dispute her assessment, but a few additional issues need to be factored in.

One wonders why a once-oppressed new bride can oppress another just a generation later. Of course, patriarchy has a big role to play, but it is the specific type of patriarchy that matters.

There is patriarchy across the world, but that fact does not lock in with dowry deaths or even dowry. More importantly, there is patriarchy both in north and south India, but dowry deaths occur predominantly in the northern and central states, with the south and even Maharashtra figuring way down in this grisly tale.

So it must be patriarchy-plus that accounts for the bulging statistic of dowry deaths in the north. Uttar Pradesh records over 2,000 such deaths annually, while the figure is barely in double digits in Kerala. In terms of cases convicted, Maharashtra, too, has a low incidence of dowry deaths with a conviction rate as low as Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh.

Now, all these states have patriarchy in full flow, so why this difference? The missing link is the way marriage relations are conducted in these regions. In the north, the bride-giver's family is considered to be of lower social status than that of the bride-taker (recall the *anuloma* and *pratiloma* distinctions). The bride in this case is the beginning of gift-giving between these two families. The woman is the first gift, a supreme gift.

The rationale for dowry begins here. From this initial gift of the virgin (or *kanya-daam*) by the males of the bride's family begins the continued demand for prestations by the groom's family. This is not unusual and it solidifies, with multiple iterations, the asymmetrical relationship between bride-giver and bride-taker. The latter believe it is their ritually sanctioned right to demand gifts from the bride's side in perpetuity. Consequently, the bride is vulnerable in her wedded home and must bend as a subject member of the household.

Contrast this with the southern practice of marriage alliance. Here there is a prevalence of cross-cousin marriage, that is, with the mother's brother's daughter. If this rule is strictly followed, then women are returned a generation later to the same extended family that gave a woman earlier. The Gonds of Madhya Pradesh, who also follow this rule of cross-cousin marriage, fetchingly call it "*dudh lautana*", or return of the milk.

In this scenario, the bride is not a stranger in the groom's home nor is she a

supreme gift. She is, after all, a cousin! This immediately takes the sting out, in contrast with the unequal relations between bride-giver and bride-taker in the north.

In north India, the bride is constantly reminded of her subjugated status in her married home and this burden is willingly accepted by her side. This explains why her parents are reluctant to take her back even when they learn she is being harassed. If she should, unluckily, give birth to girls, she faces endless acrimony, for now her married family will accuse her of being responsible for pushing them down to accept a lower status when these girls have to be married. She has now debased the whole family.

Contrarily, if a boy is born, this woman becomes a bride taker and joins her husband's patriarchal family as a near-equal member. In many ways, the mother of the boy transforms into a sociological male. This establishes her position in her husband's household, which age alone cannot accomplish. As a newly morphed bride-taker, she has all the symbolic energy of the men in her husband's family.

This unequal relationship has tragic consequences on the flip side when it comes to farmers' suicides. In those states where dowry deaths are high, farmers' suicides are low. Hence, counterintuitively, the poor regions of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh (UP), notorious for high dowry deaths, have low rates of farmers' suicides. Once again, the explanation lies in the difference in marriage customs. This has little to do with poverty, as is often believed.

In the north and south, when an agricultural family is in debt, it is almost always the male in the household who must bear the responsibility. Very often, other family members have little information about their debt status. The male farmer starts by taking a loan. When he cannot repay it, he goes to informal sources, each more rapacious than the next. Finally, when he exhausts these, he turns to his wife's family for help because his own paternal

kinsfolk are as sunk as he is.

In the north, where dowry is common practice, there is no loss of face in a man asking his in-laws for financial help. This is just another kind of dowry giving and involves no shame. In the south, it is different. The farmer is now borrowing from his wife's family, with whom his relationship is not that of a superior. In the fullness of time, a girl from his family will be returned to his wife's family. Therefore, when this financially stressed farmer cannot repay the money he had borrowed from his wife's father or brother, he is shamed at home and in every family gathering. It is this mounting pressure that finally forces him to die by suicide.

Marriage and kinship explain a lot about both kinds of tragedies. One carries the tragic stain of dowry that leads young brides to death and the other the social shame that compels many male farmers to die by suicide. Patriarchy is a background factor but not the determining variable.

The writer is a sociologist



## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### TMC collapse

THE ISSUES highlighted in the editorial extend beyond West Bengal ('In TMC's implosion, a broader warning', *IE*, June 11). The repeated splits in the Shiv Sena, NCP and other regional parties reveal a wider organisational weakness. Parties built around dominant personalities often struggle to institutionalise leadership transitions or accommodate dissent. Although the Election Commission requires internal party elections, meaningful inner-party democracy remains rare. Electoral setbacks may trigger defections, but fragile party structures enable them.

Havya Garg, Chandigarh

THE EDITORIAL hits the nail on the head by remarking, "Out of power, why can't Banerjee keep her flock together?" While taking recourse to such fair-weather friendships, which have become more the rule than the exception nowadays, Mamata Banerjee seems to have grossly misread the whole lot of pre-poll writings on the political wall even in her home state ('In TMC's implosion, a broader warning', *IE*, June 11). Instead of honestly looking within and trying to prevent massive desertion by her own party MPs in favour of the NDA, she is reportedly trying to get on board the already sinking ship of the Congress

party. Could she not thereby be destined to commit an own goal and eventually become hostage to the out-of-sync policies of Rahul Gandhi, de facto head of this fast-declining grand old party?

SK Gupta, via email

### Broken marriages

THE RECENT context of the Supreme Court's judgment, where the contesting parties had been separated for 15 years and had the liberty to approach the apex court, reflects the hapless situation of many litigants for whom relief from broken marriages appears too costly to achieve within one's lifetime ('A dignified demise for a broken marriage', *IE*, June 11). While this has compelled many in urban India to switch to live-in relationships, which have their own complications, couples, particularly women in rural India, are often seen leaving it to destiny due to social and economic insecurities. Courts must refrain from taking a narrow approach, as a marriage that has reached court has arguably outlived its purpose, whether under a fault or no-fault framework. Reforms must be streamlined, considering that forcible continuation has its own vulnerabilities, while also providing solutions for alimony and custody.

Madhusree Guha, Kolkata



OPHELIA YUMLEMBAM

INDIA'S DECISION to accord Min Aung Hlaing a high-profile reception a few days ago signals a notable shift in its approach toward Myanmar. Moving beyond its previous wait-and-watch approach, New Delhi appears willing to engage directly with the administration in Naypyidaw in pursuit of its strategic, security, and economic interests.

For Myanmar, India was a logical choice for the new administration's first state visit. First, Naypyidaw is seeking to diversify its foreign policy and reduce its heavy reliance on China. For years, Beijing's practice of playing both sides — engaging both the military regime and certain ethnic groups — has created unease within Myanmar's leadership, which increasingly seeks

greater diplomatic manoeuvrability. Second, the military's control remains weakest in western and southwestern Myanmar along the Indian border, especially Rakhine State. This region is of importance to India as it hosts key Act East Policy (AEP) investments. Finally, economic considerations may have been a major driver of the visit. Myanmar's economy remains far below its pre-coup trajectory, with high inflation, weak growth, and nearly half of the population living in poverty.

India has good reason for deepening its engagement. The rise in refugee flows, cross-border insurgent activity, illicit trafficking networks and other non-traditional security threats has heightened concerns. The prolonged delays in key connectivity projects under the AEP have added to the urgency. While demonstrating a willingness to engage with the new administration in Myanmar, India also

underscored that its core national interests remain non-negotiable.

China is another important factor. For Myanmar, closer engagement with India offers an opportunity to reduce excessive dependence on China. For New Delhi, deeper engagement with Naypyidaw serves as a means of balancing Chinese influence in India's immediate neighbourhood. But achieving either objective will be challenging. Over the past five years, while many countries limited their engagement with Myanmar's junta, China continued to provide political, economic, and military support. Naypyidaw is unlikely to move away from its long-standing "Pauk-Phaw" relationship with Beijing. Unless alternative partners can offer comparable levels of support, investment, and security cooperation, China will remain Myanmar's most consequential external partner. Given the circumstances, India is

neither willing nor positioned to match China's level of engagement.

The absence of major agreements, substantial new commitments, or significant MoUs during Min Aung Hlaing's trip underscores that while India is prepared to engage, it remains reluctant to significantly expand cooperation as long as Myanmar's internal conflict and political uncertainties persist. Ultimately, the long-term trajectory of the relationship will depend largely on how the new administration in Myanmar manages its own political and security challenges and proves its commitment to addressing India's security concerns. Until its political and security landscape becomes more stable, India-Myanmar ties are likely to remain pragmatic, cautious, and limited in scope.

The writer is a research associate at the Organisation for Research on China and Asia





# RAVENSHAW UNIVERSITY

CUTTACK-753003, ODISHA (NAAC-A++)

## FACULTY RECRUITMENT: EXTENSION OF LAST DATE

In continuation to this Office Advertisement No.-1762 Dated 12.05.2026 (For the Post of Professor), No. 1765 Dated 12.05.2026 (For the Post of Associate Professor) and No. 1768 Dated 12.05.2026 (For the Post of Assistant Professor), the **closing date and time** for online submission of application form in HIMS portal is hereby extended from 11.06.2026 (11.59 PM) to 20.06.2026 (11.59 PM). Accordingly, the closing date of receiving the hard copy of the application along with the required documents through Speed / Registered Post is extended from 20.06.2026 (05.00 PM) to 29.06.2026 (05.00 PM).

All other terms and conditions mentioned in the above Advertisements remain unchanged.  
**No.2482 Date. 11.06.2026**

REGISTRAR

OIPR-11001/11008/1/26-27/0011

**Office of Bodhgaya Temple Management Committee**  
**Bodhgaya, Gaya, Bihar - 824231**  
Email ID: bodhgayatemple@gmail.com  
**Notice Inviting Tender**  
**Short Notice Tender No. 03/2026-27**

The Bodhgaya Temple Management Committee (BTMC), Bodhgaya invites sealed Tenders invites from reputed and experienced Public Relations (PR) Agencies/Firms for providing professional PR and communication services to the BTMC Bodhgaya, Bihar, India.

| Tender Schedule/Programme: |                                            |                                                                                       |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sl. No.                    | Activity                                   | Date/Time : Duration                                                                  |
| 1.                         | Last Date/Time for Submission of offer/Bid | 29/06/2026 Up to 03:00 p.m.                                                           |
| 2.                         | Date & time for Opening of Bid.            | 29/06/2026 at 04:00 p.m.                                                              |
| 3.                         | Bid Opening Date and Time                  | Will be communicated on the date of Bid opening.                                      |
| 4.                         | Contact person/Nodal Officer for queries   | Mr. Sujeet Kumar Mishra<br>Email: bodhgayatemple@gmail.com<br>Mobile. No. 97988994224 |

- Tender Documents along with detailed descriptions of the service and Terms and Conditions of the Tender can be purchased from office of Bodhgaya Temple Management Committee, Bodhgaya, Gaya, Bihar well as it can be downloaded from [www.bodhgayatemple.com](http://www.bodhgayatemple.com).
- Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of Rs. 50,000/- (fifty thousand) only should be in the form of Demand Draft drawn from a Scheduled Bank in Favor of Bodhgaya Temple Management Committee, Bodhgaya and payable at Bodhgaya.

**District Magistrate, Gaya -cum-Chairman, BTMC**

For further details please visit : [www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar)  
**PR. No. 005406 (District) 2026-27**

**नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।**

| GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                  |                                  |                                  |                                                                     | TENDER NOTICE                        |              |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH                                                                                                                                                                          | NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER                                                       | OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME) | AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES | WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH                                     | NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL |              |                                                                                     |
| SHAHABAD OPERATIVE SUGAR MILLS LTD., KURUKSHETRA                                                                                                                                                  | SALE OF APPROX 50000 QTLS OF MOLASSES FOR SEASON 2025-26 (KURUKSHETRA) + 6 WORKS | 08.06.2026<br>22.06.2026         | Rs. 11,20,000/-                  | <a href="https://tenders.hry.nic.in">https://tenders.hry.nic.in</a> | 9466114105<br>scsmpur@gmail.com      |              |                                                                                     |
| FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : <a href="http://www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in">www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in</a> or <a href="http://www.etenders.hry.nic.in">www.etenders.hry.nic.in</a> |                                                                                  |                                  |                                  |                                                                     |                                      | No- 46133HRY |                                                                                     |

**NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY**  
**Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida G.B. Nagar, (U.P)**  
**Website : [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in)**

### E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: [www.noidaauthorityonline.in](http://www.noidaauthorityonline.in) & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

**A) Fresh-Tender Work:**

| S. No. | Jobs No.                     | Name of the Work                                                                                                                         | Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs) |
|--------|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1      | 17/GM/SM(WC-7)/PH/ET/2026-27 | Engagement of Agency for Manual Based Night Sweeping and Housekeeping Service in Commercial/Market/Vending Zone/Public area WC-7, Noida. | 70.46                    |

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **12.06.2026 to 29.06.2026 up to 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated **30.06.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

**B) Re-Tender Work:**

| S. No. | Jobs No.                        | Name of the Work                                                                                                                                                         | Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs) |
|--------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 2      | 03/GM/SM(WC-9)/ET/2026-27       | Theme Painting of walls in Noida WC-8 and 9 Area, Noida.                                                                                                                 | 55.86                    |
| 3      | 09/GM/SM(WC-8)/ET/2026-27       | M/o Road (Premix in patch repair speed breaker and Mastic work 24.00 mtr. wide road in front of Vivek Vihar, Kendriya Vihar-II & Terminal Bus Stand in Sector-82) Noida. | 78.85                    |
| 4      | 22/GM/DGM/PE (PH)-II/ET/2025-26 | Cleaning & Desilting of main drain from various Sector/Village of PH-II Area Zone-V, Noida.                                                                              | 95.92                    |

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated **12.06.2026 to 18.06.2026 up to 5.00 PM**. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated **19.06.2026 at 11.00 AM**.

**General Manager (Civil) NOIDA**

**CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA**

**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER**  
**KANPUR MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**

Ref No- D/47/C.E./C.M.G./26-27 Date- 11-06-2026

### E-Procurement Tender Notice

Nagar Nigam Kanpur invites percentage rate bids on <http://etender.up.nic.in> from eligible bidders for the following package under the CM-GRID Scheme Phase-3.

| Sl. No. | Package No. | Nagar Nigam                  | Road ID               | Included Roads                                                                             | Length of Road (Km) | Estimated Cost Excluding GST (Rs. Lakh) | Total Estimated Cost of Work (Rs. In Lakh) | Earnest Money Deposit (Rs. In Lakh) | Duration of Construction Work (in Months) | Tender Fee Including GST |          |
|---------|-------------|------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------|
| 0       | 1           | 2                            | 3                     | 4                                                                                          | 5                   | 6                                       | 7                                          | 8                                   | 9                                         | 11                       |          |
| 1       | Package 01  | Kanpur Municipal Corporation | KMC/CMG/25-26/PK-G-01 | Improvement of road from Gurudev Road To ICAI Bhawan Road & Awadhपुरi Road Under Zone -06. | 1.942               | 3756.69                                 | 67.41                                      | 3824.10                             | 76.49                                     | 15                       | 46689.00 |
| TOTAL   |             |                              |                       |                                                                                            | 1.942               | 3756.69                                 | 67.41                                      | 3824.10                             | 76.49                                     | 15                       | 46689.00 |

### Timeline for Tender

| Sr No | Event                                                         | Date & Time                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Availability of tender document on E-Tender portal of NIC.    | 15.06.2026,03:00 After noon                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2     | Date & Place of Pre-bid meeting                               | 19.06.2026 3:00 PM URIDA Head Quarter, Directorate urban local Bodies Lucknow/Online Email: <a href="mailto:chiefengineernagarnigam@gmail.com">chiefengineernagarnigam@gmail.com</a> |
| 3     | Last date and Online for submission of bid on E-Tender Portal | 30.06.2026, up to 3:00PM                                                                                                                                                             |
| 4     | Opening of tender (Technical bid)                             | 30.06.2026, 4:00 PM                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 5     | Tender Identification No.                                     | "CMGRIDS"                                                                                                                                                                            |

Any Corrigendum/addendum or any other additional information related to the tender shall be available at Kanpur Nagar Nigam Website: [kmc-up.nic.in](http://kmc-up.nic.in) and tender can be seen at e-tender portal from 19.05.2026 i.e. <http://etender.up.nic.in>

Under IBT Clause-10, Kanpur Nagar Nigam has right to issue corrigendum/addendum which will not publish in any newspaper. All bidders are advised to keep watch on E-tender portal on daily basis. Any corrigendum/addendum or any other additional information related to the tender will be available at Kanpur Nagar Nigam Website [kmc-up.nic.in](http://kmc-up.nic.in) and tender can be seen at e-tender portal from 19.05.2026 i.e. <http://etender.up.nic.in>

It will be mandatory to pay the Earnest Money and Tender Fee price of the said tender online through e-tender portal during online bid submission.

Any queries/complain related to tender can be sent before 24 Hrs. of Pre-Bid meeting date and time i.e. 28.05.2026 at e-mail-id's [chiefengineernagarnigam@gmail.com](mailto:chiefengineernagarnigam@gmail.com) and [urida.goup@gmail.com](mailto:urida.goup@gmail.com), so that queries can be resolved at Pre-Bid meeting. No queries/complain will entertain after 29.05.2026, 3:00 PM.

**Sd/- Chief Engineer,**  
**Kanpur Municipal Corporation**

**HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY**  
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.  
E-mail: [hreapkl-hry@gov.in](mailto:hreapkl-hry@gov.in), [officer.rera.hry@gmail.com](mailto:officer.rera.hry@gmail.com)  
Website: [www.haryanarealestate.gov.in](http://www.haryanarealestate.gov.in)

### PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of the Real Estate Project namely "Anantmm City"- a Residential Plotted Colony on land measuring 26.433 acres situated in Sector-11A, Assandh, Karnal being developed by Cititech Township Developers Pvt. Ltd.

- The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-KNL-17-2018 dated 20.06.2018 valid upto 31.12.2019 and renewed upto 09.09.2026.
- The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force for one more year subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
- The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.
- The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 30.06.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

**Secretary (Acting)**  
**HRERA Panchkula**

No. 46147/HRY

**E-TENDER NOTICE**  
**E- Tender Notice No 43 to 56-26-27**  
Dy. Rly. Manager, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works up to 15.00 hours on 29.06.2026 as below:-  
**Tender No.: 43, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.1(A)- Zonal works for Service Building at Bikaner under ADEN/HQ/NWR/Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 52674246.44, Earnest Money: Rs. 1053500.00, **Tender No.: 44, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 1(B)- Zonal works for Staff quarters & Bungalows at Bikaner under ADEN/HQ/ NWR/Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 51093313.61, Earnest Money: Rs. 1021900.00, **Tender No.: 45, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 1(C)- Zonal works for Horticulture works in Staff Quarters, Station Bungalows, Staff Bungalows, Bikaner & Lalgarh under ADEN/HQ/ Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 9339920.00, Earnest Money: Rs. 186800.00, **Tender No.: 46, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 2A- Zonal works for work shop & general store at Lalgarh under ADEN/HQ/NWR/ Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 25047880.92, Earnest Money: Rs. 501000.00, **Tender No.: 47, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 2B- Zonal works for service buildings at Lalgarh under ADEN/HQ/NWR/ Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 31503386.50, Earnest Money: Rs. 630100.00, **Tender No.: 48, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 3- Zonal works for Staff Quarters & Bungalows at Lalgarh under ADEN/HQ/ NWR/Bikaner, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 35805799.40, Earnest Money: Rs. 712100.00, **Tender No.: 49, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.4 A(I) - Zonal works for Service Building over ADEN/Line/Bikaner Sub Division for NPS(Ex.)-NTZ(Ex.) Section (For 2026-27 & 2027-28), Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 23377581.23, Earnest Money: Rs. 467600.00, **Tender No.: 50, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.4A(II)- Zonal works for Service Building over ADEN/Line/Bikaner Sub Division for LGH (Ex.)-PLC (Ex.) Section (For 2026-27 & 2027-28), Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 30943450.64, Earnest Money: Rs. 618900.00, **Tender No.: 51, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.4B(I) - Zonal works for Staff quarters over ADEN/Line/Bikaner Sub-Division for NPS (Ex.)-NTZ (Ex.) Section (For 2026-27 & 2027-28), Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 29517750.39, Earnest Money: Rs. 590400.00, **Tender No.: 53, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.5 (A)- Zonal works for Service Buildings over ADEN/Suratgarh Sub-Division (For 2026-27 & 2027-28), Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 44484373.67, Earnest Money: Rs. 889700.00, **Tender No.: 54, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No.5(B) Zonal work for Staff Quarters over ADEN/Suratgarh Sub-Division (For 2026-27 & 2027-28), Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 56300068.38, Earnest Money: Rs. 1126000.00, **Tender No.: 55, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 6(A)- Zonal works for Service Building over Hanumangarh Sub Division under ADEN/Hanumangarh-I, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 35527143.93, Earnest Money: Rs. 710600.00, **Tender No.: 56, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 6(B)- Zonal works for Quarters over Hanumangarh Sub Division under ADEN/Hanumangarh-I, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 38171526.66, Earnest Money: Rs. 763400.00, **Tender No.: 57, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 7(A)- Zonal works for Service building over Hanumangarh Sub Division under ADEN/Hanumangarh-II, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 57897562.30, Earnest Money: Rs. 1158000.00, **Tender No.: 58, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 8(A)- Zonal works for Service Building over SSA Sub Division under ADEN/SSA/N.W.Rly., Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 42452009.64, Earnest Money: Rs. 849100.00, **Tender No.: 60, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 8(B)- Zonal works for Staff Qtrs over SSA Sub Division under ADEN/SSA/ N.W.Rly, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 36634073.94, Earnest Money: Rs. 732700.00, **Tender No.: 62, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 9(B)- Zonal works for Staff Qtrs over BNW Sub Division under ADEN/BNW/ N.W.Rly, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 50219069.30, Earnest Money: Rs. 1004400.00, **Tender No.: 64, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 10(B)- Zonal works for Staff quarters over Sadulpur Sub Division under ADEN/ Sadulpur, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 660380.70, Earnest Money: Rs. 120800.00, **Tender No.: 65, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 11(A)- Zonal works for Service Building over Ratangarh Sub Division under ADEN/ Ratangarh, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 48264789.76, Earnest Money: Rs. 965300.00, **Tender No.: 66, Name of Work with its Location:** Zone No. 11(B)- Zonal works for Staff quarters over Ratangarh Sub Division under ADEN/ Ratangarh, Approx. Cost of Work: Rs. 50725966.01, Earnest Money: Rs. 1014500.00, **Note-** Other terms & conditions will be shown on the website [www.reps.gov.in](http://www.reps.gov.in).  
847-PH/26

Follow us on NWRRailways

**E-Tender Notice**  
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Colony, N.E. Railway, Gorakhpur for & behalf of President of India invites "OPEN" E-Tender through online (e-tendering) for the following work:  
**Tender Notice No. & Description of Work: 06-2026-Colony Name of Work:** Augmentation of Power Supply by Provision of compact sub station capacity 2x500 KVA at UTS substation under jurisdiction of Dy.CEE/Colony, Approx. Value: ₹96,30,468.00 E.M.D. Money: ₹1,92,600.00 **Cost of Tender Form:** Zero **Completion time/period from the date of issue of acceptance letter:** 09 Months.  
**Note:-** ● E-tender online will be submitted up to 15:00 Hrs on date 02.07.2026. ● Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway JREPS official website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in).  
CPRO/Elect-71 Dy.CEE/Colony Gorakhpur  
DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

**MADHYA PRADESH RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY**  
(An Agency of Panchayat & Rural Development Department, Govt. of M.P.)  
3rd Floor, Vikas Bhawan, Arera Hills, Bhopal (M.P.)  
(GST No. 23AAATM9054A3ZX)  
No./5790/22/D-12/MPRRDA/2026  
Bhopal, Dated : 11.06.2026

### NOTICE INVITING TENDER No. 1281 (MPRCP-World Bank-B.W.)

Online Tenders for Construction of Rural Roads/CDs with 5 years maintenance are invited on the E-Procurement System portal <https://mptenders.gov.in> as detailed below :-

- Name of Work** – Construction/Up-gradation of Rural Roads under PMGSY including maintenance for Five year after construction

| S. No. | Name of District | No. of Packages | Total PAC (In Rs.) |
|--------|------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| 1      | Sheopur          | 1               | 32943964.00        |

- Bid document may be purchase online from **15.06.2026 (17:30 hrs.)** and last date for online bid submission is **30.06.2026 (17:00 hrs.)**
- Other Critical dates and details can be viewed in the detailed N.I.T. and tender document on the above-mentioned portal and concerned PIU.

**CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (TENDER)**  
M.P. Madhyam/126340/2026

**FIRST LADY TEACHER MATA SAVITRI BAI PHOOLE GOVERNMENT GIRLS COLLEGE, REWARI**  
Tender Notice for Hostel Mess for the Year 2026-27

Applications are invited under the sealed cover for the Hostel Mess contract for one year from 15th July 2026 to 14th July 2027. The relevant details related to Hostel Mess contract can be obtained from the college office during working days (10:00 AM to 3:00 PM). The important dates and information are detailed below.

**Time Schedule of Bidding Process**

| Date of Publication of tender notification on official website | 15th June, 2026                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Last date for receipt of filled in tender document             | 1th July 2026 (Upto 4:00 PM)           |
| Date and time of opening of bid                                | 3rd July 2026 at 11:00 AM (Room No. 7) |
| Commencing date of the Tender                                  | 15th July 2026                         |

**Note:** This tender Document contains 12 pages and bidders are requested to sign on all the pages.

- Bidding document is free and can be downloaded from the college website or from the office of undersigned during office hours.

College website Link:  
<http://gcwrewari.ac.in/Download Forms>  
(To download the form)

**Sd/- Principal**  
**F.L.T.M.S.B.P.**  
**Govt. Girls College, Rewari**

No. 46149/HRY

**Notice for invitation of tender**  
For and behalf of President of India, CRSE (Chg)/NWR invites tender as per following details:- **Tender Notice No:** M/442/2 Mechanized laundry/KWP dated 10/06/2025 (G&M Bid No.GEM/2026/B/7648035). **Name of work:-** Turnkey Contract for Setting up of 14 TPD Mechanized laundry at Khatipura, Jaipur on BOOT (Build, own, operate & transfer) model for a period of 10 years. **Cost of tender:-** ₹1,19,77,24,057.50/-; **EMD cost:-** ₹6138700; **Pre bid meeting:-** 17.06.26 at 11 hrs in PCME/NWR office, Near Jawahar Circle, Malviya Nagar, Jaipur-302017; **Date of closing of submission of tender:-** 20.07.26 at 18.00 hrs. **Date of opening of tender:-** 20.07.26 at 18.30 hrs; Tender documents can be downloaded from <https://www.gem.gov.in> 857-AM/26  
Please join us on /NWRRailways

### E-Tender Notice

e-tender Notice No. 21 of 2026-27 (Open) - Engg/DDU

On line (through e-tendering) for the following work is invited by DRM/Engg/ DDU for and on behalf of the President of India from experienced and financially as well as technically sound contractors including those enlisted with the Railway, CPWD, BSNL, MES, PWD and other public sector undertakings. 1. **Tender No.27-DDU-DEN-HQ- 26-27, Name of the work with its location :** Construction of Subordinate Rest House at DDU under ADEN/HQ/DDU. **Advertised Value:-** ₹ 21172410.89. **Earnest Money :-** ₹ 423500.00, **Closing Date & time for submission of e-tender :** 30.06.2026, Up-to 12:00 hrs., **Website particulars of e-tendering :** [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) **Divisional Railway Manager, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Division**  
**PR/0379/DDU/ENGG/T/26-27/32**

**e-Auction Notice**  
Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial), East Central Railway, Dhanbad, on behalf of President of India invite open e-Auction through IREPS portal vide website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) for awarding the contract. Details are as under:-  
**Sr. no. (1), e.Auction Catalogue :** Rail Coach Restaurant, e.Auction Catalogue no. : Misc-RCR-2-DHN. **Scheduled date and time of e.Auction starting details :** 22.06.2026 From 15.30 hrs. **Details of work and name of station :** Provision for installation of Rail Coach Restaurant at vacant space of dismante Petrol Pump (Old Hindustan petrol pump out side of DHN Stn) at North Side of Dhanbad station for a period of 05 years.  
All prospective bidder are advised to visit the website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) for full details and participate against the above mentioned e.Auction as per schedule given vide column No. iv. Railway Administration reserves the right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason what so ever.  
**Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial), Dhanbad**  
**PR/0381/DHN/COMML/EAN/26-27/32**

**कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय सोन बराज प्रमंडल, इन्द्रपुरी**  
E-mail :- [eeindrapuriwdr@gmail.com](mailto:eeindrapuriwdr@gmail.com)

फ़ॉक :- 927 / इन्द्रपुरी

**अल्पकालीन कोटेशन दर आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- 03 / 2026-2027**

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि सोन बराज प्रमंडल, इन्द्रपुरी अन्तर्गत निम्नांकित उपस्करों/ सामग्रियों के क्रय हेतु मुहर बंद कोटेशन दर आमंत्रित किया जाता है। सभी कोटेशनदाताओं द्वारा दर संबंधित मुहरबंद लिफाफा जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 30.06.2026 को अपराह्न 3:00 बजे तक प्रमंडलीय कार्यालय (सोन बराज प्रमंडल, इन्द्रपुरी) में निर्धारित है। तत्पश्चात दर को खोलने की निर्धारित तिथि 30.06.2026 को अपराह्न 3:30 बजे है।

- कोटेशनदाता द्वारा उद्धृत दर कोटेशन दिनांक 30.06.2026 को (एक दिन) अपराह्न 3:00 बजे हाथो-हाथ / निबंधित डाक के माध्यम से अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय में प्राप्त किया जाएगा। समयावधि व्यतीत होने के उपरांत कोटेशन किसी भी परिस्थिति में प्राप्त नहीं किया जाएगा।
- कोटेशन संबंधी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राप्ति हेतु अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय अथवा मोबाईल संख्या **7463889412** पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

**कार्यपालक अभियंता**  
**सोन बराज प्रमंडल, इन्द्रपुरी।**

उक्त सूचना [state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar) पर भी देखी जा सकती है।  
PR. No.005516 (WRD) 2026-27

**नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।**

| GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                          |                                                                                            |                                  | TENDER NOTICE                    |                                 |                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| SR. No.                                                                                                                                                                                           | NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH                                 | NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER                                                                 | OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME) | AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES | WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH | NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAIL/EMAIL    |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                 | HARYANA STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION LIMITED, PANCHKULA | SALE OF WHEAT PROCURE BY IT FROM MANDIS DURING RSM 2025-26 I.E. DISTRICT KATHAL AND AMBALA | 08.05.2026<br>30.06.2026         | --                               | https://etenders.hry.nic.in     | 9416919106<br>secretary-ho@hswc.org.in |
| FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : <a href="http://www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in">www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in</a> or <a href="http://www.etenders.hry.nic.in">www.etenders.hry.nic.in</a> |                                                          |                                                                                            |                                  |                                  |                                 | No- 46125/HRY                          |

**बिहार राज्य भवन निर्माण नियम लि०, पटना (बिहार सरकार का उपक्रम)**  
**E-RFP INVITING NOTICE NO. 05(CNS) / 2026-27**

- OFFICER INVITING BIDS
- DATE OF INVITING BID
- START DATE OF DOWNLOADING
- LAST DATE AND TIME FOR UPLOAD OF BID DOCUMENTS
- TIME, DATE AND PLACE OF PRE-BID MEETING
- PLACE OF SALES/RECEIPT OF Bid Documents
- TIME AND DATE OF OPENING TECHNICAL BIDS
- TIME AND DATE OF OPENING FINANCIAL BIDS
- LAST DATE OF BID VALIDITY
- Following work :-

| Sl. No. | Dist      | Name of the work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Consultant Fee for Preparation of DPR | Earnest Money (In Rs.) | Cost of Bid document (In Rs.) | Bid processing Fee | Time of submission of DPR after work order | Name of PIU |
|---------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1       | 2         | 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4                                     | 5                      | 6                             | 7                  | 8                                          | 9           |
| 1       | Darbhanga | RFP - Selection of Consultant for Preparation of Model Drawings/Dpr for Development of Nehru Stadium under Darbhanga Commissioner as a National / International Stadium. *Detailed Requirements and others. Details will be made available through Eproc-2 website. *Construction of Aesthetically appealing structure with campus development. *Tentative Plot size is 256 M X147 M | As per offer                          | ₹100000-00             | ₹5,000-00                     | ₹5,90-00           | 30 days                                    | Darbhanga   |

For further details please visit : [www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar](http://www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar)

**PR. No. 005577 (B&C) 2026-27**

**बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, बिक्री एवं सेवन अवैध है। इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज करायें, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।**  
**टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268**

**Chief General Manager**  
**Bihar State Building Construction Corporation Ltd. Patna**



# ‘Every minute is precious’: Arunachal doctor who cheated death, thanks to emergency call

**Parimal A Dabhi**  
*Ahmedabad, June 11*

TADIE MRA, 32, had a narrow escape when he abandoned his lunch to rush for an emergency call, and within "four minutes" the Boeing 787 8 Dreamliner crashed on his hostel mess building on the fateful afternoon of June 12 last year, killing 19 on the ground and 241 on board.

Tadie Mra, hailing from Arunachal Pradesh, has been to the crash site only twice since and is sceptical about government plans to build a PG hostel complex at the same place for medical students.

"I think that if they build a new (hostel) there, nobody will stay there. You just think, around 260 people have died there...I do not think anybody will stay there. Such a horrible (incident) happened. Nobody will stay there," Tadie Mra, a final year PG student at Gujarat Cancer Research Institute from Arunachal Pradesh, told *The Indian Express*.

Speaking about the lesson learned from the incident, Mra said: "Time is very important. Even one minute is very precious. Because, it can save your life. My life has also been saved by four minutes. And secondly, I have realised that one should never be in stress. You never know when death or an accident can strike. It can come in any form. Therefore, one should never take stress. One



Among the 260 casualties of the incident were four medical students who were having lunch at the hostel mess when the plane crashed in Ahmedabad.

should be happy in the present. We cannot bring back the past and we cannot predict the future. What we are living is present and it is very important."

He suggests that instead of a hostel, an office could be built there. "I will not recommend making a hostel (there). Nobody will stay. It is such a haunted place (now)...As per human mindset, people will have fear...It will be better for office use, during day time. A hostel should not be built there. (It could be built) somewhere nearby. But to build a hostel at the same spot will not be proper. Nobody would (prefer to) stay there. They will be full of

fear...This is my personal opinion," Tadie, who is expected to become a cancer anesthesiologist, said.

On June 12, a Gatwick-bound Air India flight AI171 crashed within moments after taking off from Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport in Ahmedabad. A total of 260 persons were killed in the crash as the plane crashed on the hostel building of BJ Medical College, Atulyam.

Recently, the Gujarat government had announced a Rs 105 crore hostel complex at the crash site as the Atulyam 1-4 buildings were severely damaged in the crash.

Tadie was in Room no 302 in the Atulyam-2 which is among those burnt down.

Recalling the day June 12, 2025, Tadie said that he was in the hospital in the morning with duty in the day care surgery unit.

"At 1.10 pm, I went for lunch at the mess building. It was hotter than it is today. Then, I got a call from the CT Scan room to reach there since an urgent biopsy was to be done. But since some daal had spilled on my clothes, I went to my room (in Atulyam block) to change clothes. At that time, I also wanted to take a shower. But, because of paucity of time, I did not take a shower and immediately left for the hospital. Had I stayed

to take a shower, I would not have survived. My entire room was finished. Family members of another doctor who was living in a room in front of mine had died in the crash," Tadie said.

After leaving the hostel room, Tadie said that when he reached the 1200-bed hospital building in the Ahmedabad Civil Hospital Campus, he heard a loud sound.

"Somebody said that a gas cylinder had blasted...But then I came to know that the plane had crashed on Atulyam. From the distance, I could see huge smoke stacks coming out from that direction. Then a video came on a Whatsapp group of some of my senior doctors. I immediately went back to see my room and belongings. However, the police did not allow me to go inside. Fire officials were trying to douse the fire, but they were failing to do so. During this time, I saw bodies of many people burning at the site," Tadie added.

He further said, "We deal with (serious) patients in ICUs and operation theaters daily, but this feeling (at the crash site) was horrible. I am scared of going there (even today)... After the incident, I have gone there only twice. Once, we were called to check our belongings. And then we were called to collect our belongings. After that, we have never gone there... we get nightmares looking at that building."

## Gym owner shot dead, Lawrence gang 'member' under scanner

*Chandigarh:* A gym owner was shot dead at point-blank range by two masked bike-borne assailants in Haryana's Hansi early Thursday, police said.

The incident took place around 6 am near Fountain Chowk, when the gym owner, identified as Kapil Redhu (25) from a village in Jind, was conducting an outdoor exercise session for a group of six to seven people, they said.

Doctors found nine bullet injuries on the body of Redhu. A woman gym member, Shikha, also sustained pellet injuries when the bullets were fired and is undergoing treatment at a private hospital in Hisar.

Meanwhile, a social media post, purportedly posted in the name of Hari Boxer and Sundar Hanshi, believed to be members of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang, claimed responsibility for the murder. The post, in Hindi, also tagged Lawrence Bishnoi and other gang members.

According to the post, gangsters RD Dhaliwal, Harman Sandhu, and Vikram Kridan were behind the killing. The post claimed that Redhu was involved in plotting the shootout in Shekhpura and Dhani Purnia a few days ago.

The post also claimed that Redhu was warned, but he did not adhere to it. It added that the warning has been issued to several others as well, and they will also meet the same fate. **ENS**

## Himachal Pradesh doubles entry fee to wildlife parks

*Shimla:* Himachal Pradesh has introduced new regulations for sanctuaries, titled the Wildlife Protection Himachal Pradesh (Amendment) Rules, 2026, under which the entry fee for Indian citizens and foreign nationals has been doubled. The new regulations, amended from the Wildlife Protection Himachal Pradesh Rules, 1975, came into effect on Wednesday.

Under the revised fee structure for entry and activities within the sanctuary areas, the Indians citizens will be required to pay an entry fee of Rs 300 compared to the former fee of Rs 150. Similarly, for the foreign nationals, the fee is fixed at Rs 600, which is twice as much as the previous fee of Rs 300. The officiating Chief Secretary-cum-Additional Chief Secretary (Forests) KK Pant has issued the notification in this regard.

The revised rules prescribe enhanced charges for entry, photography, research activities, and the use of vehicles and equipment in wildlife sanctuaries.

The state has a total of 28 wildlife sanctuaries covering approximately 5965 sq km. **ENS**



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**30 June 2026**

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(Statutory body constituted under the Act of Parliament No.35 of 2002)  
Ministry of Minority Affairs, Government of India



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**PROGRAMME SCHEDULE (TENTATIVE)**

| Particular                                        | Date / Time                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Last date for Online Application                  | 19 <sup>th</sup> June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Entrance Test Date & Time (Tentative)             | 28 <sup>th</sup> June 2026 (Sunday)<br>Paper-I: General Studies (Objective Type) 10:00 am – 11:00 am<br>Paper-II: CSAT (Objective Type) 11:00 am - 12:00 pm<br>Paper-III: Essay & GS (Mains-Written) 02:00 pm - 04:00 pm |
| Result of Written Test (Tentative)                | 10 <sup>th</sup> July 2026                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Personality Test (Interview) (Tentative)          | 20 <sup>th</sup> July 2026 onwards                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Final Result (Tentative)                          | 25 <sup>th</sup> July 2026                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Last date for completion of Admission             | 5 <sup>th</sup> August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Notification for waiting list candidates          | 7 <sup>th</sup> August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Admission for waiting list candidates             | 10 <sup>th</sup> August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Commencement of Classes (Orientation) (Tentative) | 12 <sup>th</sup> August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                             |

**ELIGIBILITY**  
Graduates and Final Year Graduation Students (as per UPSC eligibility norms)

**LAST DATE TO APPLY**  
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| UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION                                                                                                             |                                                                                      |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------|
| PROGRAMME OF EXAMINATIONS/RECRUITMENT TESTS (RTS) - 2027                                                                                    |                                                                                      |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
| SL No.                                                                                                                                      | Name of Examination                                                                  | Date of Notification | Last Date for receipt of Applications | Date of commencement of Exam | Duration of Exam |
| 1.                                                                                                                                          | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 09.01.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 Days           |
| 2.                                                                                                                                          | Combined Geo-Scientist (Preliminary) Examination, 2027                               | 02.09.2026           | 22.09.2026                            | 10.01.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 3.                                                                                                                                          | Engineering Services (Preliminary) Examination, 2027                                 | 16.09.2026           | 06.10.2026                            | 31.01.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 4.                                                                                                                                          | CBI (DSP) LDCE                                                                       | 16.12.2026           | 05.01.2027                            | 27.02.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAY            |
| 5.                                                                                                                                          | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 13.03.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 Days           |
| 6.                                                                                                                                          | CISF AC(EXE) LDCE-2027                                                               | 25.11.2026           | 15.12.2026                            | 14.03.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 7.                                                                                                                                          | N.D.A. & N.A. Examination (1), 2027                                                  | 02.12.2026           | 22.12.2026                            | 11.04.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 8.                                                                                                                                          | C.D.S. Examination (I), 2027                                                         |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
| 9.                                                                                                                                          | Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination, 2027                                       | 13.01.2027           | 02.02.2027                            | 23.05.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 10.                                                                                                                                         | Indian Forest Service (Preliminary) Examination, 2027 through CS(P) Examination 2027 |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
| 11.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC Examination                                                        |                      |                                       | 05.06.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 12.                                                                                                                                         | Engineering Services (Main) Examination, 2027                                        |                      |                                       | 18.06.2027 (Friday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 13.                                                                                                                                         | I.E.S./I.S.S. Examination, 2027                                                      | 10.02.2027           | 02.03.2027                            | 18.06.2027 (Friday)          | 3 DAYS           |
| 14.                                                                                                                                         | Combined Geo-Scientist (Main) Examination, 2027                                      |                      |                                       | 19.06.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 15.                                                                                                                                         | Central Armed Police Forces (ACs) Examination, 2027                                  | 17.02.2027           | 09.03.2027                            | 04.07.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 16.                                                                                                                                         | Combined Medical Services Examination, 2027                                          | 03.03.2027           | 23.03.2027                            | 18.07.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 17.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 31.07.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 18.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 07.08.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 19.                                                                                                                                         | Civil Services (Main) Examination, 2027                                              |                      |                                       | 20.08.2027 (Friday)          | 5 DAYS           |
| 20.                                                                                                                                         | N.D.A. & N.A. Examination (II), 2027                                                 | 12.05.2027           | 01.06.2027                            | 19.09.2027 (Sunday)          | 1 DAY            |
| 21.                                                                                                                                         | C.D.S. Examination (II), 2027                                                        |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
| 22.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 25.09.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 23.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 16.10.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 24.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC Examination                                                        |                      |                                       | 23.10.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 25.                                                                                                                                         | Indian Forest Service (Main) Examination, 2027                                       |                      |                                       | 21.11.2027 (Sunday)          | 7 DAYS           |
| 26.                                                                                                                                         | Reserved for UPSC RT/Examination                                                     |                      |                                       | 04.12.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| 27.                                                                                                                                         | S.O./Steno (GD-B/GD-I) LDCE                                                          | 15.09.2027           | 05.10.2027                            | 18.12.2027 (Saturday)        | 2 DAYS           |
| Note:- The dates of notification, commencement and duration of Examinations/ RTS are liable to alteration, if the circumstances so warrant. |                                                                                      |                      |                                       |                              |                  |
| CBC-55101/14/0001/2627                                                                                                                      |                                                                                      |                      |                                       |                              |                  |



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PERSONAL FINANCE

How NRIs can make equity-like returns — from bank deposits

Siddharth Upasani  
New Delhi, June 11

THE RESERVE Bank of India's (RBI) Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposit swap scheme, which aims to boost foreign inflows, is an alluring investment opportunity for non-resident Indians (NRIs). On Wednesday, banks began raising interest rates on these deposits. HDFC Bank increased rates to 6% on three to five-year deposits. YES Bank is offering 6.5-6.6%. This 6-6.6% return is only the tip of the iceberg — thanks to leverage.

How leverage works in finance

Leverage means borrowing money to amplify the return from an investment. The leverage is 2x if a person borrows two times the money they have, or their capital; it is 10x if ten times the capital is borrowed. This leverage can help NRIs make huge returns from FCNR(B) deposits. Say an NRI in the US wants to deposit \$1 million in an FCNR(B) deposit for three years. While depositing this money will get an annual return of 6%, the NRI can borrow \$10 million from a US bank — for three years — at their lower interest rates and put this money in the FCNR(B) deposit. A three-year loan in the US costs around 4.5%. So, the interest from the FCNR(B) deposit of \$11 million in Year 1 is \$660,000, while the cost of the borrowed \$10 million is \$450,000. This means a net gain of \$210,000. After three years, the \$11 million deposit at 6% will be worth \$13.1 million. Repayment on the \$10 million loan at 4.5% will be \$11.4 million, resulting in a gain of \$1.7 million on a capital of \$1 million — or a compounded annual rate of interest of 19.3% (see table).

Equity-like returns

Two crucial factors determine how high this final rate of return can be. The first is the difference between the rate of interest on the FCNR(B) deposit and the rate at which NRIs can borrow abroad to leverage their capital. The greater the difference (or spread, in financial parlance), the greater is the return. The second is the leverage. The higher the leverage, the higher the return. Emkay Global Financial Services says: "Returns from the scheme approach equity-like returns as leverage is increased". As investors take advantage of the ability to take leverage, "flows under the scheme could be at least \$50-\$5 billion (around 1.2% of GDP) and possibly even higher". In 2013, when the swap scheme was first announced as a temporary measure to boost foreign inflows, NRIs used leverage to pour in \$26 billion — around 1.4% of India's GDP at the time — into FCNR(B) deposits.

Allocating leverage

But how is the NRI able to use leverage in the first place? Because of something called a letter of credit. Normally, Indian banks can't issue guarantees or letters of credit that assure repayment of money that has been borrowed. However, the RBI has decided this rule does not apply for the purpose of this FCNR(B) swap scheme. As such, an NRI can get a letter of credit from the Indian bank with which they are making the FCNR(B) deposit and use it to borrow from the American bank, who is now assured of being paid back by the NRI once the FCNR(B) deposit matures. The NRI wins, the American bank wins, the Indian bank wins, and the Indian economy wins.

How much an NRI can make

|                                    | LEVERAGE |          |
|------------------------------------|----------|----------|
|                                    | 5X       | 10X      |
| NRI's capital                      | \$1 m    | \$1 m    |
| NRI borrows                        | \$5 m    | \$10 m   |
| Cost of borrowing (interest rate)  | 4.5%     | 4.5%     |
| FCNR(B) deposit amount             | \$6 m    | \$11 m   |
| FCNR(B) deposit interest rate      | 6%       | 6%       |
| Repayment sum on 3-year US loan    | \$5.7 m  | \$11.4 m |
| FCNR(B) deposit after 3 years      | \$7.1 m  | \$13.1 m |
| NRI's return                       | \$1.4 m  | \$1.7 m  |
| Compounded annual rate of interest | 11.9%    | 19.3%    |

RATES, LEVERAGE ARE HYPOTHETICAL SCENARIOS; INDIAN EXPRESS CALCULATIONS

AVIATION

Amid uncertainty over AI 171 report, a look at the key theories behind the crash

Sukalp Sharma  
New Delhi, June 11

FRIDAY MARKS the first anniversary of the Air India flight AI 171 crash that killed 260 people. The one-year mark is also when air crash investigators are typically expected to reveal some of their findings. All eyes, therefore, are on India's Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB). There are two primary theories about the likely causes of the Boeing 787-8 Dreamliner crash. The first is pilot action, widely reported in Western media. The second is a catastrophic electrical or systems failure, a theory that has found support among India's pilot community, a section of aviation safety experts and even a few Boeing whistleblowers. The trigger for the crash, as identified in the AAIB's preliminary report released after a month of the accident, was the transitioning of both engine fuel control

switches from 'RUN' to 'CUTOFF' position almost immediately after liftoff from Ahmedabad. The critical question is this: How did the switches, which control the flow of fuel to the engines, transition? Over the past year, the AAIB and other wings of the Ministry of Civil Aviation have been tight-lipped about the investigation, save for the preliminary report and press releases to clarify or deny Western news reports based on leaks in the US or Europe. In the run-up to the crash's first anniversary, too, there is silence on what the AAIB will put out, and in what form. The indications are that the agency may not be able to furnish the full investigation report, and could instead issue an interim report or a status update. According to Reuters and Bloomberg, the final report is expected to be delayed by a few months as the detailed technical analysis of the ill-fated aircraft's engines is yet to be completed in the US.

AIR INDIA CRASH  
a year later

POLITICS

In PoK protests, weight of history, woes of the present



YASHEE

AT LEAST 15 people have been killed in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) as protests rage a month ahead of scheduled local elections. Authorities have responded with a crackdown, banning the group leading the protests, announcing a bounty for the arrest of some leaders, and clashing with the locals. While PoK has seen a number of protests since 2023, a recent Pakistan Supreme Court verdict on reservation of seats in the PoK assembly has become a flashpoint.

Why are people in PoK protesting?

In 2023, residents first mobilised against rising electricity bills and shortages of subsidised wheat. PoK residents argue that since significant hydropower is generated from the Mangla project in this region, they should not have to pay hefty electricity bills. The perks and privileges given to government officials amid the economic slide in Pakistan has been another irritant. The protests are spearheaded by the Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC), founded by traders, professionals and civil society activists. "The people in Kashmir are embittered and angry for a lot of reasons. They say the Mangla dam was built without their consent, and while their people were displaced for it, they still pay high power tariffs. The region has always been underdeveloped; there has been heavy security deployment because of militancy. The economic grievances have been sharpened by the issue of political representation. The Legislative Assembly is largely controlled by Islamabad bureaucrats," analyst Ayesha Siddiqua, Senior fellow at King's College, London, who hails from Pakistan, told The Indian Express. The government has been talking to the JAAC and claims that several of their demands have been met. However, the biggest sticking point is the 12 seats in the PoK Assembly reserved for Jammu and Kashmir migrants settled in different parts of Pakistan. The locals have long demanded that this reservation be abolished, while the authorities have argued that it is a lengthy process requiring a constitutional amendment. Earlier this



Police patrol an area in Muzaffarabad, Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, Tuesday. PTI

month, the PoK Supreme Court held that an amendment in the region's constitution "was not a concession to be wrested" from the government.

What is this reservation of seats?

Under the PoK constitution, the 12 seats are divided among "refugees settled in Pakistan", with some seats going to Punjab, some to Sindh, etc. The election of these members happens outside PoK geographically as well as operationally, as the local Election Commission doesn't conduct the polling. Locals say these seats are effectively used by the federal government to get their people into the PoK Assembly. Apart from these 12, five seats are reserved for women, one for Ulamas (religious scholars), one for Kashmiris living overseas, and one for "technocrats". So, in a House of 53, PoK voter elect only 33 people. However, opposition is sharper against the 12 refugee reservations, as, Siddiqua said, "The local population feels that people with no connection to Kashmir get elected on these. They say MQM-wallahs (a party that represents Urdu-speaking immigrants from India), get into our Assembly." There is also an economic angle. "Out of the 53 seats in the Assembly, 20 are controlled by the Centre under cover of various reservations. The Army basically controls these seats. But the funds for these representatives come from PoK's kitty. The locals argue that since they don't elect these

Crackdown

With the world's eye on Pakistan amid its Iran war negotiator role, wouldn't the government be more cautious about how it treats Kashmiri protesters?

Siddiqua said on the contrary, the international situation would embolden the government. 'They know no one is going to lecture them on human rights right now.'

people, they should not have to spend on them either," Dr. Dhruvajyoti Bhattacharjee, Senior Research Fellow at Indian Council of World Affairs, New Delhi who focuses on Pakistan, told The Indian Express. Those who support the reservation point to the fact that India too allotted seats in the Assembly of the state and later the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir for people living in parts occupied by Pakistan. However, these seats are kept vacant, unlike in PoK. What was unusual this time? The government has banned JAAC and booked its leaders on stringent charges, including terror and sedition. There has also been a violent crackdown. India on Tuesday condemned the "police brutality" in PoK and hoped "the international community will hold Pakistan accountable for its misdeeds and abuses." A significant PoK diaspora lives in the UK, and has been calling attention to the happenings there. Bradford East MP Imran Hussain, along with other Members of UK Parliament, have written to Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper over the issue. Hussain also posted on X, "I have called for an immediate end to the lockdown, the immediate restoration of communications, and the urgent resumption of peaceful table talks and negotiations at the heart of which must be respect for Kashmiri human rights."

LEGAL

Why Khurram Parvez got bail despite stringent UAPA conditions

Amaal Sheikh  
New Delhi, June 11

FOUR-AND-A-HALF YEARS after his arrest in a terror-conspiracy case investigated by the National Investigation Agency (NIA), Kashmiri rights activist Khurram Parvez was granted bail by the Delhi High Court on Wednesday. The Division Bench comprising Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dudeja held that the prolonged period that Parvez spent in custody, along with the slow progress of the trial and his disability, had justified his release despite the stringent bail restrictions under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). "The appellant's right under Article 21 of the Constitution of India need to be balanced and may even trump the restriction imposed under Section 43D(5) of the UAPA," the court said. The bail order pertains to the case in which Parvez was arrested in November 2021. Parvez, however, will continue to remain in jail on account of another NIA case of 2020, in which he was formally arrested

in 2023 while already in custody. The bail application in that case remains pending before the trial court. The case against Parvez The NIA case originated from an FIR registered in November 2021, alleging that the banned terror outfit Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) had established a network of operatives and over-ground workers across India through a handler. While Parvez was not named in the FIR, he was arrested during the investigation. According to the NIA, Parvez was a part of a larger conspiracy involving LeT operatives and supporters. He was alleged to have collected information related to army movements near the Line of Control, which Parvez disputed, stating that the information "primarily revolves around fact-finding, research, and documentation of atrocities faced by civilians due to state excess and/or militancy."

What the High Court held

The court held that the period of imprisonment without progress in trial had to

Bail yardstick

The court held that the period of imprisonment without progress in trial had to be taken into consideration. The appellant's right under Article 21 need to be balanced and may even trump the restriction under Section 43D(5) of the UAPA,' it said.

be taken into consideration. Parvez had spent almost four and a half years in custody, and the proceedings were still at the stage of arguments. The court observed that "the long period of incarceration of the appellant and the fact that there is no likelihood of the trial ending soon as also against the yardstick of bail being the rule, while denial thereof being an exception. The appellant's rights under Article 21 of the Constitution of India need to be balanced and may even trump the restriction imposed under Section 43D(5) of the UAPA." The court noted that the prosecution case against Parvez rested substantially on the statement of the co-accused Muneer Ahmad Kataria, who had turned approver in 2019 and whose evidence remained to be tested during trial. Legal framework The case turns on Section 43D(5) of the UAPA, which states that courts should not grant bail if, upon examining the case diary or chargesheet, they find reasonable grounds to believe that the "accusations

against such person is prima facie true". In practice, this creates a significantly higher threshold for bail than in ordinary criminal cases. Over the last few years, however, courts have increasingly been confronted with whether an accused should be kept in prison indefinitely while waiting for trial. In Union of India v. K.A. Najeer (2021), the Supreme Court held that constitutional courts retain the power to grant bail where prolonged incarceration and delay in trial threaten fundamental rights under Article 21. It noted: "At the commencement of proceedings, the courts are expected to appreciate the legislative policy against grant of bail, however, these restrictions will melt down where there is no likelihood of the trial being completed within a reasonable time and the period of incarceration already undergone has exceeded a substantial part of the prescribed sentence." At the same time, recent SC decisions in the cases of Gulfisha Fatima and Syed Ifkhar Andrabi, along with a recent reference to a larger bench of the top court, show that the law remains in flux.

had sufficiently established deliberate pilot action as the cause of the crash. Some safety experts have suggested that the aircraft may have suffered a major electrical failure as it took off, which could have cut fuel supply to the engines. The flight data recorder would have recorded it as the fuel control switches moving to the 'CUTOFF' position even if they didn't actually move. Moreover, a US-based aviation safety advocacy group claimed in January that the crashed aircraft had experienced a number of engineering, manufacturing, quality, and maintenance problems in its service life of 11 years, leading to electrical systems failures. In a whistleblower report to the US Senate Permanent Subcommittee on Investigations, the Foundation for Aviation Safety alleged that critical safety concerns pertaining to the Boeing 787 aircraft fleet persist. The group suggested that "latent defects" could be a cause of the accident and remain a concern.



The tail of the Boeing 787-8 Dreamliner in June last year. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE/FILE

The two theories

The preliminary findings narrowed the focus to the transitioning of the fuel control switches from 'RUN' to 'CUTOFF' within a second of each other, moments after the plane became airborne.



PM SURYA GHAR SEES 40 LAKH INSTALLATIONS SO FAR

# Local cell mandate may hit solar scheme

Pratyush Deep  
New Delhi, June 11

THE CENTRE's plan to install rooftop solar panels in 75 lakh households by year-end may hit a few bumps due to the limited availability and rising costs of these panels made from domestically-manufactured solar cells.

About 40 lakh rooftop systems have been installed under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana so far, adding over 12 gigawatts (GW) capacity. Vendors and installers empannelled under the scheme across multiple states told *The Indian Express* that they are struggling to procure Domestic Content Requirement (DCR)-compliant solar panels, which are mandatory under the scheme.

Some claimed that the waiting period was 25–30 days.

DCR-compliant solar panels are those in which locally manufactured solar cells — components that convert sunlight into electricity — are used. Taking cognizance of the issue, Santosh Kumar Sarangi, Secretary at Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) on Monday held a meeting with domestic solar cell manufacturers to emphasise the need to ensure adequate availability of domestically-manufactured solar PV cells and DCR solar modules, especially for vendors and installers engaged in setting up of Distributed Renewable Energy (DRE) solar projects like solar rooftop plants and solar agricultural pumps, while also keeping the prices reasonable.

"Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE), through REC Limited and National Institute of Solar Energy (NISE), is keeping a close eye on the availability and prices of domestically manufactured solar cells and modules and is closely monitoring the situation," the ministry said in response to queries sent by *The Indian Express*. "With domestic solar PV cell manufacturing capacity expected to rise substantially in the next few months, the demand supply situation is expected to improve further," it added.

## New mandate triggers price rise

According to the ministry, prices of DCR solar PV modules — domestically manufactured modules made using domestically produced solar PV cells —



Centre has made it mandatory for all projects to use only locally manufactured solar cells in the solar panels. REUTERS

have risen in May.

The ministry attributed this price increase in May to a likely surge in demand from developers seeking to commission net-metering and open-access renewable energy projects before the May 31, 2026 deadline, after which the exemption from mandatory domestic cell sourcing requirements expired.

From June 1, the government made it mandatory for all domestic, commercial and industrial solar projects to use only locally manufactured solar cells in the solar panels deployed in those projects.

While the move is aimed at reducing India's dependence on imports and strengthening the domestic solar manufacturing ecosystem, industry stakeholders say it has also exposed a critical supply gap.

India currently lacks sufficient domestic cell manufacturing capacity to meet the rapidly growing demand for solar installations. In 2025-26, India added around 45 GW of solar capacity. Against an annual solar module production of around 60-65 GW, India's solar cell manufacturing capacity stands at only about 30 GW. As a result, a significant portion of the country's module production has historically relied on imported cells.

Even though the Domestic Content Requirement (DCR) has long been mandatory for rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar scheme, the recent extension of domestic cell sourcing norms to additional segments, including commercial and industrial projects, has significantly increased demand for solar modules manufactured using locally produced cells.

Industry stakeholders say the sudden surge in demand

has outpaced available domestic manufacturing capacity, creating a supply-demand mismatch. This has led to shortages of DCR-compliant modules and a sharp rise in prices, potentially slowing the rollout of rooftop solar systems and other distributed renewable energy projects across the country.

## 'Project execution slowdown'

Several vendors who install solar systems under the PM Surya Ghar scheme told *The Indian Express* that they are grappling with a severe shortage of DCR-compliant solar modules. They said that even when modules are available, prices have risen sharply.

Vendors from Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Odisha reported waiting periods of 25–30 days for DCR-compliant panels, with many approaching the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) seeking intervention.

"The industry is currently facing a severe shortage of DCR-certified solar modules. Leading manufacturers such as Adani, Waaree, Premier Energies and other major suppliers are operating at full capacity and have long waiting periods for deliveries," said Vijay Kumar, President of the Solar Ardent Association in Haryana and Managing Director of Indivm Energy Private Limited. According to Vijay, the supply crunch has left many rooftop solar installers across the country struggling to procure modules in the required quantities, leading to delays in project execution and uncertainty for consumers who have already received approvals or made advance payments.

FULL REPORT ON  
[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM)

KEY GOVERNANCE ISSUES NOT ON AGENDA

# Tata Sons board meets today to clear accounts

George Mathew  
Mumbai, June 11

THE BOARD of Tata Sons, the holding company of the Tata group, is scheduled to meet on June 12 to consider and approve the annual accounts and dividend for the financial year 2025-26.

However, key issues that have attracted significant attention in recent months — including a possible extension of Chairman N Chandrasekaran's tenure and the long-pending question of a potential listing of Tata Sons — are not on the agenda, according to people familiar with the developments.

Sources said there is also little likelihood of any decision regarding the appointment of new nominee directors from Tata Trusts to the Tata Sons board. The matter has been delayed as the board of Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) has been unable to convene and take decisions following an order issued by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner.

Tata Trusts, through vari-

ous entities, collectively holds about 66% stake in Tata Sons and exercises significant influence over the governance of the conglomerate.

The issue of Chandrasekaran's continuation as chairman had come up earlier this year but was deferred amid differences within the board.

On February 24, a decision on granting Chandrasekaran a third extension was postponed after he himself requested the Tata Sons board to defer consideration of the matter. The request came after disagreements reportedly surfaced during a board meeting.

Although Chandrasekaran's second term as chairman is set to conclude only in February 2027, directors of Tata Sons had earlier expressed support for granting him a third extension.

However, concerns were reportedly raised during discussions by Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata regarding the performance of some group companies and losses incurred in certain businesses, according to sources familiar with the



Tata Trusts, through various entities, collectively holds about 66% stake in Tata Sons. REUTERS

deliberations. Following the discussions, Chandrasekaran requested that the matter be taken up at a later stage. Noel Tata serves on the Tata Sons board as a representative of Tata Trusts.

Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor Company Venu Srinivasan is also a Tata Sons director representing the Trusts.

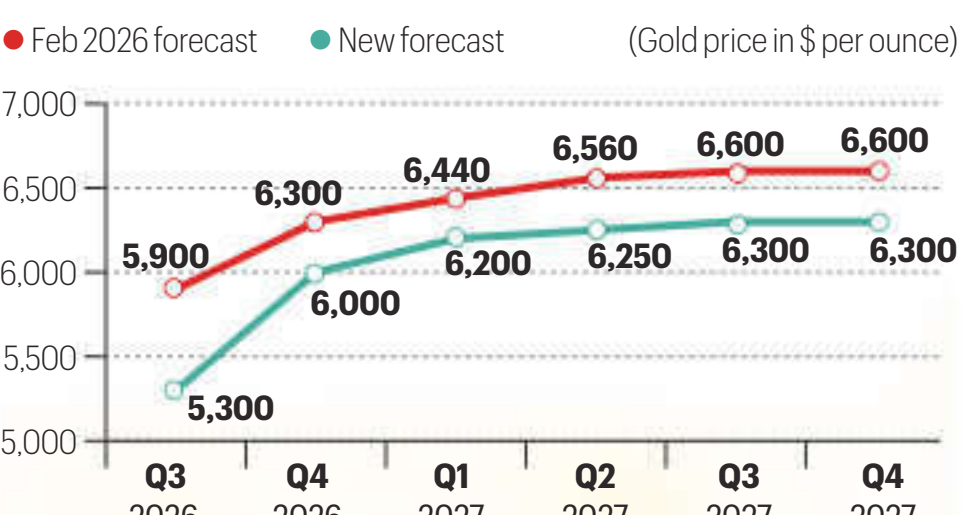
## • JP MORGAN LOWERS GOLD PRICE FORECAST

Gold prices started rising in the second half of 2025 and hit a record high of around \$5,500 per ounce in January. Since then, they have cooled, with investment demand also declining. In May, Indian gold ETFs saw outflow of Rs 725 crore, down from the record Rs 24,040 crore in January.

• This week, JP Morgan analysts lowered their price forecast for gold, noting that the yellow metal is "stuck in a bit of a technical no-man's land".

• Since gold does not offer any actual returns apart from its price appreciation, it usually performs poorly when interest rates rise, making the US Federal Reserve's interest rate decisions a key determinant.

• "A Fed that feels emboldened by stronger employment momentum and crystallises behind a need to fight higher for longer inflation could begin to crack investor demand," Greg Shearer, head of Base & Precious Metals at JP Morgan, said.



# TCS ties up with Anthropic to help clients on enterprise AI adoption

ENS Economic Bureau  
New Delhi, June 11

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), India's largest IT services company, on Thursday announced a global strategic partnership with Anthropic, the frontier AI company behind Claude, to help customers scale enterprise AI adoption.

TCS will setup a dedicated Business Unit focused on delivering strong customer value propositions, joint industry solutions and deep AI expertise on the Claude family of models through early access to Claude models, TCS said.

"In regulated industries, most AI initiatives stall at the pilot stage, where the requirements for accuracy, auditability and oversight are far more stringent, and the consequences of error significantly

higher. This partnership is designed to overcome those barriers," it said in a statement.

Combining TCS' governance, controls and implementation expertise will enable enterprises to deploy Claude confidently in production, not just in experimentation, TCS said. Dario Amodei, Co-founder and CEO, Anthropic, said, "We built Claude to be safe, trusted, and helpful, particularly in contexts where accuracy matters most. This partnership deepens our commitment to India, our second-largest market, with TCS bringing Claude to enterprises and professionals across the region and globally, including 50,000 of its employees."

As a global premier partner in the Claude Partner Network, TCS will bring Claude models to enterprises that demand accuracy, deep integration, resil-

ience and strong governance, the Indian tech firm said.

Combining scaled internal deployment, joint go-to-market offerings, industry co-innovation, and workforce enablement, the partnership gives clients a practical path to enterprise-wide adoption and measurable outcomes, it said.

TCS said it will equip 50,000 associates across engineering, finance, legal, marketing, and sales with Claude through enterprise-wide licensing. By deploying Claude internally, TCS will gain first-hand experience to transform its own operations while applying those insights to drive client success, TCS said.

TCS and Anthropic will jointly go to market with AI solutions and services across industries including highly regulated sectors. FULL REPORT ON  
[WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM)

# Protecting industry from unfair trade practices of certain countries: Goyal

New Delhi: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said that countries safeguard their domestic industries, and India is no exception. But India remains committed to navigating trade challenges through dialogue, cooperation, and mutually beneficial engagement, he said.

"...when the EU, the US, and the UK are trying to safeguard their domestic steel industry against competition, or even India for that matter, protecting our economy from unfair trading practices of certain geographies, where we find overcapacity, dumping of goods into India at predatory pricing,

"These are the realities of life you have to confront. Usually in these situations you try to find ways to mitigate it, you ignore

some, you take action against some countries," Goyal said at the annual meeting of India Global Innovation Connect here.

Goyal acknowledged that countries often adopt different approaches depending on their domestic interests, but stated that India remains committed to navigating such challenges through dialogue, cooperation, and mutually beneficial engagement. "Unfortunately, the WTO as a forum is not very effective right now, so action has to be almost bilateral....

"But overall, world trade, at the aggregate level, is very much rule-based, still under the WTO framework. There will be some aberrations," he said, adding that some countries have different standards for different sets of products. PTI

## • BRIEFLY

## Centre waives excise duty on ethanol-blended petrol

New Delhi: The Centre has waived excise duty on variants of ethanol-blended petrol, a notification by the finance ministry said. The waiver is applicable on E22, E25, E27 and E30 variants of petrol. In the notification, the ministry said excise duty will be 'nil' on petrol with 22%, 25%, 27% and 30% ethanol blend. The excise duty waiver is aimed encouraging customers to move towards ethanol-blended petrol. The move comes against the backdrop of petrol and diesel prices rising by nearly Rs 7.50 a litre in the second half of May. PTI

merchant bankers said. Companies, led by non-banking financial firms, are raising more than 310 billion rupees (\$3.24 billion) through up to five-year bonds this week, the bankers said.

The supply is one-third of what was raised in April and May, according to Reuters data. The Reserve Bank of India on Friday announced a raft of measures aimed at drawing dollars into the country, including raising subsidised deposits and incentivising banks and state-run companies to raise funds overseas. REUTERS

## Asus to begin production of gaming laptops in India

New Delhi: Taiwanese PC maker Asus plans to start production of gaming laptops in India during the ongoing financial year, a senior company official said. Paramjeet Singh Mehta, head of product and marketing for the consumer business at Asus India, said the company plans to meet 25-30% of demand in the country through local production. PTI

## India sees \$3 bln debt fundraising rush after RBI moves: Bankers

Mumbai: Indian firms are rushing to raise short-term debt after the central bank's measures to support the rupee triggered a sharp fall in borrowing costs, four

## • MARKETS

|                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br>Sensex<br>73,832.55<br>-150.63<br>-0.20% | <br>NIFTY<br>23,161.60<br>-53.35<br>-0.23% | <br>Gold ▼<br>₹1,44,782   | <br>US Dollar ▲<br>₹95.76 |
|                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                 | <br>Silver ▼<br>₹2,32,591 | <br>Oil ▲<br>\$92.58      |

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 10, 2026

# 'Single price for multi-exchange stocks'

New Delhi: SEBI on Thursday proposed a mechanism to harmonise the base price used for pre-open call auctions and price bands for stocks listed on multiple exchanges to address price divergence arising from non-trading on one or more platforms. In a consultation paper, SEBI said it has observed instances in certain illiquid stocks where non-trading on one exchange and continued trading

on another have led to significant divergence in closing prices across exchanges.

It noted that stock exchanges currently apply scrip-wise price bands independently based on their respective previous-day closing prices. However, there is no mechanism to adjust price bands on exchanges where no trading takes place, resulting in progressive divergence in prices of the same stock. According to

SEBI, such divergence may also increase the possibility of a stock remaining non-traded on one of the exchanges.

To address the issue, the regulator has proposed that if a stock trades on all exchanges or remains non-traded across all exchanges on the previous day, each exchange should continue to use its respective latest closing price for determining the subsequent day's price bands. PTI

LOWERS ITS GLOBAL GROWTH OUTLOOK FOR 2026 TO 2.5% AMID ESCALATING CONFLICT IN WEST ASIA

# World Bank raises India's FY27 growth forecast to 6.6%

ENS Economic Bureau  
New Delhi, June 11

THE WORLD Bank marginally raised its growth outlook for India to 6.6% from 6.5% for the financial year 2027 (FY27), even as it cut its global growth forecast for 2026 to 2.5% due to the war in the West Asia.

In its June 2026 Global Economic Prospects report, the World Bank raised India's growth estimate for FY28 by 0.6 percentage point to 7.2%.

"Despite heightened uncertainty related to the conflict, economic activity in India remained robust early this year, supported by resilient domestic demand," the World Bank said, adding that private consumption, particularly in rural areas, has been strong, with urban demand recovering. Collections of taxes from domestic sales have also in-

creased steadily. To mitigate price pressures arising from higher energy costs, as well as shortages of agricultural products, especially fertilizers, several measures have been implemented in India, including a reduction in fuel taxes.

However, it said the moderation in growth from 7.7% in FY26 to an estimated 6.6% in FY27 reflects a slowdown in private demand growth owing to higher energy prices and other input costs, although a reduction in Goods and Services Tax rates should provide some support to consumer demand.

"Reduced US tariffs and the expected implementation of free trade agreements will likely mitigate the impact of weaker external demand due to the conflict, particularly on merchandise exports. Growth is then anticipated to rebound



In several economies, including India, fiscal deficits are anticipated to rise, the Bank said. FILE

over the next two financial years, driven by firming domestic demand and a pickup in export growth," it said.

In several economies, including India, fiscal deficits are anticipated to rise, partly owing to increases in subsidies

intended to counter surges in energy prices, it said.

In India, reduced revenues due to tax reforms are forecast to be partly offset by slower capital expenditure growth and reductions in non-essential current spending, it added.







● SATURDAY'S GAMES

GROUP B

Canada vs Bosnia & Herzegovina  
Toronto, 0030 hrs (Saturday)

GROUP D

USA vs Paraguay  
Los Angeles, 0630 hrs (Saturday)  
ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Neymar hasn't played any warm-up game. ASSOCIATED PRESS

Neymar absent from Brazil's training

NEYMAR WAS absent yet again from Brazil's training ground at Morristown in New Jersey on Wednesday, as the team prepare for their World Cup curtain-raiser against Morocco on Saturday, while also celebrating coach Carlo Ancelotti's 67th birthday. The talisman continues his intensive rehabilitation for a grade-two calf injury suffered while playing for Santos in Brazil in mid-May. The 34-year-old is certain to miss the first game, and there is no indication yet whether he will feature in subsequent group matches.

Japan's captain Endo injured

JAPAN WILL not be able to avail the services of their designated captain Wataru Endo at the 2026 FIFA World Cup, with the midfielder withdrawing his participation with a foot injury. Having undergone surgery in February, the Liverpool player made his return to the national team in a friendly against Iceland on May 31, but had to be substituted at half-time. In his absence, Ajax's Ko Itakura has been named as the stand-in captain.



Abde Ezzalzouli suffered a freak collision with Chadi Riad. REUTERS

Two injuries for Morocco

MOROCCO HAVE been dealt with two major blows even before playing a game at the 2026 FIFA World Cup, with central defender Nayer Aguerd and winger Abde Ezzalzouli ruled out with injuries. Aguerd has been nursing a groin injury and could not recover in time, while Ezzalzouli suffered a freak collision with teammate Chadi Riad.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE



USA fans supporting the home team during the warm-up match against Germany where the visitors won 2-1 in Chicago on Sunday. REUTERS

US open campaign: No Trump, home fans outnumbering rivals

Coach Mauricio Pochettino dials back on his full press habit to factor in reality of Pulisic & Co's tempo



Sandip G  
Mexico City, June 11

THE BIGGEST anticlimax for co-hosts USA's first game against Paraguay is the absence of its president Donald Trump. A central character in the country's successful World Cup bid, the overbearing cynosure in the draw ceremony and the most ubiquitous headline stealer in the prelude to the tournament, he would be in Washington DC to attend walk-throughs of the weekend's UFC event. Instead, Secretary of State Marco Rubio will attend the game.

But home support is expected to be tremendous—nearly 65,000 homes supporters are projected to heave in the SoFi Stands in California. Usually, outnumbered by the adversary's crowd even on home soil, American fans have flocked to watch their practice games as well as warm-up in the Irvine, about 50 miles north of the Inglewood Stadium before the Paraguay game. Nearly 33,000 applied for access to watch them train, and 5,500 procured it. "[The] environment was crazy. It's more than we expect," coach Mauricio Pochettino said. "We are so grateful."

Similar turnouts surprised them in the build-ups too. As many as 57,000 filed in for the friendly against Senegal, which they nailed 3-2. "Everybody was saying how incredible it was, how great it was to have a pro-US crowd, and feel that connection with the fans in the stadium. They could carry us a long way into the tournament," captain Tim Ream said after the game.

Ream, the strapping centre-back who turns up for Charlotte FC, would know the enormity of reaching the tournament's deep end. The progress of

USMNT has not matched neither the soaring popularity of football in the country nor the financial muscle it wields. American owners own or co-own eleven clubs in the Premier League, but only four players from the US are playing in what is considered the toughest league in the world. The World Cup heritage is middling—in 12 World Cups, the furthest they have travelled is to the quarter-final stage in the wild and erratic tournament that was 2002. But the surge of co-hosts South Korea in that tournament, who scalped a raft of giants to reach the semifinals, would offer plumes of hope. Since then, they haven't

Usually outnumbered by the adversary's crowd even on home soil, American fans have flocked to watch their practice games as well as warm-up in the Irvine.

progressed beyond the round of 16 in the four editions they qualified.

There is no shortage of ambition, though. The moment they knew they would co-host, they started scanning for high-profile coaches and probed into the possibility of luring credible footballers with American ancestry. Argentina's Mauricio Pochettino is among the most celebrated coaches in the world, reputed for his high-tempo attractive system. But a few months into his tenure, he realised he doesn't have the personnel to embrace such a game. "Belgium and Portugal have a few players in the top 100, I don't think we have any," he said after a 2-0 defeat to Portugal in a friendly, two days before picking the World Cup squad.

The comments incensed the administrators but he was de-

scribing the reality, reflected by their group-stage exit in the COPA. Another act of his angered those snubbed from the squad—he informed them of the omission through a WhatsApp message rather than a phone call or a private chat.

He countered: "What am I going to tell a player?" Pochettino said. "Am I supposed to lie? I am going to say that another player is on the roster because today, in this period, he is a better option."

He binned his penchant to high press and opted for a functional mid-block that offered more steel in defence and midfield. They frustrated Germany in their last game (2-1), matched them at the centre of the pitch and created ample chances without cutting-edge upfront. "To see how we react, how we show character, how we show [togetherness], how we start to play under pressure," he said.

The creative fulcrum is forward Christian Pulisic, but he has not scored a goal since last December, for both club and country. Yet, his link-up play and passing range are impeccable. The 24-year-old striker Folarin Balogun is their focal point. He is quick and direct, even though his finishing is a study in progress. His acquisition was considered a coup, as he was eligible to play for both England and Nigeria as well.

Their rivals Paraguay would put to test the hosts' attacking prowess, as they are among the meanest defences in South America, leaking only 12 goals in their 18-match qualifying cycle. Coach Gustavo Alfaro was clear about their approach from the first day: "Paraguayan DNA, intensity and clean sheets. That's what will take us to the World Cup."

The tournament has a history of host nations mocking the pre-tournament odds. But the USMNT have to hit the straps straightaway in a group that also features Australia and Turkey. And without the most powerful man in the country watching from the stands.



Coach Jesse Marsch leads a training session for Canada. AP

Ignored hosts Canada have chance to make a splash

Mihir Vasavda  
Mumbai, June 11

CANADA IS a co-host of the World Cup, but often an afterthought in the global imagination. The country will stage 13 matches across Toronto and Vancouver; the first of those on Friday (12.30 am Saturday, IST) when the hosts take on Bosnia and Herzegovina at the Toronto Stadium.

Yet, on the eve of the first-ever World Cup match on its soil, Canada finds itself in a curious position: hosting the World Cup while still trying to convince the world, and perhaps itself, that it belongs at football's biggest table. The men's team made a solitary World Cup appearance in 1986 before disappearing from the tournament for 36 years. They qualified for Qatar 2022, but struggled to leave a lasting impression.

Canada lost all three matches, but Alphonso Davies's goal against Croatia – the country's first World Cup goal – offered a glimpse of what might come next. Now, on the eve of their tournament opener, the country is sweating over the fitness of its biggest star while also hoping to step out of the shadow of its southern neighbour.

Canada's current squad is widely regarded as the most talented in the country's history. Davies remains the headline act. Jonathan David, the Juventus forward, has become one of Europe's most reliable goal

scorers. The supporting cast is deeper, more experienced and more comfortable on the international stage than the group that travelled to Qatar.

But perhaps the most crucial element in Canada's World Cup moment is not a player. It is Jesse Marsch, the American coach who has become one of the most visible champions of Canadian football.

Marsch arrived in 2024 with a reputation forged in club football and quickly transformed the national team. Under him, Canada reached the semifinals of the Copa América, achieved its highest-ever FIFA ranking and developed an aggressive, fearless style that mirrors the personality of its manager.

More importantly, he has given Canada a clearer football identity – pressing aggressively, playing proactively and embracing the kind of ambition that host nations often need when the spotlight arrives.

Marsch has emerged as an unlikely public voice for Canadian football and, at times, Canadian identity itself. When US President Donald Trump referred to Canada as a potential '51st state', Marsch publicly pushed back, urging respect for Canadian sovereignty and character. The comments reflected qualities that define his football: directness, conviction and an absence of caution. Here was an American coaching Canada who seemed to understand the country's desire to be recognised on its own terms.

{ SIDELINES }



Omar Artan was sent back from Miami Airport on Wednesday. AP

Artan to officiate in UEFA Super Cup after WC snub

AFTER SOMALIA referee Omar Artan was denied entry into the United States to officiate in the upcoming FIFA World Cup, the UEFA on Thursday announced that he will officiate the 2026 UEFA Super Cup final between Europa League winner Aston Villa and Champions League winner Paris Saint Germain on August 12 in Salzburg. "Following discussions with its sister confederation, Confédération Africaine de Football (CAF), UEFA has today appointed Somali referee Omar Artan to officiate the 2026 UEFA Super Cup, which will take place on 12 August in Salzburg between UEFA Champions League winners Paris Saint-Germain and UEFA Europa League winners Aston Villa," UEFA said in a statement. Artan, who was Africa's referee of the year in 2025, was set to

become the first from his country to take charge of a FIFA World Cup game, but was denied entry at Miami International Airport on Monday, despite holding a diplomatic passport and a single-entry visa into the USA. The referee said that he faced an 11-hour immigration interview and was detained for several hours before he was put on a flight back to Istanbul, Turkey. On Wednesday, he returned home to a hero's welcome where he was received by supporters and officials after touching down in the capital city of Mogadishu. "I promise you, God willing, that I will attend the next one. I want the Somali public to take comfort in this and remain confident, he said to the people gathered there. "It is up to all of us to defend the Somali name," Artan said.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE



Haiti alter jersey days before their first game

JUST DAYS ahead of their first match in the FIFA World Cup, Haiti had to alter the design of their jersey. The shirts, which depicted a war scene from the country's battle for independence, had to be changed due to FIFA flagging it for violating its regulations on political speech. "During the review process, FIFA determined that certain visual elements could be interpreted differently under its equipment regulations and ultimately requested modifications to the design. While this interpretation differed from our intention, Saeta respected the process and implemented the final requirements communicated by FIFA," the shirt manufacturer Saeta said. ENS

Influencers can't make content with tourist visa

THE ROLE of 'influencers' in major sports events has been growing ever bigger over the last few years, with many of them now being embedded by organisers and teams to create content that throws a positive light on them. But if they had thought that they could carry on their activities in the United States during the FIFA World Cup, the authorities have thrown cold water over their aspirations. Content creators and influencers, who travel to the country, will not be allowed to carry out their activity with only a tourist visa any more, immigration authorities have warned. Many of these individuals generate income from the content they upload onto digital platforms such as YouTube, TikTok, Facebook. This directive would hit them hard. "Having the sole purpose of the visit be content creation, thereby generating income from US sources while in the country, is considered work and requires the appropriate visa," said Authorities about the influencers. ENS

{ NO WORRIES }

Infantino asks fans to 'chill, relax' amid WC ticket row

Express News Service  
New Delhi, June 11

FIFA PRESIDENT Gianni Infantino told football fans and critics to "chill and relax" as the governing body came under fresh pressure over immigration problems, travel restrictions and ticket prices ahead of the start of the World Cup. Infantino defended the organisation's handling of several controversies that have dominated the buildup, from visa issues affecting teams and officials to complaints about expensive tickets. He insisted FIFA was doing everything possible to find solutions.

"It's important sometimes to chill, relax," he said. "We work on everything. Sometimes, screaming and shouting does not find a solution." His comments came as FIFA faced criticism over entry restrictions affecting

some participants and supporters. The issue gained attention after Somali referee Omar Artan was denied entry to the United States, prompting criticism from the United Nations over immigration issues. Infantino acknowledged the frustration but argued that FIFA cannot control decisions made by governments.

"We don't live on the moon, we live on planet Earth," he said. "We have to respect that we are not kings of the world, who can rule over governments and police forces."

The FIFA chief said people should not interpret his call to "chill and relax" as a request to ignore problems.

"When I say chill, I don't mean sit and do nothing," he said. "I mean trust us that we are trying to find solutions. Sometimes we are successful, some-



Gianni Infantino addressed his first press conference since 2023. AP

times we are not. We are a sports organisation that does as much as we can," he added.

Much of Infantino's address focused on defending the United States. Despite concerns over travel bans and visa restrictions affecting people from some

participating countries, he said every nation has the right to protect its borders.

"Unfortunately, we live in an aggressive world and security goes above everything," he said.

To underline his point, Infantino used a future example

involving Britain. "In 2035, we hope the Women's World Cup will be in the United Kingdom," he said. "Would you find it normal that FIFA would dictate to the British government who to let into the country?"

Ticket prices were another major target of criticism, but Infantino argued that demand for the tournament justified the cost. He revealed that more than six million tickets had already been sold and described interest in the competition as extraordinary. According to Infantino, lowering prices would not necessarily help genuine supporters because many tickets would simply be resold for profit.

"The demand has been unprecedented, not by a little bit, but by a factor of 10 or more," he said.

"When we put tickets on sale

on the secondary market, they are sold at a much higher price, which shows the original price was accurate," he added.

He also defended FIFA's financial model, saying money generated from the World Cup is reinvested into football around the world. "What's most important in all of this is that every dollar we generate goes back into football," he said.

Infantino pointed to investment in smaller and developing football nations as evidence of that commitment. "We invest in countries where no one else does – South Sudan, Bhutan. No one else is doing this," Infantino added.

The FIFA president was equally determined to highlight Iran's participation in the tournament despite the political difficulties surrounding the team's presence.



## 400-run innings in U-13s to India U-19 captain: Chauhan's story

**Devendra Pandey**  
*Mumbai, June 11*

WHEN YASHBARDHAN Singh Chauhan (**in pic**) picked up a cricket bat for the first time at the age of six, his father Anami knew from the grip alone.

The hands were in the right place. That was enough. He enrolled his son at Lavkesh Chaudhary's cricket academy in Gwalior the same week.

On Thursday, his son was named captain of India's under-19 side for the tour of Sri Lanka next month — three one-day matches and two multi-day games. "My father was also a club-level cricketer. The way I held the bat for the first time — *jaise meine bat pakda* — it was the right way. So he decided to enroll me in one of the academies in Gwalior," Yashbardhan said.

The word spread fast once he started scoring. In the A W Kamnadikar Trophy, the MPCA's under-13 inter-divisional tournament, he scored 425, 235 and 391 in successive innings — around 1,300 runs in five matches. He was thirteen.

Since then he has led the MP side at under-14, under-16 and under-19 level without interruption. When Covid-19 shut the world down, Anami drove 40 kilometres every day — Gwalior to Murena and back — so his son could attend practice. The sessions continued. The runs continued.

### Patidar's kit

Last season Yashbardhan scored 550 runs with a highest score of 223. A year ago, he met Rajat Patidar. The senior MP and India player asked him about his scores, liked what he heard, and handed over his own helmet and gloves.

"For me my first goal was to get selected for India under-19. Everyone at home is happy and excited but I know I have a long way to go. It was last year I met Rajat bhai. He asked me about my scores and was happy so he gave me his helmet and gloves. I like to play long innings — *usmein ek alag maza hai*," the 17-year-old said.

In Indian cricket, he watches Virat Kohli — specifically, the fitness. "I haven't had to sacrifice as much, but if he can sacrifice so much to show the world, then god has given me everything. I have such a good father. If I keep working hard, I can do it too," he said.

**A year ago, he met Rajat Patidar. The India player asked him about his scores, and handed over his own helmet and gloves**

## T20 WORLD CUP

# A new world order awaits

**Tournament could mark the end of one era and the beginning of another, as ODI world champions India look to extend supremacy in shortest format**

**Shankar Narayan**  
*Mumbai, June 11*

THE 2026 T20 World Cup in England arrives at a fascinating moment for the women's game. The likes of Harmanpreet Kaur and Ellyse Perry are preparing for their 10th appearances at the tournament. New Zealand's title-winning trio of Suzie Bates, Sophie Devine and Lea Tahuu are embarking on a farewell campaign. Shabnim Ismail has come out of retirement for one final shot at the trophy that has twice slipped South Africa's grasp.

Yet while the old guard prepares for another run, a new generation is closing in, and whether experience can hold off youth may ultimately define the tournament.

Australia remain the benchmark despite entering a period of transition. England have home conditions and a growing belief under Nat Sciver-Brunt and Charlotte Edwards. Defending champions New Zealand arrive with the confidence of proven winners, while South Africa and India believe their moment may finally have arrived.

The growing parity in the women's game raises a fascinating question: will the established powers have one final say, or is a changing of the guard finally underway?

### Sides in transition

For the first time in years, Australia arrive at a T20 World Cup without some of the names who defined their golden era. Meg Lanning retired a few years ago, and Alyssa Healy hung up her boots months before the tournament; hence,

they will be led by a relatively new captain in Sophie Molineux.

Yet the production line shows no signs of slowing down. Ellyse Perry and Megan Schutt still provide experience, Annabel Sutherland is one of the game's premier all-rounders, while Phoebe Litchfield represents Australia's next batting generation.

England's transition under Sciver-Brunt and Edwards has gathered momentum, highlighted by a semifinal appearance at last year's ODI World Cup. Playing at home will bring expectation, but it could also provide them with their best chance in years to reclaim the title.

A squad featuring Charlotte Dean, Alice Capsey, Sophie Ecclestone and Heather Knight has depth and experience. Historically, England have been Australia's closest challengers, winning 31 of their 42 Women's T20 World Cup matches. The challenge will be handling the pressure that comes with hosting a major event.

### Title defence

New Zealand spent years carrying the label of dark horses before finally breaking through in 2024. Amelia Kerr's side arrive in England no longer hoping to belong among the favourites, but knowing they do. The farewell tournament for Bates, Tahuu and Devine adds an emotional layer to their campaign. The White Ferns would love nothing more than to send them off with another title.

"For them, there will be emotions around that, they have all had really long careers,



Team India poses for a photo on the eve of the T20 World Cup. BCCI/X

### Number Plate

**10**

● This will be Harmanpreet Kaur's 10th T20 World Cup. She has played every edition since the inaugural one in England in 2009.

but hopefully they can go out there and enjoy it.

Winning and success help, but in terms of what we can control off the field, hopefully we can make it a really special last tour for them," Kerr wrote about the trio in her ICC column.

South Africa no longer need to prove they can compete with the best. Consecutive appearances in 2023 and 2024 finals have established Laura Wolvaardt's side as genuine contenders. The question now is whether they can finish the job, as near misses are becoming a recurring theme.

### India's moment

India's case rests on more than hope. It rests on evidence. In the inaugural tournament in 2009, India scored at a strike

### ● India's schedule

**JUNE 14:** vs Pakistan, 7pm  
**JUNE 17:** vs Netherlands, 7pm  
**JUNE 21:** vs South Africa, 7pm  
**JUNE 25:** vs Bangladesh, 7pm  
**JUNE 28:** vs Australia, 7pm

Live on JioHotstar & Star Sports Network

rate of 79.06. That number had climbed to 118.91 by 2018 and peaked at 119.04 during the 2023 World Cup in South Africa. Their best tournament aggregates - 704 runs in 2018 and 700 in 2023 - reflect that growth.

Harmanpreet, Smriti Mandhana, Jemimah Rodrigues and Deepti Sharma form an experienced core, but India no longer look dependent on one or two players.

The batting carries greater depth than before, with the likes of Richa Ghosh holding the middle order together, while players have benefited from regular exposure to high-pressure cricket through the Women's Premier League.

Harmanpreet, for whom

this could be her last shot at glory, believed that progress would count for little unless India showed they could handle the demands of the upcoming tournament in England.

"Every ICC trophy has its own challenges. The format is shorter, the margins are smaller, and the pressure is greater. We will have to be sharper right from the start, and winning the key moments will be crucial," she wrote in her ICC column.

With India's pacers lacking consistency, Deepti, Sree Charani and Shreyanka Patil may need to shoulder a greater share of the bowling burden. Buoyed by last year's ODI World Cup triumph, they start the tournament with reason to believe.

Australia remain the standard. England have home conditions. New Zealand have championship pedigree. South Africa have unfinished business. But India is perhaps carrying the strongest sense of opportunity. For a team that has spent years knocking on the door, this feels like another chance to finally stand on the podium.

# Sooryavanshi shines but Afghanistan A beat India A

**Express News Service**  
*Chennai, June 11*

AFGHANISTAN A defeated India A by four runs under the DLS method in the second match of the tri-series in Dambulla on Thursday. Chasing a revised score of 294 runs in 38 overs due to a rain interruption in the mid-innings break, the opening pair of captain Imran Mir and Hassan Eisaikhil put on 53 runs for the first wicket.

The former, one of the country's best batting talents, paced his innings perfectly in the company of number four batsman Bahir Shah (51). The pair put on 112 runs for the third wicket, keeping Afghanistan A on course to victory.

The pair seemed ready to launch, but in the 26th over, the

rains arrived, and at 177/2 after 25.5 overs, they were marginally ahead in the DLS par score and, as a result, secured the win. For India A, this was a missed opportunity with the ball. A revised target offered them a chance to make it two wins in two, especially after how they had secured a spirited win at the death in the tri-series opener.

The attack didn't penetrate much with the new ball. Anshul Kamboj and Arshad Khan were expensive at the start before the latter provided the first breakthrough by removing Eisaikhil for 36. And when left-arm spinner Anukul Roy trapped Khalid Taniwal for two a couple of overs later, India A appeared to be taking control of the game.

**Sooryavanshi showed his game was not just about power.**

But Mir and Shah ensured there were no further dents, eventually doing just enough to clinch two points for their side.

### Sooryavanshi cameo

Earlier, 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi set the ball rolling for India to post the huge total. The left-hander began with a boundary, creamed through covers, but during the course of his 22-ball 44, showed a different game than the explosive version he has shown in the IPL. While his knock didn't include a single six, Sooryavan-

shi showed his game was not just about power. With Afghanistan A bowling to a strong off-side field and not offering enough room, he timed his shots through the gaps, with one of the one-the-up drives emerging as the standout shot.

His innings ended when he tried to upper cut a delivery that was too close to play as he took the edge and settled into the hands of the wicketkeeper.

With Priyansh Arya falling cheaply, Prabhsimran Singh and Ruturaj Gaikwad consolidated India. The Punjab opener, in particular, was the more aggressive of the two, stroking some delightful drives against the spinners.

He looked set for a century before he fell trying to play a paddle-scoop that took a faint

edge to the keeper. That dismissal brought captain Tilak Varma to the middle. Having struggled in the previous outing to rotate the strike against spinners, he appeared to get into a shell again on Thursday. But every time he looked stuck, Afghanistan A provided him with a boundary ball. Gaikwad had only three boundaries to show in his 66 as he did the bulk of his scoring in singles and twos. All-rounder Suryansh Shedge gave late momentum to the innings, which powered India A to the towering score.

**BRIEF SCORES: India** 349/9 in 49 overs (Prabhsimran 84, Gaikwad 66, Varma 66, Shedge 40; Ahmadzai 5/68) in 49 ovs lost to **Afghanistan** 177/2 in 25.5 ovs (Imran 75 n.o., Bahir 51) by four runs (DLS method)

# Manu to lead India in two events as NRAI names Asian Games squad

**Express News Service**  
*New Delhi, June 11*

DESPITE FINISHING seventh in the 10m air pistol women's shooting trials, Manu Bhaker has made it to the Asian Games squad for the event along with 25m Sports Pistol event. Similarly, Esha Singh has also made it to the squad in both events, Vidarsa K Vinod and Rudranksh Patil has also made it to the 10m air rifle and 50m three positions team.

The decision to take two event specialists came after the organizers capped the maximum number of participants at 30 (15 men and 15 women) for each country. Since, shotgun shooters can't participate in two events, NRAI decided to prefer two event specialists in rifle and pistol. While Manu didn't have a good show in the 10m trials, she is the Olympic bronze medalist in the event while Rudranksh, who primarily shoots in 10m event, has been producing good results in the 50m 3P since last year.

### 'Challenging task'

Speaking of the squad selected for the Asian Games.

# With uncertainty around Pandya, India turn to Reddy

**Lalith Kalidas**  
*Dharamsala, June 11*

IN HIS first set of India training sessions in New Chandigarh last week, Nitish Kumar Reddy's warm-up drills were conspicuously different from those of his teammates. Mohammed Siraj couldn't help but chuckle as Nitish sent down the red SG ball rather unusually, from a two-step run-up — utilising only the final motions of his usual delivery — in full force.

Bowling coach Morne Morkel also watched Nitish from a distance. Now down on one knee, he continued to hurl a yellow ball, heavier than the usual 5.5-ounce cricket ball. Two days later, the 23-year-old was left on the bench as India went in with the additional spinner, debutant Manav Suthar, for the one-off Test against Afghanistan. On Wednesday, the specific drills were back on display at the old PCA Stadium in Mohali as India limbered up for the three-match ODI series, starting Saturday here.

Nitish's modified routines stem from a chance encounter with renowned English fast-bowling coach Steffan Jones on Instagram this summer. Their one-week exchange in Bengaluru before IPL 2026 delivered pathbreaking results. Nitish added up to 10 kph — touching 140 kph for the first time in his career. Moreover, he has re-kindled his case as India's all-format seam-bowling alternative to Hardik Pandya.

The initial wave of replacing Hardik as the new Test seam all-rounder fell flat shortly after his Boxing Day Test century on his maiden tour to Australia in 2024. Pace, or the lack thereof, soon stalled his momentum across formats. So much so that the Andhra all-rounder made his last Test appearance in Guwahati last year as a mere stop-gap option in the XI. When India went down to South Africa by 408 runs — their heaviest home defeat — Nitish's contributions were confined to 10 runs and only 10 overs across four innings.

Fast forward seven months, and Nitish's gains have sustained his name across formats post the IPL. Named in both squads for the home series, he will also fly out for the Ireland and England T20Is later this month. Nitish's return to the all-format board comes at a time when Hardik — the bona fide all-rounder — has repeatedly struggled to unify form and fitness. He was rested for India's previous ODI series, a 1-2 defeat to New Zealand, in line with his workload ahead of the T20 World Cup.

Despite his eight wickets and 217 runs, Hardik was far from his best during India's World Cup triumph. During India's Champions Trophy-winning season last year, Hardik was only required in parts, tallying 135 runs and seven



Nitish Reddy was spotted doing drills designed by Steffan Jones last week. LALITH KALIDAS

wickets in eight ODIs in 2025. A late injury flare-up has delayed his 50-overs comeback this week. Hardik could also miss the cut for the England tour.

The opening gives Nitish a vital opportunity, not necessarily to displace Hardik but to stake a claim for a role in tandem even when the senior all-rounder returns. Despite the injury situation and wavering form, India would be better served avoiding a 'Hardik versus Nitish' debate, and instead building towards a 'Hardik and who' combination for the 2027 ODI World Cup.

The all-round yields from the IPL 2026 season reveal Nitish's evolving mettle, though there is a lot left to be proven in the India blues. The Sunrisers Hyderabad all-rounder aggregated 302 runs — tonking 21 sixes — besides nabbing eight wickets, his best for a season. Nitish was the only player to amass at least 300 runs and pick as many wickets this year, a feat previously achieved among Indian pace-bowling all-rounders only by Hardik in 2019 and 2022.

### Third dimension

Nitish's challenge rests on consistency and enhancing his bowling factor, besides his floating and improved big-hitting capabilities. The competition takes on a three-dimensional shape when Harshit Rana returns to the fold. Clearly, the specialist seamer among the three, Harshit, embodies a lower-order, long-handle spirit. It was exemplified in his 43-ball half-century with eight boundaries in India's last ODI against New Zealand in late January.

If the speeds and bowling efficacies from a straightened and longer run-up hold, India can turn to Nitish for further batting cushion, behind a fit Hardik, in a full-strength ODI XI that must assemble at some point over the next few months. With added nip and pace, Nitish had peppered a returning Rohit Sharma with swift in-cutters in Mohali on Wednesday.

On chillier plains in Dharamsala and the rest of the series, Nitish will step into Hardik's shoes. He does not yet command the same presence across departments, but India would have earned something significant if Nitish could emulate Hardik on temperament and coolness, across phases and conditions.

**Nitin Sharma**  
*Chandigarh, June 11*

WHEN NIKHIL Chaudhary got stuck in Australia during COVID-19, little did he or his family back home in Punjab know that the inconvenience would eventually result in him getting called up for the Aussie T20 side in just over six years time.

A former teammate of Shubman Gill, Abhishek Sharma and Harbhajan Singh in the state side, Nikhil travelled to Australia's Townsville in March 2020 for a friend's birthday, just before borders were closed. Now, the 30-year-old has a chance to become only the third India-born cricketer to have played for Australia, following in the footsteps of Rex Sellers and Lisa Shalekar.

"When Nikhil decided to play club cricket in Australia months after he was struck there, I was a bit displeased. He had played for Punjab and wanted to don the Indian jersey one day. But he saw himself growing as a professional cricketer there," his father Sneh Kumar Chaudhary told *The Indian Express* on Thursday.



Coach Charanjit Bhangu with Nikhil Chaudhary during one of his visits to his academy in Ludhiana. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

"Right from his childhood, he was an admirer of the dominance of Australian teams."

Nikhil's cricketing dreams germinated in Ludhiana — a city his family shifted to in 1997, a year after he was born, to start a construction business. Chaudhary Sr, whose father was a wrestler, took a young Nikhil to train under coach Charanjit Bhangu at the Cricket Galaxy academy in 2007. Initially an off-spinner, the youngster later developed into a leg-spinning-allrounder.

"From the day he came to train under me, I was impressed by his physique. He had a very good cricketing IQ. Once during a Punjab U-16 tour to Madhya Pradesh where I was assistant coach, the coach decided to send him as an opener. He had never batted so high but hit a 96. However, he was dropped for the second match. When he returned to the side, he scored 145," Bhangu tells *The Indian Express*.

Within five years, Nikhil made his Punjab debut in a

**When Nikhil decided to play club cricket in Australia months after he was struck there, I was a bit displeased. He had played for Punjab and wanted to don the Indian jersey one day."**

**SNEH KUMAR CHAUDHARY,**  
NIKHIL'S FATHER

North Zone T20 match against Haryana, before he was handed his List A debut against Delhi in the Vijay Hazare Trophy in 2017. He was even named in Punjab's Ranji Trophy squad but didn't get a game.

### A fresh start

Nikhil's life turned on its head when he took a flight to Australia on March 14, 2020. Within a week, Australia sealed its borders and he would shift base to Brisbane to play club cricket. He also worked at a Mexican restaurant for a few days, before trying out parcel delivery for Australia Post.















CROSSWORD



**ACROSS**

1 Moving spirits behind drug sales (7)

5 Those in favour have a point in writing (5)

8 When to take action in prison (5,4)

9 Recovered from a sudden attack (3)

10 It's heavy though possibly used as a light attachment (4)

12 Humiliating return from a summit meeting? (8)

14 A binding affair perhaps (6)

15 They're employed in a theatre or in religious work (6)

17 Just the same it means you had the right money (2,6)

18 Father to the French and mother to the Germans (4)

21 Some Africans have such charm (3)

22 Concerns financial gains (9)

24 Girl in New York becomes a nurse (5)

25 Division has FBI agents put outside (7)

**DOWN**

1 Plead controversially for one trodden underfoot (5)

2 It will be in most winter sportsmen's kit (3)

3 They're regularly shelled and may be beaten (4)

4 A gentleman who goes after a lady (6)

5 Bearing gifts we hear vaguely (8)

6 A shade less well than usual? (3-6)

7 Holds out longer? (7)

11 It comes from a friend but also from a foe in fact (9)

13 There's much laughter when a girl swallows it (8)

14 Hit by a car, not at all well (3,4)

16 A new stage setting may include them (6)

19 Rising and descent of the sun cause disturbance (5)

20 Get up in turn and crow (4)

23 Prosecute for wrong use (3)

**SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6012****ACROSS:** 1 Exposure, 5 Opus, 9 Garbo, 10 Premier, 11 Working party, 13 Mishit, 14 Stamen, 17 Off the record, 20 Testate, 21 Lyino, 22 Rash, 23 Playtime**DOWN:** 1 Edge, 2 Parsons, 3 Shook his head, 4 Repent, 6 Prior, 7 Spraying, 8 Despotically, 12 Impostor, 15 Martini, 16 Ordeal, 18 Fists, 19 Ogre

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

I learned long ago, never to wrestle with a pig. You get \_\_\_\_, and besides, the pig \_\_\_\_. George Bernard Shaw (5,,,5,2)

CMEIR

TVIIS

EOOLTT

ALRDKY

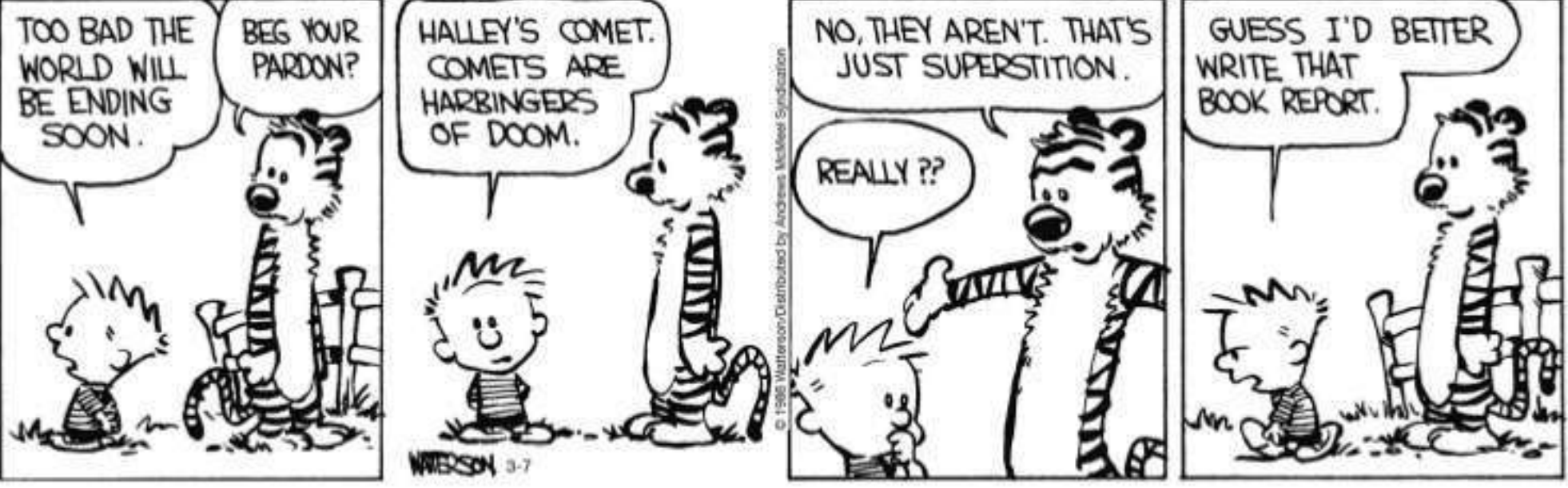
ANSWER: I learned long ago, never to wrestle with a pig. You get **dirty**, and besides, the pig **likes it**. - George Bernard Shaw

SOLUTIONS: Crime, Visit, Tootle, Barkly

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s

INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6347

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 |   |   |   | 8 | 2 | 9 |
| 6 |   |   | 2 | 4 |   |   |
|   |   |   | 7 |   |   |   |
| 9 |   | 7 |   | 2 | 1 | 8 |
|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
| 2 | 3 | 4 |   | 1 |   | 7 |
|   |   |   | 9 |   |   |   |
|   | 1 |   | 4 |   |   | 3 |
| 3 | 4 | 7 |   |   |   | 6 |

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6346

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | 8 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 1 | 2 | 9 | 3 |
| 9 | 6 | 1 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 8 | 5 | 7 |
| 3 | 5 | 2 | 9 | 8 | 7 | 1 | 6 | 4 |
| 4 | 1 | 3 | 7 | 5 | 8 | 6 | 2 | 9 |
| 5 | 9 | 6 | 3 | 2 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 1 |
| 8 | 2 | 7 | 1 | 9 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 6 | 4 | 9 | 2 | 7 | 3 | 5 | 1 | 8 |
| 2 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 1 | 9 | 4 | 7 | 6 |
| 1 | 7 | 8 | 6 | 4 | 5 | 9 | 3 | 2 |

ROYAL STARS

**ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20):** Tread carefully today. You're eager to get out and talk to others. In fact, short trips and an opportunity to teach and share your ideas will please you. However, you might be touchy about money matters or something that you own. Tonight: Check your money.

**TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21):** Today the Moon is in your sign, which can give you a slight advantage. However, it is lined up with fiery Mars, which can make you easily irritable. Be reasonable. Tonight: You're strong.

**GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21):** Strong feelings might be building up within you behind the scenes or in a secretive way. (You might be aware of this; you might not be.) However, this is why you might feel easily irritated or quick to anger. This is a fleeting influence. Tonight: Solitude.

**CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23):** Today you'll need to be patient with a friend or even a member of a group because you might feel reactive. Perhaps you are too quick to jump to conclusions. Perhaps you are too quick to take offence. Tonight: Be friendly.

**LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23):** When talking to VIPs, bosses, parents, you might be challenged because either they are a bit angry or you are. Either way, don't do anything to get in their bad books. What's the upside to that? Tomorrow is a fine day. Tonight: Be modest.

**VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23):** In discussions with others, if you drift into controversial subjects, an argument might break out because you have strong feelings about things today. Why not avoid controversy, thereby avoiding anything nasty? Tonight: Something to learn.

**LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23):** Use your skillful means today to avoid arguments about shared property, shared responsibilities, taxes or debt. You might still feel angry, but you don't have to get involved with someone to make matters worse. Be cool. Tonight: Check your finances.

**SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23):** The Moon is opposite your sign lined up with Mars, which means you might be easily irritated by someone close to you -- a spouse, partner or close friend. Knowing this annoyance is temporary, deal with it gracefully. Tonight: Be welcoming.

**SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22):** Remember that you need more sleep this month. And today in particular you might feel angry or irritated with a co-worker. Cool your jets so you can accomplish as much as possible without being upset. Tonight: Be efficient.

**CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20):** Parents will have to be extra patient when dealing with their kids and each other today. For that matter, anyone involved in the arts, sports events or the hospitality industry will have to practice patience today. Tonight: Socialize.

**AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19):** Do what you can to keep the family peace today. This will benefit everyone, including yourself. Meanwhile, this is a playful day. Get out and make things happen. Tonight: Rest at home.

**PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20):** This is the classic day to give into irritation when talking to siblings, relatives and neighbours. Don't do this. This way you're happier, and so is everyone else. Tonight: A short trip?

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**See Section 82 Cr. P.C.**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Manjeet @ Monu, S/o: Devender Singh, R/o H.No. 382 Parwa Pana Village Karala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 38/2026, U/S: 115(2)126(2)/324/351 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet @ Monu**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet @ Monu**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Manjeet @ Monu**, of **FIR No: 38/2026, U/S: 115(2)126(2)/324/351 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.07.2026**.

By Order  
Apoorv Bhardwaj  
Judicial Magistrate, First Class  
North-West, Room No. 113, 1st Floor  
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7587/RD/2026  
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**See Section 84 BNSS**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Briju Kumar S/o Sh. Kedar Paswan R/o H.No. 222, Panja Sharif, Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 98/2026, U/s: 306 BNS**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Briju Kumar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Briju Kumar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Briju Kumar, FIR No.: 98/2026, U/s: 306 BNS**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.07.2026**.

By Order  
Sh. Vaibhav Garg  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11  
(Central) Court No. 138, First Floor  
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7777/N/2026  
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**(See Section 82 Cr.PC)**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Pawan Kumar, S/o Sh. Shyam Singh R/o H.No.C-77/A, Anup Nagar, D.K Mohan Garden, Delhi-110059, Also at C/o M/s Rubber India, Khasra No.647/2, Shaheed Bhagat Singh Marg, Near Metro Pillar No. 507, Mundka, New Delhi-110041 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **Ct Cases/CC NI Act 3454/2019, u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pawan Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pawan Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pawan Kumar of Ct Cases/CC NI Act 3454/2019, u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order  
Ms. Poonam Singh  
Judicial Magistrate First Class(West)  
(NI Act)-04 Room No.04, Annexe-1  
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7755/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pradeep Kumar, S/o: Raj Kumar, R/o: A-116, Lal Kuan, M.B. Road, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 561/2007, U/s: 41.1 CRPC, P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pradeep Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pradeep Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pradeep Kumar of P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.

By Order  
Sh. Manuj Kaushal  
JMFC-03, Room No. 512,  
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/7796/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Manoj Kumar S/o Rajbir Singh R/o H. No. 7/9, 2nd Floor, 55 Foota Road, Bhagwati Garden, Dwarka Mor, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 135/2021 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC, PS Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manoj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Manoj Kumar in FIR No. 135/2021 U/s 457/380/411/34 IPC, PS Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.07.2026**.

By order  
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh  
Metropolitan Magistrate (West)  
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/77329/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

**See Section 82 (2)(ii) Cr.Pc.**

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely 1. **Amarjeet S/o Kulbir Singh 2. Paramjeet S/o Kulbir Singh R/o H.No. WZ-272A, G-Block, Hari Nagar, Delhi** (Address is same for both) have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 354/2020 U/s 188/269 IPC and 3 Epidemic Diseases Act** has been registered at **P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, 1. **Amarjeet 2. Paramjeet** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, 1. **Amarjeet 2. Paramjeet** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, 1. **Amarjeet 2. Paramjeet** of under **FIR No. 354/2020 U/s 188/269 IPC and 3 Epidemic Diseases Act** has been registered at **P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order  
Mr. Moksha Bains-II,  
JMFC-II, Room No.31,  
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7593/WD/2026  
(court notice)

**DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM**  
**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA**  
Paryatan Bhawan, Lewis Road, Bhubaneswar, 751014  
Phone: (0674) 243 2177  
Website: www.odishatourism.gov.in | www.dot.odisha.gov.in

No. 8947

TSM,

Bhubaneswar, dt.10.06.2026

TCT-TSP-FEST-0003-2023

INDICATIVE ADVERTISEMENT

APPLICATION FOR 37<sup>th</sup> KONARK FESTIVAL

(1<sup>st</sup> to 5<sup>th</sup> December 2026)

Open Air Auditorium, Konark, Odisha, India

Tourism Department, Government of Odisha invites online applications separately from eligible Troupe/ Institute/ Organisation to perform in the Indian Classical Dance forms i.e. Odissi, Kathak, Bharatnatyam, Mohiniyattam, Kuchipudi and Sattriya for the 37<sup>th</sup> Konark Festival scheduled to be held from 1st to 5th December 2026.

For detailed information, interested Troupe/ Institute/ Organisation are requested to visit online application portal [www.odishatourism.gov.in](http://www.odishatourism.gov.in) which shall remain open from the 12th June 2026 to 15th July 2026.

Sd/-

(Biswajit Routray)

Additional Director

OIPR- 37001/37001/1/26-27/0005

Public Works Department  
Office of The Superintending Engineer, Pwd,  
Raipur Circle No.-1 Raipur. (C.G.)

**REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)**  
(1st Call)

No. 06/Raipur/2026-27 Raipur, Dated. 05.06.2026

Public Works Department (PWD) invites proposal for Planning, Design, Estimation and related services for the work  
डॉ. भीमराव अंबेडकर स्मृति चिकित्सालय रायपुर के अधीन एडवांस कार्डियक इंस्टीट्यूट भवन निर्माण कार्य हेतु वास्तुविद् (अर्किटेक्ट) नियुक्त करने बाबत।  
Sited at Raipur  
Probable cost of project Rs. 500.00 Lakh.  
Minimum eligibility for participants shall be as below :-

|       |                                         |                                                                 |                                                                                                           |
|-------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S. N. | Building project cost                   | The applicant firms, forming Joint venture/ consortium shall be | Earnest money firms, (In shape as per annexure I) Favor of Executive Engineer, PWD Division No.-02 Raipur |
| 1     | For project cost Between 01 to 10 Crore | Empanelled as architect in Class "D" & Above Class in C.G. PWD. | Rs. 3,000=00                                                                                              |

**General Condition:** All the documents & Information as per para 6.4, shall be submitted through speed post/Registered post. so as to reach the office of under signed on or before dated 25.06.2026 by 17.30 hour. Any documents received after the last date and time will not be entertained.  
The detailed RFP is available on the website [www.cg.nic.in/pwdraipur](http://www.cg.nic.in/pwdraipur) & <http://cgstate.gov.in/> from where it can be downloaded for submission. CGPWD reserves the right to reject all or any of the application without assigning any reason. Right to modify the process of Pre-qualification is reserved with CGPWD.

Sd/-  
Superintending Engineer  
Public Works Department  
Raipur Circle No-1 Raipur

NO. 262701287/4

**बॉसवाड़ा सहकारी उपभोक्ता थोक भण्डार लि., बॉसवाड़ा**  
उद्यमपुर रोड केन्द्रीय विद्यालय के पास, बॉसवाड़ा-327001 (राजस्थान)

क्रमांक :- एक/2026/27/223 दिनांक :- 06/06/2026

**ई-निविदा संख्या 1 सूचना वर्ष 2026-27**  
बॉसवाड़ा सहकारी उपभोक्ता थोक भण्डार लि. बॉसवाड़ा द्वारा E-Bid For Procurement of Stationery Items के लिए इच्छुक बोलीदाताओं से दिनांक 16.06.2026 को दोपहर 12.00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। निविदा में वर्णित कार्य से संबंधित विवरण व अन्य शर्तें वेबसाईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। उपायन हेतु **NIB Code- CMF2627A0014, UBN No. CMF2627GLOB000015** है।  
राज.संसाद./सी/26/4653 महाम्रबंधक

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, P.W.D. DISTT.DN.II, UDAIPUR**

No.: 345 Date: 01.06.2026

Notice Inviting Bid No. 05/2026-27  
NIB No.: PWD2627A0911  
Bids for DMFT & Submersible Bridge works are invited from interested bidders upto 09.06.2026 11.00 AM to 29.06.2026 04.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal ("http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in" and "http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in") of the state, and department website. The approximate value of procurement of 5 No. is Rs. 90220 Lacs.  
UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB03912  
2 UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB03913  
3 UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB03915  
4 UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB03916  
5 UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB03918  
Sd/-  
(Anil Kichhi)  
Executive Engineer, PWD  
Distt. Dn.II, Udaipur  
DIPR/C/10008/2026

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 Cr.P.C.**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vinay Pawar, S/o Sandeep Pawar, R/o C-29, Hazara Park, Chander Nagar, Jagatpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 34/2013, U/s 25/27/29 Arms Act & 120B IPC, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vinay Pawar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vinay Pawar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinay Pawar** accused of **FIR No. 34/2013, U/s 25/27/29 Arms Act & 120B IPC, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Prigya Gupta  
Chief Judicial Magistrate, East District  
DP/7450/Crime/2026 Room No. 29, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused (1) **Rihan S/o Muslim R/o H. No. 1387, E-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** (2) **Danish S/o Kayum R/o Village Dhaka, Teh Hasalpur, PS- Nagli, Distt. Amroh, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 488/17 U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Rihan**, (2) **Danish** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Rihan**, (2) **Danish** in **FIR No. 488/17 U/s 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.07.2026**.

By order  
Ms. Bharti Beniwal  
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)  
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor  
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7765/ON/2026